

PUZZLES AND ODDITIES:

Found Floating on the Surface of our Current
Literature,

OR

TOSSED TO DRY LAND BY THE WAVES OF MEMORY.

GATHERED AND ARRANGED

BY

M. A. A. D.

New York :

RUSSELL BROTHERS, PUBLISHERS,
17, 19, 21, 23 ROSE STREET.

1876.

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tossed to dry land by the waves of memory

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It is related of St. Aloysius Gonzaga that while, at the usual time of recreation, he was engaged in playing chess, question arising among his brother novices as to what each would do were the assurance to come to them that they would die within an hour, St. Aloysius said he should go on with his game of chess.

If our recreations as well as our graver employments are undertaken with a pure intention, we need not reproach ourselves though Sorrow, we need not fear though Death surprise us while engaged in them.

Addison, N. Y., January, 1876.

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PART I.

PUZZLES AND ODDITIES.

1.

My FIRST the heats of July pack
With rows of milk-pans down the back;
September fills them all with starch,
And, though they neither drill nor march,
Each has a warlike name:
October plucks my honors off,
And down I'm thrown to floor or trough:
Perchance the mill to powder turns
Or smouldering fire to ashes burns
My rough and useless frame.

A weaver's loom my SECOND fills
In dozens of tall cotton mills,
Before the shuttle, o'er and through,
Has thrown the filling straight and true,
And made each ending fast.
My WHOLE a house in corners set,
Has swung as long as time, and yet
A trap for foolish folk shall swing,
And lessons to the wiser bring,
As long as time shall last.

[Answer](#)

2.

What is that which we often return, but never borrow?

[Answer](#)

3.

Can you tell me of what parentage Napoleon the First was?

[Answer](#)

4.

What was Joan of Arc made of?

[Answer](#)

5.

Why ought stars to be the best Astronomers?

[Answer](#)

6.

What colors were the winds and the waves in the last violent storm?

[Answer](#)

7.

In what color should a secret be kept?

[Answer](#)

8.

How do trees get at their summer dress without opening their trunks?

[Answer](#)

9.

Why am I queerer than you?

[Answer](#)

10.

Mr. Premium took my FIRST, and he wrote to Captain Smith,
And said: "Sir, do my SECOND to my THIRD, forthwith."
Now, Mr. P., you see, though a millionaire he be,
Could not, without my WHOLE, have sent Captain Smith to sea.

[Answer](#)

11.

Two pronouns find, but mind they suit,
And then between them "a—t" put:
The combination quickly yields
What may be seen on Scotland's fields.
Now, for the first word, substitute
Another pronoun that will "suit;"
When this is done, 'twill bring to view
What every day is seen by you.

[Answer](#)

12.

Me the contented man desires,
The poor man has, the rich requires,
The miser gives, the spendthrift saves,
And all men carry to their graves.

[Answer](#)

13.

A BUSINESS ORDER.

“J. Gray:

Pack with my box five dozen quills.”

What is its peculiarity?

[Answer](#)

14.

Those who have me not, do not wish for me; those who have me, do not wish to lose me; and those who gain me, have me no longer.

[Answer](#)

15.

Although Methusaleh was the oldest man that ever lived, yet he died before his father.

[Answer](#)

16.

If Moses was by adoption the son of Pharaoh’s daughter, was he not, “by the same token,” the *daughter* of Pharaoh’s *son*?

[Answer](#)

17.

What is the best time to study the book of Nature?

[Answer](#)

18.

What is the religion of Nature in the spring?

[Answer](#)

19.

There is an article of common domestic consumption, whose name contains six letters, from which may be formed twenty-two nouns, without using the plurals. What is it?

[Answer](#)

20.

What word is that, of two syllables, to which if you prefix one letter, two letters, or two other letters, you form, in each instance, a word of one syllable?

[Answer](#)

21.

What was the favorite salad at the South, in the spring of 1861?

[Answer](#)

22.

There was a thing, 'twas two days old
Ere Adam was, of yore;
Before that thing was five weeks old,
Adam was years four-score.

[Answer](#)

23.

What's that which on four limbs doth move
When first it sees the light,
But walks erect on two at noon,
And creeps on three at night?

[Answer](#)

24.

A sailor launched a ship of force,
A cargo put therein, of course;
No goods had he he wished to sell;
Each wind did serve his turn as well;
To neither port nor harbor bound,
His greatest wish to run aground.

[Answer](#)

25.

A merry maid, whose pleasant name
Was my sweet FIRST. Under a tree
She sat, and sang my THIRD, as free
As the wild crows, that without dread,
My SECOND called above her head.
Anon she turned, (with a last look
Above, below,) unto her book—
My WHOLE the author. Guess the same.

[Answer](#)

26.

The three most forcible letters in our alphabet?

[Answer](#)

27.

The two which contain nothing?

[Answer](#)

28.

The four which express great corpulence?

[Answer](#)

29.

The four which indicate exalted station?

[Answer](#)

30.

The three which excite our tears?

[Answer](#)

31.

What foreign letter is an English title?

[Answer](#)

32.

What foreign letter is a yard and a half long?

[Answer](#)

33.

What letter will unfasten an Irish lock?

[Answer](#)

34.

When was B the first letter of the alphabet, while E and O were the only vowels?

[Answer](#)

35.

What letter is always more or less heavily taxed?

[Answer](#)

36.

What letter is entirely out of fashion?

[Answer](#)

37.

Why is praising people like a certain powerful opiate?

[Answer](#)

38.

Prove that a man has five feet.

[Answer](#)

39.

WHAT AM I?

I was once the harbinger of good to prisoners.

I add to the magnitude of a mighty river.

I am a small portion of a large ecclesiastical body.

I represent a certain form of vegetable growth.

A term used by our Lord in speaking to His disciples.

A subordinate part of a famous eulogy.

I am made useful in connection with the Great Western Railway.

[Answer](#)

40.

5005E1000E,

5 0 0 5 E 1 0 0 0 E .

The name of a modern novel.

[Answer](#)

41.

Two words in French are often spoken;
Of home and love the fondest token:
But, strange to say it, one of these
Is English, from beyond the seas;
And though the thing seems quite absurd,
It means the same as t'other word.

[Answer](#)

42.

You fain would win fair Julia's heart—
“Have I the power?” you'd ask her,
But, from your lips the words won't part—
“'Tis not an easy task, Sir!”
“I know 'tis not, for one so shy.”
“Well, how shall I begin, Sir?”
“Be what you ask her,” I reply,
“And, ten to one, you'll win, Sir!”

[Answer](#)

43.

My FIRST is company; my SECOND shuns company; my THIRD calls
together a company; and my WHOLE entertains company.

[Answer](#)

44.

My FIRST is a sound, of tranquillity telling,—

A cozy and complaisant sound for your dwelling.
A place which for criminals fittest is reckoned,
Yet where saints find ineffable peace, is my SECOND.
Or, where niggardly natures, who hunger and thirst
For the wealth of this world, keep their hearts, is my FIRST;
While my SECOND'S a measure you'll know at a glance,
For 'tis shortest in Flanders, and longest in France.

Oh! my WHOLE is a name widely known, well beloved,
A name blessed on earth, and in Heaven approved;
Crowned by Faith and Good Works with so holy a light
That angels, themselves, thrill with joy at the sight.

[Answer](#)

45.

Dr. Whewell being asked by a young lady for his name “in cipher,”
handed her the following lines:

You O a O, but I O thee,—
Oh, O no O, but oh, O me;
And O, let my O no O go,
But give O O I O you so!

[Answer](#)

46.

Why was the execution of Charles the First voluntary on his part?

[Answer](#)

47.

How is Poe's “Raven” shown to have been a very dissipated bird?

[Answer](#)

48.

Set down four 9's so as to make one hundred.

[Answer](#)

49.

The cc 4 put 00000000.
si

[Answer](#)

50.

John Doe to Richard Roe,	Dr.
To 2 bronze boxes	\$3 00
1 wooden do	1 50
1 wood do	1 50

This bill was canceled by the payment of \$1.50. How?

[Answer](#)

51.

When was Cowper in debt?

[Answer](#)

52.

What animal comes from the clouds?

[Answer](#)

53.

My FIRST is one of mystic three,
Who go where goes true Liberty;
Sets with the sun, with him to rise,
Lives in the flame and with it dies;
Fades with the leaf that earthward flies.

My SECOND cleaves the morning air,
Floats through the evening still and fair;
Now soars beyond the mountain crest,
Now flutters downward to its rest,
Now broods upon some hidden nest.

My WHOLE long since the prairie trod,
Now rests beneath the prairie-sod;
Yet still upon the river stands,
And calls the stranger to the lands
Which Reminichia's ^[1] cliff commands.

[Answer](#)

54.

I saw a peacock with a fiery tail
I saw a blazing comet pour down hail
I saw a cloud all wrapt with ivy 'round
I saw a lofty oak creep on the ground
I saw a beetle swallow up a whale
I saw the foaming sea brimful of ale
I saw a pewter cup sixteen feet deep
I saw a well full of men's tears that weep
I saw wet eyes in flames of living fire
I saw a house as high as the moon and higher
I saw the glorious sun at deep midnight
I saw the man who saw this wondrous sight!

An incredulous friend actually ventured to doubt the above plain statement of facts, but was soon convinced of its literal truth.

[Answer](#)

55.

Charles the First walked and talked half an hour after his head was cut off.

[Answer](#)

56.

At the time of a frightful accident, what is better than presence of mind?

[Answer](#)

57.

Why was the year preceding 1871 the same as the year following it?

[Answer](#)

58.

Why do “birds in their little nests agree?”

[Answer](#)

59.

What did Io die of?

[Answer](#)

60.

Why did a certain farmer out West name his favorite rooster ROBINSON?

[Answer](#)

61.

How do sailors know there's a man in the moon?

[Answer](#)

62.

How do sailors know Long Island?

[Answer](#)

63.

What does a dog wear in warm weather, besides his collar?

[Answer](#)

64.

If you transpose what ladies wear,
'Twill plainly show what bad men are:
Again, if you transpose the same,
You'll see an ancient Hebrew's name:
Change it again and it will show,
What all on earth desire to do.

[Answer](#)

65.

Two brothers, wisely kept apart,
Together ne'er employed;
Though to one purpose we are bent,
Each takes a different side.

To us no head nor mouth belongs,
Yet plain our tongues appear;
With them we never speak a word,
Without them, useless are.

In blood and wounds we deal, yet good
In temper we are proved;
From passion we are always free,
Though oft with anger moved.

We travel much, yet prisoners are,
And close confined, to boot;
Can with the swiftest horse keep pace,
Yet always go on foot.

[Answer](#)

66.

Translate:

Je suis capitaine de vingt-cinq soldats; et, sans moi, Paris serait pris.

[Answer](#)

67.

Je suis ce que je suis, et je ne suis pas ce que je suis. Si j'étais ce que je suis, je ne serais pas ce que je suis.

[Answer](#)

68.

Mus cucurrit plenum sed
Contra meum magnum ad!

[Answer](#)

69.

Mens tuum ego!

[Answer](#)

70.

The title of a book: Castra tintinnabula Poëmata.

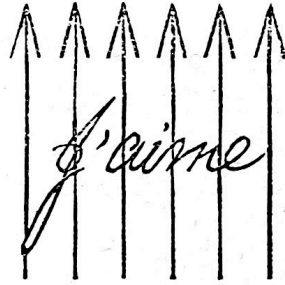
[Answer](#)

71.

Motto on a Chinese box: Tu doces!

[Answer](#)

72.



[Answer](#)

73.

Translate:

Quis crudus enim lectus, albus, et spiravit!

[Answer](#)

74.

Ecrivez: “J’ai grand appétit,” en deux lettres.

[Answer](#)

75.

Monosyllabic I, and a reptile, I trow;
But, cut me in twain, I form syllables two.
I’m English, I’m Latin, the one and the other;
And what’s Latin for one half, is English for t’other.

[Answer](#)

76.

Ever running on my race,
Never staying in one place,
Through the world I make my tour
Everywhere at the same hour.
If you please to spell my name,
Backward, forward, 'tis the same.

[Answer](#)

77.

In my FIRST my SECOND sat; my THIRD and FOURTH I ate; and yet I was
my WHOLE.

[Answer](#)

78.

TONIS ADRESTO MARE.

O Mare! Eva si formæ,
Formæ ure tonitru;
Iambicum as amandum,
Olet Hymen promptu!
Mihi his vetas annæ se,
As humano erebi;
Olet mecum, mare, to te,
Or Eta Beta Pi.

Alas, plano more meretrix;
Mi ardor vel uno,
Inferiam ure artis base
Tolerat me urebo.
Ah me! ve ara scilicet
To laudu vimin thus.
Hiatu as arandum sex—
Illuc Ionicus!

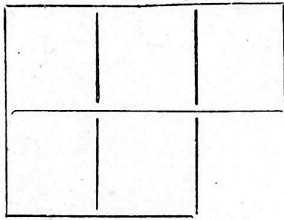
Heu! sed heu! vixin, imago,
Mi missis mare sta!
O cantu redit in mihi
Hibernus arida?

Everi dafur heri si;

Mihi resolves indu;
Totius, olet Hymen cum
Accepta tonitru!

[Answer](#)

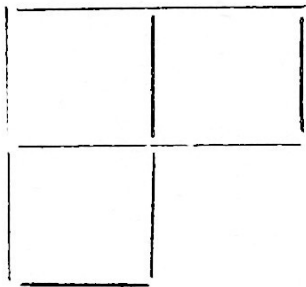
79.



From these five squares take three of the fifteen sides, and leave three squares.

[Answer](#)

80.



Divide this figure into four equal *and uniform* parts.

[Answer](#)

81.

Four things there are all of a height,
One of them crooked, the rest upright.
Take three away, and you will find

Exactly ten remains behind:
But, if you cut the four in twain,
You'll find one-half doth eight retain.

[Answer](#)

82.

To divide eight gallons of vinegar equally between two persons; using only an eight-gallon, a five-gallon, and a three-gallon measure?

[Answer](#)

83.

A certain miller takes “for toll” one tenth of the meal or flour he grinds. What quantity must he grind in order that a customer may have just a bushel of meal after the toll has been taken?

[Answer](#)

84.

To prove that two are equal to one:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Let } x &= a: \text{ Then, } x^2 = ax, \\ x^2 - a^2 &= ax - a^2, \\ (x + a)(x - a) &= a(x - a), \\ x + a &= a, \\ 2a &= a, \\ 2 &= 1. \quad \text{Q. E. D.}\end{aligned}$$

Where is the fallacy?

[Answer](#)

85.

As two Arabs, who had for sole provision, the one five, and the other three loaves of bread, were about to take their noonday meal in company, they were joined by a stranger who proposed to purchase a third part of their food. In payment he gave them, when their repast was finished, eight pieces of silver, and they, unable to agree as to the division of the sum referred the matter to the nearest Cadi, who gave seven pieces to the owner of the five loaves, and but one piece to the owner of the three loaves. And the Cadi was right.

[Answer](#)

86.

A man went to a store and bought a pair of boots for six dollars. He put down a ten dollar bill, and the merchant having no change, sent for it to a neighboring bank, and gave it to him. Later in the day one of the bank clerks came in to say that the ten dollar bill was a bad one, and insisted that the merchant should make it right, which he did. Now, how much did he lose by the whole transaction?

[Answer](#)

87.

A man bought twelve herrings for a shilling; some were two pence apiece, some a halfpenny, and some a farthing. How many did he buy of each kind?

[Answer](#)

88.

My FIRST is the last of me;
My SECOND is not so much;
And my WHOLE is entirely destitute of my FIRST.

[Answer](#)

89.

There is a word of plural number,
A foe to peace and tranquil slumber;
Now, any word you chance to take,
Adding an s will plural make;
But if you add an s to this,
How strange the metamorphosis!
Plural is plural then no more,
And sweet what bitter was before.

[Answer](#)

90.

“Charge, Chester, charge! On, Stanley, on!”
Were the last words of Marmion.
Had I been in Stanley’s place,
When Marmion urged him to the chase,
You then would very soon descry,
What brings a tear to every eye.

[Answer](#)

91.

My FIRST, if you do, will increase;
My SECOND will keep you from Heaven,
My WHOLE—such is human caprice—
Is seldomer taken than given.

[Answer](#)

92.

When may a man reasonably complain of his coffee?

[Answer](#)

93.

Why does a duck put her head under water?

[Answer](#)

94.

Why does she take it out again?

[Answer](#)

95.

In what terms does Shakespeare allude to the muddiness of the river on which Liverpool lies?

[Answer](#)

96.

If the **B**mt put: If the **B**. putting:

So said one, but another replied: How can I put: when there is such a-
der?

[Answer](#)

97.

Why is a man who never bets, as bad as one who bets habitually?

[Answer](#)

98.

When is a bonnet not a bonnet?

[Answer](#)

99.

Twice ten are six of us;
Six are but three:
Nine are but four of us;
What can we be?
Would you know more of us?
I'll tell you more;
Seven are five of us,
Five are but four!

[Answer](#)

100.

As I was going to St. Ives'
I met seven wives;
Each wife had seven sacks,
Each sack had seven cats,
Each cat had seven kits,—
Kits, cats, sacks and wives,
How many were going to St. Ives'?

[Answer](#)

101.

Helen, after sitting an hour, dressed for a walk, at length set out alone, leaving the following laconic note for the friend who, she had expected, would accompany her:

² 2⁸.

[Answer](#)

102.

Come and commiserate one who was blind,
Helpless and desolate, void of a mind;
Guileless, deceiving; though unbelieving,
Free from all sin.
By mortals adored, still I ignored
The world I was in.
King Ptolemy's, Cæsar's, and Tiglath Pilezer's
Birth days are shown;
Wise men, astrologers, all are acknowledgers,
Mine is unknown.
I never had father or mother
Alive at my birth.
Lodged in a palace, taunted by malice,
I did not inherit by lineage or merit,
A spot on the earth.
Nursed among pagans, no one baptized me,
Sponsor I had, who ne'er catechised me;
She gave me the name to her heart that was dearest;
She gave me the place to her bosom was nearest;
But one look of kindness she cast on me never,
Nor word of my blindness I heard from her ever.
Encompassed by strangers, naught could alarm me;
I saved, I destroyed, I blessed, I alloyed;
Kept a crown for a prince, but had none of my own;
Filled the place of a king, but ne'er had a throne;
Rescued a warrior, baffled a plot;
Was what I seemed not, seemed what I was not;
Devoted to slaughter, a price on my head,
A king's lovely daughter watched by my bed.
How gently she dressed me, fainting with fear!
She never caressed me, nor wiped off a tear;
Ne'er moistened my lips, though parched and dry,
What marvel a blight should pursue and defy?
'Twas royalty nursed me wretched and poor;
'Twas royalty cursed me in secret, I'm sure.

I lived not, I died not, but tell you I must,
That ages have passed since I first turned to dust.
This paradox whence? this squalor, this splendor?
Say, was I king, or silly pretender?
Fathom the mystery, deep in my history—
Was I a man?
An angel supernal, a demon infernal?
Solve it who can.

[Answer](#)

103.

A blind beggar had a brother. This blind beggar's brother went to sea and was drowned. But the man that was drowned had no brother. What relation to him, then, was the blind beggar?

[Answer](#)

104.

Two brothers were walking together down the street, and one of them, stopping at a certain house, knocked at the door, observing: "I have a niece here, who is ill." "Thank Heaven," said the other, "I have no niece!" and he walked away. Now, how could that be?

[Answer](#)

105.

"How is that man related to you?" asked one gentleman of another.

"Brother or sister I have none,
But that man's father was my father's son."

[Answer](#)

106.

Describe a cat's clothing botanically.

[Answer](#)

107.

What is that which boys and girls have once in a lifetime, men and women never have, and Mt. Parnassus has twice in one place?

[Answer](#)

108.

Why is the highest mountain in Wales always white?

[Answer](#)

109.

To what two cities of Massachusetts should little boys go with their boats?

[Answer](#)

110.

There kneels in holy St. Cuthbert's aisles
No holier Father than Father Giles:
Matins or Vespers, it matters not which,
He is ever there like a saint in his niche;
Morning and midnight his Missal he reads,
Midnight and morning he tells his beads.

Wide-spread the fame of that holy man!

Potent his blessing, and dreaded his ban:
Wondrous the marvels his piety works
On unbelieving heathen, and infidel Turks,
But strangest of all is the power he is given
To turn maidens' hearts to the service of Heaven.

St. Ursula's Prioress comes to-day,
At holy St. Cuthbert's shrine to pray,
She comes with an offering; she comes with a prayer;
For she leads to the altar the Lady Clare.
Mary Mother! how fair a maid
To yield the world for the cloister's shade!

She yields, to-morrow, her gold and lands
For the Church's use, to the Church's hands,
Renounces the world, with its pleasures and wiles,
And to-day she confesses to Father Giles:
Slight is the penance, I ween, may atone
For all of sin she hath ever known!

"Daughter! since last thou didst kneel for grace,
Hath peace in thy heart found a dwelling-place?
From thy breast hast thou banished each idle thought?
Save thy spirit's weal hast thou pined for naught?"
Moist is her kerchief, and drooped her head,
But my FIRST is all that poor Clara said.

"Daughter! thy cheek hath grown pale and thin—
Is thy spirit pure and chastened within?
Gone from thy voice is its ancient mirth?
Are thy sighs for Heaven? Thy tears for earth?"
For earth are her sighs, yet poor Clara knows
My SECOND no more than the spring's first rose!

Why doth he tremble, that holy man,
At eye so sad, and at cheek so wan?
Less burning the tears, less bitter the sighs
Heaven asks from its *willing* votaries!
And, alas! when my ALL weeps as Clara weeps,
Holy Church gaineth more than she ofttimes keeps!

[Answer](#)

NOTABLE NAMES.

One name that means such fiery things
I can't describe their pains and stings.

[Answer](#)

112.

Red as an apple, or black as night:
A heavenly sign, or a "perfect fright."

[Answer](#)

113.

Place an edible grain 'twixt an ant and a bee,
And the well-beloved name of a poet you'll see.

[Answer](#)

114.

Each human head, in time, 'tis said,
Will turn to him, though he is dead.

[Answer](#)

115.

A little more
Than a sandy shore.

[Answer](#)

116.

The dearest, “sweetest, spot on earth to me,”
And, just surpassing it, a name you’ll see.

[Answer](#)

117.

A head-dress.

[Answer](#)

118.

Inclining to one of the four parts of the compass.

[Answer](#)

119.

A mineral and a chain of hills.

[Answer](#)

120.

A metal, and a worker in metals.

[Answer](#)

121.

A sound made by an insect; and a fastening.

[Answer](#)

122.

A sound made by an animal; and a fastening.

[Answer](#)

123.

A sound made by an animal, and a measure of length.

[Answer](#)

124.

A Latin noun and a measure of quantity.

[Answer](#)

125.

A bodily pain.

[Answer](#)

126.

The value of a word.

[Answer](#)

127.

A manufactured metal.

[Answer](#)

128.

To agitate a weapon.

[Answer](#)

129.

A domestic animal, and what she cannot do.

[Answer](#)

130.

Which is the greater poet, William Shakespeare or John Dryden?

[Answer](#)

131.

A barrier before an edible; a barrier built of an edible.

[Answer](#)

132.

One-fourth of the earth's surface, and a preposition.

[Answer](#)

133.

One-fourth of the earth's surface, and a conjunction.

[Answer](#)

134.

A song; to follow the chase.

[Answer](#)

135.

A solid fence, a native of Poland.

[Answer](#)

136.

An incessant pilgrim; fourteen pounds weight.

[Answer](#)

137.

A quick succession of small sounds.

[Answer](#)

138.

Obsolete past participle of a verb meaning to illuminate.

[Answer](#)

139.

A carriage, a liquid, a narrow passage.

[Answer](#)

140.

To prosecute, and one who is guarded.

[Answer](#)

141.

A letter withdraws from a name to make it more brilliant.

[Answer](#)

142.

A letter withdraws from a name and tells you to talk more.

[Answer](#)

143.

Why is a man who lets houses, likely to have a good many cousins?

[Answer](#)

144.

What relation is the door-mat to the door-step?

[Answer](#)

145.

What is it that gives a cold, cures a cold, and pays the doctor's bill?

[Answer](#)

146.

What is brought upon the table, and cut but never eaten?

[Answer](#)

147.

What cord is that which is full of knots which no one can untie, and in which no one can tie another?

[Answer](#)

148.

What requires more philosophy than taking things as they come?

[Answer](#)

149.

What goes most against a farmer's grain?

[Answer](#)

150.

Which of Shakespeare's characters killed most poultry?

[Answer](#)

151.

THE BISHOP OF OXFORD'S RIDDLE.

I have a large box,¹ two lids,² two caps,³ two musical instruments,⁴ and a large number of articles which a carpenter cannot dispense with.⁵ I have always about me a couple of good fish,⁶ and a great number of small size;⁷ two lofty trees,⁸ and four branches of trees;⁹ some fine flowers,¹⁰ and the fruit of an indigenous plant.¹¹ I have two playful animals,¹² and a vast number of smaller ones;¹³ also, a fine stag,¹⁴ and a number of whips without handles.¹⁵

I have two halls or places of worship,¹⁶ some weapons of warfare,¹⁷ and innumerable weather-cocks;¹⁸ the steps of a hotel;¹⁹ the House of Commons on the eve of a division;²⁰ two students or scholars,²¹ and ten Spanish gentlemen to wait upon their neighbors.²²

To these may be added, a rude bed;^a the highest part of a building;^b a roadway over water;^c leaves of grass;^d a pair of rainbows;^e a boat;^f a stately pillar;^g a part of a buckle;^h several social assemblies;ⁱ part of the equipments of a saddle-horse;^j a pair of implements matched by another pair of implements much used by blacksmiths;^j several means of fastening.^k

[Answer](#)

152.

Be thou my FIRST in study or in play,
Through all the sunny hours which make the day.
Go to my SECOND, and do not despise
Her useful teachings, wonderful and wise:
Yet, for this purpose, never be my WHOLE,
Nor seek to wander from a wise control.

[Answer](#)

153.

Be sure you do my FIRST, whene'er you see
My SECOND in the garden or the tree;
But set my WHOLE upon the open plain
If you would have a plenteous crop of grain.

[Answer](#)

154.

My FIRST is a house men love to view;
My SECOND you do when you fasten your shoe;
My THIRD is one of a loving two;
My WHOLE I fain would be with you.

[Answer](#)

155.

1. A common fish, or an Eastern bay;
2. Part of a visage, or self to say;
3. The lowest part of window or door;
Whole. The end of a will that was made before.

[Answer](#)

156.

I have a little friend who possesses something very precious. It is a piece of workmanship of exquisite skill, and was said by our Blessed Saviour to be an object of His Father's peculiar care; yet it does not display the attribute of either benevolence or compassion. If its possessor were to lose it, no human ingenuity could replace it; and yet, speaking generally, it is very abundant. It was first given to Adam in Paradise, along with his beautiful Eve, though he previously had it in his possession.

It will last as long as the world lasts, and yet it is destroyed every day. It lives in beauty after the grave has closed over mortality. It is to be found in all parts of the earth, while three distinct portions of it exist in the air. It is seen on the field of carnage, yet it is a bond of affection, a token of amity, a pledge of pure love. It was the cause of death to one famed for beauty and ambition. I have only to add that it has been used as a napkin and a crown, and that it appears like silver after long exposure to the air.

[Answer](#)

157.

When the king found that his money was nearly all gone, and that he really *must* live more economically, he decided on sending away most of his wise men. There were some hundreds of them—very fine old men, and magnificently dressed in green velvet gowns with gold buttons. If they *had* a fault, it was that they always contradicted each other when he asked their advice—and they certainly ate and drank *enormously*. So, on the whole, he was rather glad to get rid of them. But there was an old lay which he did not dare to disobey, which said there must always be:

“Seven blind of both eyes;
Ten blind of one eye;
Five that see with both eyes;
Nine that see with one eye.”

Query: How many did he keep?

[Answer](#)

158.

Why are not Lowell, Holmes, and Saxe the wittiest poets in America?

[Answer](#)

159.

Why did they call William Cullen Bryant, Cullen?

[Answer](#)

160.

Why do we retain only three hundred and twenty-five days in our year?

[Answer](#)

161.

What seven letters express actual presence in this place; and, without transposition, actual absence from every place?

[Answer](#)

162.

Is Florence, (Italy,) on the Tiber? If not, on what river does it lie?
Answer both questions in one word.

[Answer](#)

163.

Is there a word in our language which answers this question, and contains all the vowels?

[Answer](#)

164.

What is it that goes up the hill; and down the hill, and never moves?

[Answer](#)

165.

What 'bus has found room for the greatest number of people?

[Answer](#)

166.

In describing a chance encounter with your doctor, what kind of a philosopher do you name?

[Answer](#)

167.

My FIRST is of my SECOND made,
And holds within its ample bound,
The grosser things of human trade,
From half a ton to half a pound.
But mostly from a barren isle,
Named from the land of Bajazet,
Where tropic sunbeams fiercely smile,
It brings a crystallised muriate.

But, in the land of Moslem mosque,
Of cool sherbet, and scimitar,
Of harem dark and fair kiosk,
It hath an office fouler far
Than e'en the headsman's sinecure:
For slighted loves and jealousies
It finds a never-failing cure
Deep in the dark Borysthenes.

The fleecy flocks on Scotia's hills;
The snow-crowned plant on Georgia's soil,
The Linum with its pale blue bells,
My SECOND yield to human toil.
To shelter from the sun and storm,
It hangs in most unseemly shape
Around the beggar's shriveled form;
Or fits a dandy, or an ape.

The gentle Rizpah, when the ire
Of Gibeon poured its bloody gall,
Did to the courts of Death retire
To watch the murdered sons of Saul:
More truly great was Aiah's child,
As on my WHOLE she sat alone,
To fright the wolf and vulture wild,
Than coward Saul upon his throne.

And ever—symbol dark of doom,
A type of deep humility—
My WHOLE speaks of the fearful tomb,
The coffin, shroud, and cypress tree;
Save in the far-off Orient,
Where Light's own spotless color
Is with the tears of mourners blent,
And made the type of dolor.

[Answer](#)

168.

What physician stands at the top of his profession?

[Answer](#)

169.

Would you rather an elephant killed you, or a gorilla?

[Answer](#)

170.

Why is an amiable and charming girl like one letter deep in thought, another on its way toward you, another bearing a torch, and another slowly singing psalms?

[Answer](#)

171.

Why is Emma, in a sorrowful mood, one of a certain sect of Jews?

[Answer](#)

172.

Why is she, always, one of another sect?

[Answer](#)

173.

What English writer would have been a successful angler?

[Answer](#)

174.

What is that which you and every living man have seen, but can never see again?

[Answer](#)

175.

Which is the strongest day in the week?

[Answer](#)

176.

Come from my FIRST, aye, come!
The battle dawn is nigh;
And the screaming trump, and the thundering drum
Are calling thee to die.
Fight as thy fathers fought,
Fall as thy fathers fell;
Thy task is taught, thy shroud is wrought;
So, forward! and farewell!

Toll ye my SECOND, toll!
Fling high the flambeau's light;
And sing the hymn for the parted soul
Beneath the silent night.
The wreath upon his head,
The cross upon his breast,
Let the prayer be said, and the tear be shed,
So, take him to his rest!

Call ye my WHOLE, aye, call
The lord of lute and lay;
And let him greet the sable pall
With a noble song to-day.
Go, call him by his name;
No fitter hand may crave
To light the flame of a soldier's fame
On the turf of a soldier's grave.

[Answer](#)

177.

Oh, gloomy, gloomy, is my FIRST
To all who step within!
But doubly gloomy to the one
Who dwells there for his sin.

Oh, silent, silent, are the tongues
Of those who are my NEXT!
Oh, never be unkind to them,
Or with their failings vexed.

Oh, kindly fall sweet pity's words
Upon the outcast's heart!
My WHOLE will tell how oft they come
Their blessing to impart.

[Answer](#)

178.

What a common man often sees;
What a king or emperor seldom sees;
What GOD never sees?

[Answer](#)

179.

A shining wit pronounced, of late,
That every acting magistrate
Is water in a freezing state.

[Answer](#)

180.

I'm rough, I'm smooth, I'm wet, I'm dry;
My station low, my title high;
The king my lawful master is,—
I'm used by all, though only his.

[Answer](#)

181.

My FIRST'S a stream in classic land;
My SECOND all well understand
Who traveled much by public aid
Ere steam ingenious man obeyed.

My FIRST, when cut in two again,
Has part in shedding light 'mong men;
My SECOND, though 'tis no disgrace,
Writes wrinkles on the human face.

My WHOLE is not of recent birth,
But something proved of real worth,
Whose task is to facilitate
The movements of the Ship of State.

[Answer](#)

182.

I am a king; my palace low, yet rule I with extensive sway;
Great kings had Egypt long ago, but yet I reigned before their day;
To epicures my reign I owe more than to any other thing—
Though guillotine I undergo, it keeps me not from being king.
With head cut off, I am a king; with neck cut off and head left on,
I will be king: yes! I'll be king though head and neck should both be gone.
If head and foot I both should lose, a blood relation you'd espy;
For, then, a kin I would disclose: now tell, I pray, what king am I?

[Answer](#)

183.

My FIRST is in the cornfield seen;
My SECOND in the hedges green;
My WHOLE from glossy vines you glean.

[Answer](#)

184.

What is the smallest room in the world?

[Answer](#)

185.

What is often found where it does not exist?

[Answer](#)

186.

What is that which is lengthened by being cut at both ends?

[Answer](#)

187.

When do your teeth usurp the functions of your tongue?

[Answer](#)

188.

What word is that to which if you add one syllable, it will be shorter?

[Answer](#)

189.

What is that which is lower with a head than without one?

[Answer](#)

190.

What vice is that which people shun if they are ever so bad?

[Answer](#)

191.

Which travels at greater speed, heat or cold?

[Answer](#)

192.

My FIRST hath teeth, yet 'tis no man;
It hath no hands, yet work it can.
My NEXT hath teeth, for 'tis a man,
Or 'tis an herb dried on a pan.
My WHOLE hath *no* teeth: 'tis no man,
'Tis eaten oft by all his clan.

[Answer](#)

193.

A maid sat sewing in castle hall,
Near an arching window in the wall;
And again and again her song she rehearsed
As she placed on her lover's kerchief my FIRST,
For her lover was coming from foreign land
To give her his heart, and to claim her hand.

Ah! in foreign dungeon her lover lay,
Where stone on stone shut out every ray.
He never the hand of the maiden would clasp;
He was held by my SECOND'S iron grasp.

With feverish thirst he calls for drink—
Ere long he hears the rattle and clink
Of the jailer's keys, as he brings the cup,
And bids the prisoner drink it up.

Eagerly, quickly, he slakes his thirst.
Heaven pity the maid! In that draught accurst,
Is mingled my WHOLE; and, with failing breath,
The doomed man sinks in the arms of death.

[Answer](#)

194.

A word I am of letters seven,
A name to noble women given;
Take three away, (the last I mean,)
And I'm a man fit for a queen;
Remove one more, and, lo! you'll see
That I my former sex will be;
Another drop, and two remain
Which tell I am a man again.

[Answer](#)

195.

No rose can boast a lovelier hue
Than I can when my birth is new:
Of shorter date than e'en that flower,
I bloom and fade within an hour.

Though some in me their honor place,
I bear the stigma of disgrace;
Like *Marplot*, eager to reveal
The secret I would fain conceal.
Fools, coxcombs, wits, agree in this,
They equally destroy my peace;
Though 'gainst my will to stoop so low,
At their command I come and go.

[Answer](#)

196.

When a blind man drank tea, how did he manage to see?

[Answer](#)

197.

Why is a mouse like grass?

[Answer](#)

198.

What is the key-note of good breeding?

[Answer](#)

199.

What is the typical “Yankee’s” key-note?

[Answer](#)

200.

If you were on the second floor of a burning house and the stairs were away, how would you escape?

[Answer](#)

201.

My FIRST is nothing but a name;
My SECOND still more small;
My WHOLE is of so little fame,
It has no name at all.

[Answer](#)

202.

A carpenter made a door and made it too large; he cut it again and cut it too little; he cut it again and made it fit.

[Answer](#)

203.

A wagoner, being asked of what his load consisted, made the following (rather indirect) reply:

Three-fourths of a cross, and a circle complete;
An upright, where two semi-circles do meet;
A right-angled triangle standing on feet;
Two semi-circles, and a circle complete.

What is it?

[Answer](#)

204.

Why need people never suffer from hunger on such a desert as Sahara?

[Answer](#)

207.

How do the arks used for freight on the Mississippi River, differ from Noah's Ark?

[Answer](#)

208.

In what order did Noah leave the Ark?

[Answer](#)

209.

What is Majesty deprived of its externals?

[Answer](#)

210.

Dreaming of apples on a wall,
And dreaming often, dear,
I dreamed that if I counted all,
How many would appear?

[Answer](#)

211.

What is most like a bee in May?
“Well, let me think: perhaps—” you say;
Bravo! you’re guessing well to-day.

[Answer](#)

212.

Three sisters at breakfast were feeding the cat;
The first gave it sole: Puss was grateful for that;
The next gave it salmon, which Puss thought a treat;
The third gave it herring, which Puss wouldn’t eat.
(Explain the conduct of the cat.)

[Answer](#)

213.

John went out; his dog went with him; he went not before, behind, or on
one side of him; then where did he go?

[Answer](#)

214.

If spectacles could speak to their wearers, what ancient writer would
they name?

[Answer](#)

215.

Part of a foot with judgment transpose,
And the answer you’ll find just under your nose.

[Answer](#)

216.

A feeling all persons detest,
Although nearly by every one felt;
By two letters fully expressed,
By twice two invariably spelt.

[Answer](#)

217.

My FIRST implies equality; my SECOND is the title of a foreign nobleman; and my WHOLE is asked and given a hundred times a day with equal indifference; yet is of so much importance that it has saved the lives of thousands.

[Answer](#)

POSITIVES AND COMPARATIVES.

218.

Where runs the land far out into the sea,
The children shout and frolic in their glee.

[Answer](#)

219.

Among the singers half a score were found,
But not a voice so sweet as his in sound.

[Answer](#)

220.

He vowed he never would forgive,
Though twice two years and more he lived.

[Answer](#)

221.

The noble tree spread out its mighty arms,
Above the house bedecked in painted charms.

[Answer](#)

222.

He planted there his wheat and corn,
While birds flew high in early morn.

[Answer](#)

223.

He paid the lawyer when the suit was won,
Glad that his dread of sad defeat was done.

[Answer](#)

224.

The timid creature wildly looking 'round,
Shrinks back in deadly terror from the sound.

[Answer](#)

225.

He vowed to prosecute, because
A neighboring drain unsavory was.

[Answer](#)

226.

How would the Teuton manage to exist,
If this enchanting beverage he missed?

[Answer](#)

227.

How delightful 'twould be to recline at your ease,
And list to the harp, with its rare melodies!

[Answer](#)

228.

A gay young man, without ideas,
Oft wearies where he fain would please.

[Answer](#)

229.

Famed more for genius than good looks;
I went there to procure her books.

[Answer](#)

230.

The broad expanse, denied his waking sight,
He saw in visions both by day and night.

[Answer](#)

231.

It brought the miser to his grave;
Even his strong box could not save.

[Answer](#)

232.

1. Because he will not work for one,
2. The other he will be.

[Answer](#)

233.

1. The ship came gaily sailing in;
2. Now who so strong as he?

[Answer](#)

234.

1. If hungry, you may have it all;
2. A funeral pile, you see.

[Answer](#)

235.

1. Drive home your ball, and come and eat
2. The cakes prepared for tea.

[Answer](#)

236.

1. While the poet sang his “Farewell, thou sweet river!”
2. It roamed in forests near, as wild and free as ever.

[Answer](#)

237.

1. Add sugar, more sugar! His grimaces see!
2. Swift rider, bold robber, fierce savage is he.

[Answer](#)

238.

1. Hand the beverage 'round, adding cream as you go,
2. From the uppermost, down to the lowermost, row.

[Answer](#)

POSITIVES, COMPARATIVES, SUPERLATIVES.

239.

Pos., A pronoun; Com., A period of time; Sup., Fermenting froth.

[Answer](#)

240.

Pos., A knot of ribbon; Com., An animal; Sup., Self-praise.

[Answer](#)

241.

Pos., A reward; Com., Dread; Sup., A festival.

[Answer](#)

242.

Pos., To reward; Com., A fruit; Sup., An adhesive mixture.

[Answer](#)

243.

Pos., A meadow; Com., An unfortunate king; Sup., The smallest.

[Answer](#)

244.

Pos., In a regular line;
Com., With an appetite fine;
Sup., 'Twill be done when we dine.

[Answer](#)

245.

Pos., Busy, noisy, and cheerful.
Com., The thought of it saddening and tearful;
Sup., Its roar and its fierce claws are fearful.

[Answer](#)

246.

Pos., The end of all time;
Com., Judge of music and rhyme;
Sup., The Orient clime.

[Answer](#)

247.

Pos., Denotes a bond or tie;
Com., In the centre it doth lie;
Sup., The billows break on it and die.

[Answer](#)

248.

Pos., An American genius; Com., To turn out or to flow; Sup., An office, an express, a place, a piece of timber.

[Answer](#)

249.

Pos., To depart; Com., To wound; Sup., A visible spirit.

[Answer](#)

250.

Pos., Pleasant, dreary, wet or dry;
Com., If 'tis light or heavy, try,
On your scales, before you buy;
Sup., Don't spend money foolishly!

[Answer](#)

251.

A gentleman who had sent to a certain city for a car-load of fuel, wrote thus to his nephew residing there:

“Dear Nephew

;

Uncle John.”

Presently he received the following reply:

“Dear Uncle

:

James.”

[Answer](#)

252.

Why is a man up stairs, stealing, like a perfectly honorable man?

[Answer](#)

253.

Why is a ship twice as profitable *as a hen*?

[Answer](#)

254.

Why can you preserve fruit better by canning it, than in any other way?

[Answer](#)

255.

Twelve kinds of things in fact, not fiction,
Behind a veil of contradiction.

* * * * *

All dressed in silk, with stately grace,
We stand with ready ears,
And yet the sounds that greet the place
Not one among us hears.¹
We're keen and quick our holes to find
And run in lively mood,
And yet we're footless quite and blind,
Although our eyes are good.²

Our perfect heads can't give us sense,
 Though we are naught without them;³
Our useful tongues are mere pretense—
 No talk or taste about them.⁴
Our locks though fine can ne'er be combed;⁵
 Our teeth can never bite;⁶
Our mouths from out our heads have roamed,
 And oft outgrow them quite.⁷
Our hearts no pity have, or joy,
 Yet they're our richest worth;⁸
Our hands ne'er waved at girl or boy,
 Or anything on earth.⁹
Alive are we, yet buried quite;
 Our trust is in our eyes;
They help us out through darkest night,
 Though sight stern fate denies.¹⁰
We sally forth when day is done,
 And set the owls a-hooting,
And, though we have no bow or gun,
 We often go a-shooting.¹¹
Our souls, alas! are dull and low,
 Down-trodden, from the start;
Yet who shall say, in weal or wo,
 They're not our better part?¹²

[Answer](#)

256.

Within this world a creature once did dwell,
As sacred writings unto us do tell,
Who never shall be doomed to Satan's home,
Nor unto God's celestial Kingdom come;
Yet in him was a soul that either must
Suffer in Hell, or reign among the just.

[Answer](#)

257.

What best describes, and most impedes, a pilgrim's progress?

[Answer](#)

258.

Why is a girl not a noun?

[Answer](#)

259.

What part of their infant tuition have old maids and old bachelors most profited by?

[Answer](#)

260.

What is that which never asks any questions, and yet requires many answers?

[Answer](#)

261.

What quadrupeds are admitted to balls, operas, and dinner-parties?

[Answer](#)

262.

If a bear were to go into a linen-draper's shop, what would he want?

[Answer](#)

263.

When does truth cease to be truth?

[Answer](#)

264.

How many dog-stars are there?

[Answer](#)

265.

What is worse than raining cats and dogs?

[Answer](#)

266.

Why is O the only vowel that can be heard?

[Answer](#)

267.

Why is a man that has no children invisible?

[Answer](#)

268.

What is it which has a mouth, and never speaks; a bed, and never sleeps?

[Answer](#)

269.

Which burns longer, a wax or sperm candle?

[Answer](#)

270.

Why is a watch like an extremely modest person?

[Answer](#)

271.

LORD MACAULAY'S LAST RIDDLE.

Let us look at it quite closely,
'Tis a very ugly word,
And one that makes me shudder
Whenever it is heard.
It mayn't be very wicked;
It must be always bad,
And speaks of sin and suffering
Enough to make one mad.
They say it is a compound word,
And that is very true;
And, when they decompose it,
(Which, of course, they're free to do)—
If, of the letters they take off
And sever the first three,
They leave the nine remaining
As sad as they can be:
For, though it seems to make it less,
In fact it makes it more,
For it takes the brute creation in,
Which it left out before.

Let's try if we can mend it—
It's possible we may,

If only we divide it
In some new-fashioned way,
Instead of three and nine, then,
Let's make it four and eight;
You'll say it makes no difference,
At least not very great:
But only see the consequence!
That's all that needs be done
To change this mass of sadness
To unmitigated fun.
It clears off swords and pistols,
Revolvers, bowie-knives,
And all the horrid weapons
By which men lose their lives;
It wakens holier feelings—
And how joyfully is heard
The native sound of gladness
Compressed into one word!

Yes! four and eight, my friends!
Let that be yours and mine,
Though all the hosts of demons
Rejoice in three and nine.

[Answer](#)

272.

A word by grammarians used in our tongue,
Of such a construction is seen,
That if, from five syllables one is removed,
No syllable then will remain.

[Answer](#)

273.

Formed long ago, yet made to-day,
I'm most in use when others sleep;
What few would like to give away,
And none would like to keep.

[Answer](#)

274.

A lady was asked “What is Josh Billings’ real name? What do you think of his writings?” How did she answer both questions by one word?

[Answer](#)

275.

Why is Mr. Jones’ stock-farm, carried on by his boys, like the focus of a burning-glass?

[Answer](#)

276.

A by <. The name of a book, and of its author.

[Answer](#)

277.

What word in the English language contains the six vowels in alphabetical order?

[Answer](#)

278.

If the parlor fire needs replenishing, what hero of history could you name in ordering a servant to attend to it?

[Answer](#)

279.

My FIRST is an insect, my SECOND a quadruped, and my WHOLE has no real existence.

[Answer](#)

280.

If the roof of the Tower of London should blow off, what two names in English history would the uppermost rooms cry out?

[Answer](#)

281.

MY FIRST.

In the glance of the sun, when the wild birds sing,
I start in my beauty to gladden the spring;
I weep at the morning marriage, and smile
On the evening tomb, though I die the while.

MY SECOND.

I wander; I sin; though a breath may make
All my frame an effeminate nature take,
And a manly dignity that, as well,
Can of mastery and lordship tell.

MY WHOLE.

I have startled the world to jeering and mirth,
Since that, earthly, I dared to withdraw from the earth;
But I stay, though cut off in my prime, far more
Enlivening and life-full than ever before.

[Answer](#)

282.

One hundred and one by fifty divide,
Then, if you add naught to the right or left side,
The result will be one out of nine—have you tried?

[Answer](#)

283.

I am composed of five letters. As I stand, I am a river in Virginia, and a fraud. Beheaded, I am one of the sources of light and growth. Beheaded again, I sustain life; again, and I am a preposition. Omit my third, and I am a domestic animal in French, and the delight of social intercourse in English. Transpose my first four, and I become what may attack your head, if it is a weak one, in your efforts to find me out.

[Answer](#)

284.

Unto a certain numeral one letter join—sad fate!
What first was solitary, you now annihilate.

[Answer](#)

285.

My FIRST was heard to “hurtle in the sky,
When foes in conflict met in olden time”;
My SECOND none can yield without a sigh,
Though it has oft been forfeited by crime;
My WHOLE, its ancient uses gone, is found

On sunny uplands, or in forest ground.

[Answer](#)

286.

Can you tell me why
A hypocrite's eye
Can better descry
Than you can, or I,
Upon how many toes
A pussy-cat goes?

[Answer](#)

287.

Walked on earth,
Talked on earth,
 Boldly rebuked sin;
Never in Heaven,
Never in Hell,
 Never can *enter* in.

[Answer](#)

288.

There is a certain natural production that is neither animal, vegetable, nor mineral; it exists from two to six feet from the surface of the earth; it has neither length, breadth, nor substance; is neither male nor female, though it is found between both; it is often mentioned in the Old Testament, and strongly recommended in the New; and it answers equally the purposes of fidelity and treachery.

[Answer](#)

289.

We are little airy creatures,
All of different voice and features:
One of us in glass is set;
One of us is found in jet;
One of us is set in tin;
One a lump of gold within:
If the last you should pursue,
It can never fly from you.

[Answer](#)

290.

My FIRST is a point, my SECOND a span;
In my WHOLE often ends the greatness of man.

[Answer](#)

291.

Wherever English land
Touches the pebbly shore,
My FIRST lies on the sand,
Changing forevermore.
My SECOND oft, I'm told,
State secrets will hold fast,
But, to a key of gold
'Tis known to yield at last.
Fond mother, tender wife,
With agonizing soul,—
The exile, sick of life,—
Have looked and sighed my WHOLE.

[Answer](#)

292.

I begin with a thousand, I end with a hundred;
My middle's a thousand again;
The third of all vowels, the ninth of all letters,
Take their place in the rest of the train:
My WHOLE is a thing you never should do,—
At least, you don't like it, if tried upon you!

[Answer](#)

293.

A word which always speaks of shame
I pray you, reader, now to name:
Eleven parts my whole contains,
To guess them you must take some pains.

Three groups there be which stand related;
The first with many a word is mated:
The second speaks of favor rare;
The third of plenty everywhere.

Cut off the first; and shameful grows
As fair as any garden rose;
Cut off the last, and lo! 'tis plain,
The word is full of shame again.

[Answer](#)

294.

The eldest of four brothers did a sound business; the second, a smashing business; the third, a light business; and the youngest, the most wicked business. What were they?

[Answer](#)

295.

Cut off my head, and singular I am,
Cut off my tail, and plural I appear;
Cut off both head and tail, O wondrous fact!
My middle part remains, though naught is there.

What is my head cut off? A sounding sea.
What is my tail cut off? A roaring river.
Far in the ocean's depths I fearless play;
Giver of sweetest sounds, yet mute forever.

[Answer](#)

296.

I'm a creature most active, most useful, most known,
Of the thousands who daily perambulate town.
Take from me one letter, and still you will see
I'm the same as I was; just the same, to a T.
Take two letters from me, take three, or take four,
And still I remain just the same as before:
Indeed I may tell you, although you take all
You cannot destroy me, or change me at all.

[Answer](#)

297.

My FIRST is up at break of day,
And makes a welcome voice heard,
And goes to bed in twilight gray,
Though neither child nor song-bird.

My SECOND'S known to tongue and pen;
Is fast to all the church walls,
Is always seen in nurseries,
And often when the snow falls.

In green and yellow always dight,
Though melancholy never,

My WHOLE shines bright with golden light,
And emerald, forever.

[Answer](#)

298.

To fifty add nothing, then five,
Then add the first part of eighteen;
A desert would life be without it,
But with it, a garden, I ween.

[Answer](#)

299.

What tree bears the most fruit for the Boston market?

[Answer](#)

300.

Why is the end of a dog's tail, like the heart of a tree?

[Answer](#)

301.

Why is a fish-monger not likely to be generous?

[Answer](#)

302.

Take away my first five, and I am a tree. Take away my last five, and I am a vegetable. Without my last three, I am an ornament. Cut off my first and my last three, and I am a titled gentleman. From his name cut off the last letter, and an organ of sense will remain. Remove from this the last, and two parts of your head will be left.

Divide me into halves, and you find a fruit and an instrument of correction. Entire, I can be obtained of any druggist.

[Answer](#)

303.

Why was Elizabeth of England a more marvelous sovereign than Napoleon?

[Answer](#)

304.

A SQUARE-OF-EVERY-WORD PUZZLE.

I.

The desert-king,
Whose presence will
Each living thing
With terror fill.

II.

Of this word 'tis the mission
To be a preposition,
Giving you a notion
Of onward, inward, motion.

III.

This charm to blend,
The myriad roses of Cashmere you ask
Their subtle essences to one small flask
Freely to lend.

IV.

The middy, to his labor trained,
The sun by sextant viewed;
And said that Phœbus had attained
His greatest altitude.

[Answer](#)

305.

A prophet exists, whose generation was before Adam; who was with Noah in the Ark, and was present at the trial of our Lord. The only sermon he preached, was so convincing as to bring tears to the eyes and repentance to the heart of a sinner. He neither lies in a bed nor sits in a chair; his clothing is neither dyed, spun nor woven, but is of finest texture and most brilliant hue. His warning cry ought to call all sluggards from their slumbers: he utters it in every land and every age; and yet he is not the Wandering Jew.

[Answer](#)

306.

I have but six letters; I'm little, you see;
Yet millions of people have wondered at me;
My 2, 6, 5, 1, you possess, and yet seek;
My 6, 4, 1, renders the strongest man weak;
My 5, 3, 2, 1, is both pronoun and noun,
And my 5, 1, 2, often have builded a town;
To my 3, 5, 6, 4, 1, men sometimes have prayed,
And my 4, 6, 5, 1, through most forests have strayed;
My 6, 3, 5, *has* been to mystify you,
And devout men oft utter my 6, 5, 1, 2.

[Answer](#)

307.

(Fill the blanks with the names of British Authors.)

A —— upon the —— shore was seen,
I looked again, and it no —— was seen.

[Answer](#)

308.

A —— who of riches had great store,
Was fain to keep a —— upon his door.

[Answer](#)

309.

A —— trod the desert, —— and ——,
And, slow but sure of —— made good his way.

[Answer](#)

310.

I see with every man a thing
No man on earth hath ever seen;
Yet calm reflection still would bring
It face to face with him, I ween;
'Twould be before him plain as day,
Yet not be what he saw, I say.

[Answer](#)

311.

1. I have wings and I fly, though I'm not called a bird;

2. I am part of a hundred, e'en more than a third;
3. I am "A No. 1" with the most of mankind;
4. In France and in Germany me you will find;
5. My FIFTH in your hand you may frequently see;
6. And my WHOLE it is dreary and wretched to be.

[Answer](#)

312.

Blanks to be filled with the names of noted authors.

A little child, —, —, and full of grace,
Threw back her — and showed her smiling face;
Meek as the — she by a ribbon led,
As o'er the — in the — dawn she sped;
Fleet as the — when to the — the —
Called, and the sportsman — not at morn;
Against her — more than paltry gold,
I could not — my heart, however cold.

[Answer](#)

313.

You need not — my inquiring friend,
If, asking me if I am on the mend,
You find me still in no — frame;
Upon an — lay all the blame;
And though it may not — seem to mope,
I could not — my pain to please the —.

[Answer](#)

314.

Than myself in my normal condition, nothing could be lighter or more airy. I am composed of six letters and four syllables. Deprived of my first two and transposed, I am the haunt of wild beasts; transposed, I am a

human being more dangerous than a wild beast; transposed again, I am part of a fence; robbed of my last letter, and again transposed, I am a melody; or I am that noun without which there would be no such adjective as my WHOLE.

[Answer](#)

315.

CHRISTMAS DINNER.

The first course consisted of a linden tree, and some poles. The second, of a red-hot bar of iron, a country in Asia, and an ornament worn by Roman ladies, accompanied by a vegetable carefully prepared as follows: one-sixth of a carrot, one-fourth of a bean, one-half of a leaf of lettuce, and one-third of a cherry. For dessert, a pudding made of the interment of a tailor's implement; some points of time, and small cannon-shot from Hamburg.

[Answer](#)

316.

My FIRST can be a useful slave,
Obedient to your will;
Yet let him once the master be,
He'll ruin, rage, and kill.
To do my SECOND through the air,
Oft men have tried in vain,
Yet, if you look, you'll find it there,
Upon your window-pane.
My WHOLE on summer nights is seen
A fairy lamp to light the green.

[Answer](#)

317.

Seen more by day; heard more by night:
I help the old to better sight;
Chameleon-like, my food is air,
And dust to me is dainty fare.

[Answer](#)

NUTS TO CRACK.

318.

What nuts were essential to the safety of ancient cities?

[Answer](#)

319.

What nut is a garden vegetable?

[Answer](#)

320.

What nut is a dairy product?

[Answer](#)

321.

What nut is dear to bathers?

[Answer](#)

322.

What nut is used to store away things in?

[Answer](#)

323.

What nut is a breakfast beverage?

[Answer](#)

FOR AMATEUR GARDENERS.

324.

Plant the early dawn, and what flower will appear?

[Answer](#)

325.

What spring flowers are found in the track of an avalanche?

[Answer](#)

326.

What early vegetable most resembles a pain in the back?

[Answer](#)

327.

What flower is most cultivated by bad-tempered persons?

[Answer](#)

328.

If a dandy be planted, what tree will come up?

[Answer](#)

329.

Why is a gardener a most fortunate antiquary?

[Answer](#)

330.

What herbs will spoil your brood of chickens?

[Answer](#)

331.

Man cannot live without my FIRST;
By day and night 'tis used,
My SECOND, though disliked by all,
By none can be refused.
My WHOLE is never seen by day,
Nor ever seen by night;
Yet shows in eyes suffused with tears,
In faces wan and white.

[Answer](#)

332.

FIRST.

Something we too early sigh for;
What, through life, too hard we try for;
What, alas! too many die for.

SECOND.

Upon my SECOND, in a boat,
We lightly toss or idly float;
Or bathe within its wavelets clear,—
(The word to Tennyson is dear.)

THE WHOLE.

A lovely vale well known to fame,
Of which a fabric bears the name,
Well worthy of the proudest dame.

[Answer](#)

333.

My SECOND went to the side of my FIRST,
And stayed through the WHOLE for the air;
There were croquet and singing
And bathing and swinging,
And chatting with maidens so fair.

[Answer](#)

334.

Two heads I have, and when my voice
Is heard afar like thunder,
The lads and maids arrested stand,
And watch and wait with wonder.

Quite promptly I'm obeyed, and yet

'Tis only fair to say
My master bangs me right and left,
And him I must obey.

[Answer](#)

335.

I am useful on a farm, and on shipboard. Transpose me and I am not out of place on your tables, though I am most at home on the other side of the world. Change me to my original form, and remove my middle, and I become a part of your face.

[Answer](#)

POSITIVES AND COMPARATIVES.

336.

He brings his bill for service done
And straightway mounts his steed.

[Answer](#)

337.

The little rascal plays his pranks,
Then runs away with speed.

[Answer](#)

338.

Now see the youth with nimble tread

As step by step he mounts!

[Answer](#)

339.

How well the story he'll relate!
How rapidly he counts!

[Answer](#)

340.

Then give me but my Arab steed,
And well I'll shave his head.

[Answer](#)

341.

Oh! what a horrid, noisy bell!
The noontide meal is spread.

[Answer](#)

342.

It was myself—mistake me not—
Whose wrath was kindled at the thought.

[Answer](#)

343.

The sombre tree grew at the foot of the mountain:
Just where the pitcher we filled at the fountain.

[Answer](#)

344.

The debts he's contracted to you and to me,
By the silver that's in it, will canceled be.

[Answer](#)

345.

Beside the brook one summer day
When Nature all was merry,
I saw a gypsy maiden stray,
As brown as any berry.
She, with the limpid waters quenched her thirst,
And picked a simple salad of my FIRST.

The woodbine and the eglantine,
The clematis and mallow,
Delight to twine and interwine
Beside that streamlet shallow;
And, kissed by sunlight, and caressed by dews,
My SECOND in the ambient air diffuse.

The sun went down; the twilight fell;
Out shone the stars unnumbered;
Each flowret closed its honeyed cell,
And Nature softly slumbered.
While, pale and cold, across the heavens stole
In modest, maiden majesty, my WHOLE.

[Answer](#)

346.

The following puzzle was first published in 1628, and was reprinted in *Hone's Every-Day Book* for 1826:

A vessel sailed from a port in the Mediterranean, with thirty passengers, consisting of fifteen Jews and fifteen Christians. During the voyage a heavy storm arose, and it was found necessary to throw overboard one-half the passengers, in order to lighten the ship. After consultation, they agreed to a proposal from the captain, that he should place them all in a circle, and throw overboard every ninth man until only fifteen should be left. The treacherous wretch then arranged them in such a way, that all the Jews were thrown overboard, and all the Christians saved. In what order were they placed?

[Answer](#)

347.

pO^l

P_Ol

P_Ol

POL

ST

p^{ol}

P^oL

[Answer](#)

348.

A man building a barn, wished to place in it a window 3 ft. high by 3 ft. wide. But, finding there was not room enough, he had it made half the size intended, without altering height or width.

[Answer](#)

349.

PERSIAN RIDDLE.

Between a thickset hedge of bones,
A small, red dog now barks, now moans.

[Answer](#)

350.

I contain only two syllables. My FIRST implies plurality; my SECOND, sound health. My WHOLE is the name of a profligate earl who was the third husband of a queen noted alike for her beauty and her misfortunes. He died insane and in exile; and the beautiful queen, after being queen consort in one country, and reigning sovereign in another, spent nineteen years in captivity, and was finally beheaded on the 8th of January, 1587.

[Answer](#)

351.

A celebrated line from Shakespeare.

KIND

[Answer](#)

352.

The blacksmith with hammer of musical ——
Forges a chain of a ponderous ——
His hands are brawny and black as ——
But he loves his work as well
As his neighbor goldsmith at ease in a ——
Twisting fine gold to the size of a ——
And weaving a trifle light as ——
For the delicate ear of a belle.

[Answer](#)

353.

TRANSMUTATIONS.

1. A letter made crazy by being placed in order.
2. A letter becomes an island when surrounded by a belt.
3. A letter is pleased when set on fire.
4. A letter falls in love when it is beaten.
5. A letter is hated when it is examined.
6. A letter becomes a sailor when it leaves the house.
7. A letter is filled with crystals when it becomes a creditor.
8. A letter becomes musical when it is made thick.
9. A letter changes its shape when empty.
10. A letter is seen when it is spotted.
11. Another is seen when taken in hand.
12. When a letter is perforated it draws near the ocean.
13. It costs money for a letter to be thoughtful.
14. A letter is always slandered when it becomes noted.

What letters are they?

[Answer](#)

354.

My FIRST a liquid path is made
By something used in foreign trade.
My SECOND pours from out his throat
To weary ones a welcome note,
Coming, a sure and pleasant token
That winter's icy chain is broken.

My WHOLE I've found in purple bloom,
Or clothed in white 'mid forest gloom,
Leaves, petals, sepals, all in threes—
A triple triplet, if you please.

[Answer](#)

355.

On muster-day the boys were ——
Each nerve to show a splendid ——
When suddenly the cry, 'Tis ——
 Proclaims ill luck begun;
From fine cockades the beauty ——
Adown their uniforms are ——
 The streams that spoil their fun.
Crestfallen, homeward they are ——
When lo! a bright bow over ——
 Tells that the rain is done.

[Answer](#)

356.

Brilliant with white and golden light
 I blossom in the shade;
Emblem of purity and truth,
 Though of two falsehoods made.

[Answer](#)

357.

The egotist my FIRST employs
 To consummate his bliss,
The school-boy finds it in a noise,
 The lover in a kiss.
When on the field, in dread array,
Opposing legions wait the fray,

When trumpets sound and banners wave,
The watchword "Victory or the Grave"
Where'er my SECOND may be found,
The bravest knights will there abound.
What though my THIRD the soldier spurns
With undisguised disdain,
To it the farmer gladly turns
To cultivate the plain.
My WHOLE a gallant warrior's name,
The idol of the fair;
A wizard celebrates his fame—
You'll find my subject there.

[Answer](#)

358.

*A little word of syllables three,
Holds in its heart a mystery.*

I walk the earth; I climb the sky;
Full fierce below, serene on high;
I lead the field, I lead the fold,
I call to mind the fleece of gold.

Four times ten centuries ago,
When Abraham's shepherds watched by night,
Their flocks upon the fields below,
Above, the stars' mysterious light,
The heavenly host all followed one
Whose name proclaimed his mission high,
He "went before and led the way,"
We joined his train submissively.

At length, as centuries rolled on,
His leadership and prestige gone,
In turn *I* led the flocks on high,—
As on the earth, so in the sky.

When many centuries again
Had joined the eternal past,
I found the fate of all create
Was mine—was mine—at last!
And while, my ancient honors lost,
I yield to my changed destiny,
Another chief the starry host
In stately march precedes on high.

(To make the enigma more complete,
If to this word of syllables three,
A personal pronoun be prefixed,
The *three* reduced to *two* you'll see:
And this new word will just express
What everything earthly does in time,
Life's bitter sooner than its sweets,—
So end the riddle and the rhyme.)

[Answer](#)

359.

What kind of paper is most like a sneeze?

[Answer](#)

360.

Why did Edward Everett like to write his own name?

[Answer](#)

361.

Why would not the same name be a good exercise in writing?

[Answer](#)

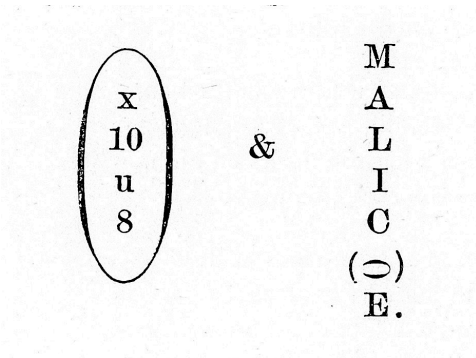
362.

A farmer had ten apple trees to plant. He desired to place them in five rows, having four in each row. This he succeeded in doing. How?

[Answer](#)

363.

Quotation from Shakespeare:



[Answer](#)

364.

One little boy said to another: “I have an own and only sister, but she has no brother.” How was that?

[Answer](#)

365.

If stately Edith give her ——
To Reginald, 'twill end my ——
For it transcends my utmost ——
To make a hero of a ——

[Answer](#)

366.

On grassy upland chirps the ——
Sad in the valley roams the ——
Thinking of bright hours too soon ——

Humming in misery “Non è ——”
He thinks not of the west so brightly ——
Nor listens to the faint and distant ——
But dreams of the false fair to whom is ——
The wo which never, never, will take ——.

[Answer](#)

367.

Convert the following into a couplet, perfect in rhyme and rhythm,
without adding or omitting a single letter:

“O Deborah, Deborah! wo unto thee
For thou art as deaf as a post.”

[Answer](#)

368.

One and the same word of two syllables, answers each of the following
triplets:

- I. MY FIRST springs in the mountains;
MY SECOND springs out of the mountains;
MY WHOLE comes with a spring over the mountains.
- II. MY FIRST runs up the trees;
MY SECOND runs past the trees;
MY WHOLE spreads over the trees.
- III. MY FIRST runs on two feet;
MY SECOND runs without feet;
MY WHOLE just glides away.
- IV. To catch MY FIRST, men march after it;
To capture MY SECOND, they march over it;
To possess MY WHOLE, they go through a march before it.

[Answer](#)

369.

Said the Moon to the Sun:
“Is the daylight begun?”
Said the Sun to the Moon:
“Not a moment too soon.

You’re a full Moon,” said he;
She replied, with a frown,
“Well! I never did see
So uncivil a clown!”

Query: Why was the Moon so angry?

[Answer](#)

370.

It is as high as all the stars,
No well was ever sunk so low;
It is in age five thousand years,
It was not born an hour ago.

It is as wet as water is;
No red-hot iron e’er was drier;
As dark as night, as cold as ice,
Shines like the sun, and burns like fire.

No soul, nor body to consume—
No fox more cunning, dunce more dull;
’Tis not on earth, ’tis in this room,
Hard as a stone, and soft as wool.

’Tis of no color, but of snow,
Outside and inside black as ink;
All red, all yellow, green and blue—
This moment you upon it think.

In every noise, this strikes your ear,
’Twill soon expire, ’twill ne’er decay;
Does always in the light appear,
And yet was never seen by day.

Than the whole earth it larger is,

Yet, than a small pin's point, 'tis less;
I'll tell you ten times what it is,
Yet after all, you shall not guess!

'Tis in your mouth, 'twas never nigh—
Where'er you look, you see it still;
'Twill make you laugh, 'twill make you cry;
You feel it plain, touch what you will.

[Answer](#)

371.

My FIRST, so faithful, fond and true,
Will ne'er forsake or injure you;
My SECOND, coming from the street
You often trample under feet;
My THIRD you sleep on every night,
Serene and calm, without affright;
My WHOLE is what you should not be
When talking with your friends or me.

[Answer](#)

372.

My FIRST is a little river in England that gave name to a celebrated university; my SECOND is always near; my THIRD sounds like several large bodies of water; and my WHOLE is the name of a Persian monarch, the neighing of whose horse gave him a kingdom and a crown.

[Answer](#)

373.

A horse in the midst of a meadow suppose,
Made fast to a stake by a line from his nose;
How long must this line be, that, feeding all 'round,
Permits him to graze just an acre of ground?

[Answer](#)

374.

FIRST, A house where man and beast
Find themselves at home;
SECOND, Greatest have and least
Wheresoe'er you roam;
THIRD, A pronoun, meaning many,
(You must add an L);
ALL, The manner of our meeting
When you ring my bell.

[Answer](#)

375.

A DINNER PARTY.

THE GUESTS,

(Who are chiefly Anachronisms and other Incongruities.)

The First: Escaped his foes by having his horse shod backward.

Second: Surnamed, The Wizard of the North.

3d: Dissolved pearls in wine; "herself being dissolved in love."

4th: Was first tutor to Alexander the Great.

5th: Said "There are no longer Pyrenees."

6th: The Puritan Poet.

7th: The Locksmith King.

8th: The woman "who drank up her husband."

9th: The Architect of St. Peter's, Rome.

10th: The Miner King.

11th: Surnamed The King Maker.

12th: The woman who married the murderer of her husband, and of her husband's father.

13th: The Architect of St. Paul's, London.

14th: The man who spoke fifty-eight languages; whom Byron called "a Walking Polyglot."

15th: A death-note, and a father's pride.

16th: The Bard of Ayrshire.

17th: The Knight "without fear, and without reproach."

18th: Refused, because he dared not accept, the crown of England.

19th: Whose vile maxim was "every man has his own price."

20th: The king who had an emperor for his foot-stool.

21st: The conqueror of the conqueror of Napoleon.

22d: The inventor of gunpowder.

23d: The king who entered the enemy's camp, disguised as a harper.

24th: The greatest English navigator of the eighteenth century.

25th: The inventor of the art of printing.

26th: Whom Napoleon called "the bravest of the brave."

27th: Who first discovered that the earth is round.

28th: The diplomatic conqueror of Napoleon.

29th: The inventor of the reflecting telescope.

30th: The conqueror of Pharsalia.

31st: The inventor of the safety lamp.

32d: First introduced tobacco into England.

33d: Discovered the Antarctic Continent.

34th: The present poet laureate of England.

35th: His immediate predecessor.

36th: The first of the line.

37th: Surnamed “the Madman of the North.”

38th: The young prince who carried a king captive to England.

39th: First sailed around the world.

40th: Said “language was given us to enable us to conceal our thoughts.”

41st: The Father of History.

DISHES, RELISHES, DESSERT.

1: Natural caskets of valuable gems.

2: Material and immaterial.

3: The possessive case of a pronoun and an ornament.

4: A sign of the zodiac, (pluralized).

5: One-third of Cesar’s celebrated letter, and the centre of the solar system.

6: Where Charles XII. went after the battle of Pultowa.

7: Whose English namesake Pope called “the brightest, wisest, meanest of mankind.”

8: A celebrated English essayist.

9: Formerly a workman’s implement.

10: The ornamental part of the head.

11: An island in Lake Ontario.

12: Timber, and the herald of the morning.

13: A share in a rocky pathway.

14: The unruly member.

15: The earth, and a useful article.

- 16: An iron vessel, and eight ciphers.
- 17: A letter placed before what sufferers long for.
- 18: Like values, and odd ends.
- 19: A preposition, a piece of furniture, and a vowel, (pluralized).
- 20: An insect, followed by a letter, (pluralized).
- 21: The employment of some women, and the dread of all.
- 22: A kind of carriage, and a period of time.
- 23: A net for the head, an organ of sense, an emblem of beauty.
- 24: By adding two letters, you'll have an Eastern conqueror.
- 25: Five-sevenths of a name not wholly unconnected with Bleak House and Borrioboola Gha.
- 26: An underground room, and a vowel.
- 27: Skill, part of a needle, and to suffocate, (pluralized).
- 28: Antics.
- 29: An intimation burdens.
- 30: What if it should lose its savor?
- 31: Where you live a contented life; a hotel, and a vowel.
- 32: The staff of life.
- 33: What England will never become.
- 34: Scourges.
- 35: Running streams.
- 36: A domestic fowl, and the fruit of shrubs.
- 37: Married people.
- 38: A Holland prince serene, (pluralized).
- 39: To waste away, and Eve's temptation, (pluralized).
- 40: Four-fifths of a month, and a dwelling, (pluralized).

41: Busybodies.

42: What Jeremiah saw in a vision.

43: Very old monkeys.

44: Approach convulsions.

45: Small blocks for holding bolts.

[Answer](#)

UNGUESSED RIDDLES.

As, on Louis Gaylord Clarke's authority, "no museum is complete without the club that killed Captain Cook"—he had seen it in six—so no collection of riddles can be considered even presentable without the famous enigma so often republished, and always with the promise of "£50 reward for a solution." It was first printed in the *Gentlemen's Magazine*, London, in March, 1757.

The compiler of this little book has no hope of winning the prize, and leaves the lists open to her readers, with a hope that some one of them may succeed in "guessing" not only this, but the next riddle, of whose true answer she has not the faintest idea.

The noblest object in the works of art;
The brightest scenes which Nature can impart;
The well-known signal in the time of peace;
The point essential in a tenant's lease;
The farmer's comfort as he drives the plough;
A soldier's duty, and a lover's vow;
A contract made before the nuptial tie;
A blessing riches never can supply;
A spot that adds new charms to pretty faces;
An engine used in fundamental cases;
A planet seen between the earth and sun;
A prize that merit never yet has won;
A loss which prudence seldom can retrieve;
The death of Judas, and the fall of Eve;
A part between the ancle and the knee;
A Papist's toast, and a physician's fee;
A wife's ambition, and a parson's dues;
A miser's idol, and the badge of Jews.
If now, your happy genius can divine
The corresponding word in every line,
By the first letter plainly may be found
An ancient city that is much renowned.

The other unguessed, if not unguessable, riddle claims to come from Cambridge, and is as follows:

A Headless man had a letter to write;

It was read by one who had lost his sight;
The Dumb repeated it, word for word;
And he was Deaf who listened and heard.

([See Key.](#))

QUESTIONS NOT TO BE ANSWERED UNTIL THE WORLD IS WISER.

Considering how useful the ocean is to mankind, are poets justified in calling it “a waste of waters”?

How can we catch *soft* water when it is raining hard?

Where is the chair that “Verbum sat” in?

How does it happen that *Fast* days are always provokingly *slow* days?

How is it that a storm looks heavy when it keeps lightening? And the darker it grows, the more it lightens?

When it is said of a man that “he never forgets himself,” are we to understand that his conduct is absolute perfection, or that it is the perfection of selfishness?

PARADOXES.

1st. Polus instructed Ctesiphon in the art of pleading. Teacher and pupil agreed that the tuition-fee should be paid when the latter should win his first case. Some time having gone by, and the young man being still without case or client, Polus, in despair of his fee, brought the matter before the Court, each party pleading his own cause. Polus spoke first, as follows:

“It is indifferent to me how the Court may decide this case. For, if the decision be in my favor, I recover my fee by virtue of the judgment; but, if my opponent wins the case, this being his first, I obtain my fee according to the contract.”

Ctesiphon, being called on for his defense, said:

“The decision of the Court is indifferent to *me*. For, if in my favor, I am thereby released from my debt to Polus. But, if I lose the case, the fee cannot be demanded, according to our contract.”

2d. A certain king once built a bridge, and decreed that all persons about to cross it, should be interrogated as to their destination. If they told the truth they should be permitted to pass unharmed; but, if they answered falsely, they should be hanged on a gallows erected at the centre of the bridge. One day a man, about to cross, was asked the usual question, and replied:

“I am going to be hanged on that gallows!”

Now, if they hanged him, he had told the truth, and ought to have escaped; but, if they did not hang him, he had “answered falsely,” and ought to have suffered the penalty of the law.

PART II.

FANCY TITLES FOR BOOKS.

*Furnished by Thomas Hood for a blind door in the Library at Chatsworth,
for his friend the Duke of Devonshire.*

Percy Vere. In Forty Volumes.

Dante's Inferno; or Descriptions of Van Demon's Land.

Ye Devyle on Two Styx: (black letter).

Lamb's Recollections of Suet.

Lamb on the Death of Wolfe.

Plurality of Livings: with Regard to the Common Cat.

Boyle on Steam.

Blaine on Equestrian Burglary; or the Breaking-in of Horses.

John Knox on Death's Door.

Peel on Bell's System.

Life of Jack Ketch, with Cuts of his own Execution.

Cursory Remarks upon Swearing.

Cook's Specimens of the Sandwich Tongue.

Recollections of Banister. By Lord Stair.

On the Affinity of the Death-Watch and Sheep-Tick.

Malthus' Attacks of Infantry.

McAdam's Views of Rhodes.

The Life of Zimmermann. By Himself.

Pygmalion. By Lord Bacon.

Rules of Punctuation. By a Thoroughbred Pointer.

Chronological Account of the Date Tree.

Kosciusko on the Right of the Poles to Stick up for Themselves.

Prize Poems. In Blank Verse.

Shelley's Conchology.

Chantry on the Sculpture of the Chipaway Indians.

The Scottish Boccaccio. By D. Cameron.

Hoyle on the Game Laws.

Johnson's Contradictionary.

When Hood and his family were living at Ostend for economy's sake, and with the same motive Mrs. Hood was doing her own work, as we phrase it, he wrote to a friend in England: "Jane is becoming an excellent cook and housemaid, and I intend to raise her wages. She had nothing a week before, and now I mean to double it."

It has been estimated that of all possible or impossible ways of earning an honest livelihood, the most arduous, and at the same time the way which would secure the greatest good to the greatest number, would be to go around, cold nights, and get into bed for people! To this might be added, going around cold mornings and getting up for people; and, most useful and most onerous of all, going around among undecided people and making up their minds.

In these days of universal condensation—of condensed milk, condensed meats, condensed news—perhaps no achievement of that kind ought to surprise us; but it must be acknowledged that Thackeray's condensing feat

was the most extraordinary on record. To compress “The Sorrows of Werther”—that three volumed novel: a book of size—and tears, full of pathos and prettiness, of devotion and desperation—into four stanzas that tell the whole story, was a triumph of art which—which it is very possible GOETHE would admire less than we do.

Werther had a love for Charlotte
Such as words can never utter.
Would you know how first he met her?
She was cutting bread and butter.

Charlotte was a married lady,
And a moral man was Werther,
And, for all the wealth of Indies,
Would do nothing for to hurt her.

So he sighed, and pined, and ogled,
And his passion boiled and bubbled,
Till he blew his silly brains out,
And no more was by it troubled.

Charlotte, when she saw his body
Borne before her on a shutter,
Like a well conducted person,
Went on cutting bread and butter.

Theodore Hook was celebrated not more for his marvelous readiness in rhyming than for the quality of the rhymes themselves. In his hands the English language seemed to have no choice: plain prose appeared impossible. Motley was the only wear; fantastic verse the only method of expression. No less does he press into his service phrases from the languages, as in the curious verses which follow, in praise of

CLUBS.

If any man loves comfort and
Has little cash to buy it, he
Should get into a crowded club—
A most select society!

While solitude and mutton cutlets
Serve *infelix uxor*, he

May have his club (like Hercules),
And revel there in luxury.

Here's first the Athenæum club,
So wise, there's not a man of it
That has not sense enough for six;
(In fact, that is the plan of it).

The very waiters answer you
With eloquence Socratical,
And always lay the knives and forks
In order mathematical.

The Union Club is quite superb;
Its best apartment daily is
The lounge of lawyers, doctors, beaux,
Merchants, *cum multis aliis*.

The Travellers are in Pall Mall,
And smoke cigars so cozily,
And dream they climb the highest Alps,
Or rove the plains of Moselai.

These are the stages which all men
Propose to play their parts upon;
For *clubs* are what the Londoners
Have clearly set their *hearts* upon.

OTHER WORLDS.

Mr. Mortimer Collins indulges in sundry very odd speculations concerning them.

Other worlds! Those planets evermore
In their golden orbits swiftly glide on;
From quick Hermes by the solar shore,
To remote Poseidon.

Are they like this world? The glory shed
From the ruddy dawn's unfading portals?
Does it fall on regions tenanted
By a race of mortals?

Are there merry maidens, wicked-eyed,
Peeping slyly through the cottage lattice?
Have they vintage bearing countries wide?
Have they oyster patties?

Does a mighty ocean roar and break
On dark rocks and sandy shores fantastic?
Have they any Darwins there, to make
Theories elastic?

Does their weather change? November fog,
Weeping April, March with many a raw gust?
And do thunder and demented dog
Come to them in August?

Nineteenth century science should unravel
All these queries, but has somehow missed 'em.
When will it be possible to travel
Through the solar system?

STILTS.

Behold the mansion reared by dædal Jack,
See the malt stored in many a plethoric sack,
In the proud cirque of Ivan's bivouac.
Mark how the Rat's felonious fangs invade
The golden stores in John's pavilion laid.
Anon, with velvet foot and Tarquin strides,
Subtle Grimalkin to his quarry glides—
Grimalkin grim, that slew the fierce *rodent*,
Whose tooth insidious Johann's sackcloth rent.
Lo! now the deep mouthed canine foe's assault,
That vexed the avenger of the stolen malt,
Stored in the hallowed precincts of the hall,
That rose complete at Jack's creative call.
Here stalks the impetuous Cow with crumpled horn,
Whereon the exacerbating hound was torn,
Who bayed the feline slaughter beast that slew
The Rat predacious, whose keen fangs ran through
The textile fibres that involved the grain,
That lay in Hans' inviolate domain.
Here walks forlorn the Damsel crowned with rue,
Lactiferous spoils from vaccine dugs who drew,
Of that corniculate beast whose tortuous horn
Tossed to the clouds, in fierce, vindictive scorn,
The harrying hound whose braggart bark and stir
Arched the lithe spine and reared the indignant fur
Of Puss, that with verminicidal claw,
Struck the weird Rat, in whose insatiate maw
Lay reeking malt, that erst in Ivan's courts we saw.

Robed in senescent garb that seems, in sooth,
Too long a prey to Chronos' iron tooth;
Behold the man whose amorous lips incline,
Full with young Eros' osculative sign,
To the lorn maiden, whose lac-albic hands
Drew albu-lactic wealth from lacteal glands
Of the immortal bovine, by whose horn
Distort, to realm ethereal was borne
The beast catulean, vexer of that sly
Ulysses quadrupedal, who made die
The old mordacious Rat, that dared devour
Antecedaneous ale, in John's domestic bower.
Lo here, with hirsute honors doffed, succinct
Of saponaceous lock, the Priest, who linked
In Hymen's golden bands the torn unthrift,
Whose means exiguous stared from many a rift,
Even as he kissed the virgin all forlorn,
Who milked the cow with implicated horn,
Who in fine wrath the canine torturer skied,
That dared to vex the insidious muricide,
Who let the auroral effluence through the pelt
Of the sly Rat that robbed the palace Jack had built.
The loud, cantankerous Shanghai comes at last,
Whose shouts aroused the shorn ecclesiast,
Who sealed the vows of Hymen's sacrament,
To him who robed in garments indigent,
Exosculates the damsel lachrymose,
The emulgator of that hornèd brute morose,
That tossed the dog, that worried the cat, that *kilt*
The rat, that ate the malt, that lay in the house that Jack built.

The *Home Journal* having published a set of rather finical rules for the conduct of equestrians in Central Park, a writer in *Vanity Fair* supplemented and satirized them as follows:

ETIQUETTE OF EQUITATION.

When a gentleman is to accompany a lady on horseback,

1st. There must be two horses. (Pillions are out of fashion, except in some parts of Wales, Australia and New Jersey.)

2d. One horse must have a side saddle. The gentleman will not mount this horse. By bearing this rule in mind he will soon find no difficulty in recognizing his own steed.

3d. The gentleman will assist the lady to mount and adjust her foot in the stirrup. There being but one stirrup, he will learn upon which side to assist the lady after very little practice.

4th. He will then mount himself. As there are two stirrups to his saddle, he may mount on either side, but by no means on both; at least, not at the same time. The former is generally considered the most graceful method of mounting. If he has known Mr. Rarey he may mount without the aid of stirrups. If not, he may try, but will probably fail.

5th. The gentleman should always ride on the right side of the lady. According to some authorities, the right side is the left. According to others, the other is the right. If the gentleman is left handed, this will of course make a difference. Should he be ambidexter, it will be indifferent.

6th. If the gentleman and lady meet persons on the road, these will probably be strangers, that is if they are not acquaintances. In either case the gentleman and lady must govern themselves accordingly. Perhaps the latter is the evidence of highest breeding.

7th. If they be going in different directions, they will not be expected to ride in company, nor must these request those to turn and join the others; and *vice versa*. This is indecorous, and indicates a lack of *savoir faire*.

8th. If the gentleman's horse throw him he must not expect him to pick him up, nor the lady; but otherwise the lady may. This is important to be borne in mind by both.

9th. On their return, the gentleman will dismount first and assist the lady from her horse, but he must not expect the same courtesy in return.

N. B.—These rules apply equally to every species of equitation, as pony riding, donkey riding, rocking horse riding, or "riding on a rail." There will, of course, be modifications required, according to the form and style of the animal.

SONG OF THE RECENT REBELLION.

AIR: "Lord Lovell."

Lord Lovell he sat in St. Charles' Hotel,
In St. Charles' Hotel sat he;
As fine a case of a rebel swell,
As ever you'd wish to see, see, see,
As ever you'd wish to see!

Lord Lovell the town had sworn to defend,
A-waving his sword on high;
He swore that the last ounce of powder he'd spend,
And in the last ditch he would die, die, die,
And in the last ditch he would die.

He swore by black and he swore by blue,

He swore by the stars and bars,
That never he'd fly from a Yankee crew
While he was a son of Mars, Mars, Mars,
While he was a son of Mars.

He had fifty thousand gal-li-ant men,
Fifty thousand men had he,
Who had all sworn with him they would never surren-
Der to any tarnation Yankee, kee, kee,
To any tarnation Yankee.

Sir Farragut came with a mighty fleet;
With a mighty fleet came he;
And Lord Lovell instanter began to retreat,
Before the first boat he could see, see, see,
Before the first boat he could see.

His "fifty thousand gal-li-ant men"
Dwindled down to thousands six,
Who heard a distant cannon, and then,
Commenced a-cutting their sticks, sticks, sticks—
Commenced a-cutting their sticks.

"Oh, tarry, Lord Lovell!" Sir Farragut cried;
"Oh, tarry, Lord Lovell!" cried he;
"I rather think not," Lord Lovell replied,
"For I'm in a great hurree, ree, ree,
For I'm in a great hurree!"

"I like the drinks at St. Charles' Hotel,
But I never could bear strong Porter,
Especially when it is served in a shell,
Or mixed in an iron mortar!"

"I reckon you're right," Sir Farragut said,
"I reckon you're right," said he;
"For if my PORTER should fly to your head,
A terrible crash there'd be, be, be,
A terrible crash there'd be!"

Oh, a wonder it was to see them run!
A wonderful thing to see—
And the Yankees sailed up without shooting a gun,
And captured their great citee, tee, tee,
And captured their great citee.

Lord Lovell kept running all day and all night,
Lord Lovell a-running kept he,
For he swore that he couldn't abide the sight
Of the gun of a live Yankee, kee, kee,
Of the gun of a live Yankee.

When Lord Lovell's life was brought to a close
By a sharp-shooting Yankee gunner,
From his head there sprouted a red, red—nose,
From his feet a scarlet runner!

OTHER PARODIES.

“Come into the garden, Maud!”

Come out in the garden, Jane,
For the black bear, night, has run,
Come out in the garden, Jane,
It's time the party was done;
And the chickens commence to cackle again,
And the cocks crow, one by one.

For a breeze begins to blow,
And the planet of Jupiter, he,
Grows shaky and pale, as the dawn, you know,
Comes striding over the sea;
Grows pale, as the dawn keeps coming, you know,
Grows paler and paler to be.

All night have the tulips shaken,
At the noise of the fiddle and drum,
All night has the trumpet-vine quivered and quaked,
As the sounds of the dancing have come;
Till the chickens and cocks in the hen-roost waked,
And they stopped the fiddle and drum.

I said to the tulip, “It's I,” says I,
Whom she likes best of them all;
“When will they let her alone?” says I,
“She's tired I know of the ball.
Now part of the folks have said good-bye,
And part are now in the hall;
They'll all be off directly,” says I,
“And then I'm over the wall.”

I said to the pink, “Nigh over, I think,
The dancing and glancing and fun:
O young Lloyd Lever, your hopes will sink
When you find the charmer is won!
We're one, we're one,” I remarked to the pink,
“In spirit already one.”

And the red of the pink went into my face,
As I thought of your sweet “I will;”

And long I stood in that slippery place,
For I heard our waterfall spill,
Spill over the rocks and run on in the race,
The mill-race down by the mill,
From the tree where I feebly stated my case,
To the fence where you answered "I will."

The drowsy buttercup went to bed
Nor left a lock of her hair;
The great sunflower he nodded his head
And the poppy snored in his chair;
But the pink wasn't sleepy at all, she said,
Wishing my pleasure to share,
No tulip or pink of them cared for bed,
They knew I expected you there.

Queen pink of the feminine pinks in there,
Come out in the garden to me,
In the velvet basque, silk-lined you wear,
Queen pink and tulip you be:
Bob out little face, running over with hair,
And let the hollyhocks see.

Is that the marigold's laugh I hear,
Or the sound of her foot as 't fell?
She is coming, my duck, my dear;
She is coming, my bird, my belle.
The blood-pink cries; "She is near, she is near,"
And the pale pink sobs: "Do tell!"
The snap-dragon says: "D'you see her? D'you see her?"
And the tulip, "Yes, there by the well!"

She is coming, my joy, my pet,
Let her trip it, soft as she chose,
My pulses would livelier get
Were I dying there under the rose;
My blood flow rapider yet
Were I buried down under the rose,
Would start and trickle out ruby and wet
And bubble wherever she goes.

CLEON HATH A MILLION ACRES.

Brown has pockets running over,
Ne'er a dime have I;
Brown he has a wife and children,

Bachelor am I;
Brown he has a dozen servants,
One of 'em am I;
Yet the poorest of us couple
's Brown; I'll tell you why.

Brown, 'tis true, possesseth dollars,
All creation I;
And the income that it gives me
Lieth in my eye.

Brown he is a sleepy fellow,
Wide-awake am I;
He in broad-cloth, I in tow-cloth,
Handsomest am I.

Brown has had no education;
Mine you couldn't buy;
He don't know we call him "noodle,"
I assert it, I;
Brown, I tell you you're a noodle,
Noodle you will die;
Who speaks first to change conditions?
—I declare—it's I!

“WHEN I THINK OF MY BELOVED.”

(Algonquin Song, in “Hiawatha.”)

When I think of him I love so,
Oh lor! think of him I love so,
When I am a-thinking of him—
Ouch! my sweetheart, my Bee-no-nee!

Oh lor! when we left each other
He presented me a thimble—
As a pledge, a silver thimble,
Ouch! my sweetheart, my Bee-no-nee!

“I'll go 'long with you,” he whispered,
Oh lor! to the place you come from;
“Let me go along,” he whispered,—
Ouch! my sweetheart, my Bee-no-nee!

“It's awful fur, full fur,” I answered,
“Fur away it is,” I answered,
“Oh lor! yes, the place I come from—”
Ouch! my sweetheart, my Bee-no-nee!

As I looked 'round for to see him,
Where I left him for to see him,
He was looking for to see me—
Ouch! my sweetheart, my Bee-no-nee!

On the log he was a-sitting,
On the hollow log a-sitting,
That was chopped down by somebody—
Ouch! my sweetheart, my Bee-no-nee!

When I think of him I love so,
Oh lor! think of him I love so,
When I am a-thinking of him—
Ouch! my sweetheart, my Bee-no-nee!
(*From "Milkanwatha."*)

“NEVER STOOPS THE SOARING VULTURE.”

(*Also from "Milkanwatha."*)

Never jumps a sheep that's frightened,
Over any fence whatever,
Over wall, or fence, or timber,
But a second follows after,
And a third, upon the second,
And a fourth, and fifth, and so on,
First a sheep, and then a dozen,
Till they all, in quick succession,
One by one have got clean over.

So misfortunes almost always,
Follow after one another,
Seem to watch each other always;
When they see the tail uplifted,
In the air the tail uplifted,
As the sorrow leapeth over;
Lo! they follow, thicker, faster,
Till the air of earth seems darkened
With the tails of sad misfortunes,
Till our heart within us, weary,
Cry out: "Are there more a-coming?"

THE FALLS OF LODORE.

“Rising and leaping, sinking and creeping,
Striking and raging, as if a war waging,
All around and around, with endless rebound,
 Confounding, astounding,
Dizzying and deafening the ear with its sound!

“Recoiling, turmoiling, and toiling and boiling,
And dashing, and flashing, and splashing and crashing,
All at once, and all o’er, with a mighty uproar;
And THIS way the water comes down at Lodore!”

A disappointed, “disillusioned,” tourist expresses below *his* view of the subject, which slightly differs from Southey’s.

Do you want to be told how it is that the water
 Comes down at Lodore?
 Why then I’m the man
 Of all others, that can,
Or, rather, the man of all others, that *ought* to
 Be able to tell you, without any more
 Fuss;
 Thus!

 Behind a small cavern,
 Suppose a dark cavern,
 Or ravine, more correctly,
 From whose summit directly
 As from a stone pitcher,
 Out of the which, a
 Volume of fluid
 Enough for a Druid
 To wade to his knees in,
 Pours out unceasin’-
 Gly down, and not up;
 Which would be a sup-
 Position so very
 To nature contrary,
 That it couldn’t be thought a
 Supposable case,
 For a cascade of water
 On any man’s place;
 Much more, at Lodore,
Where the water has always come down, heretofore.
 Down deep precipices,
 And awful abysses,
 Ten feet, or fifteen,
 The water is seen
 To drip, skip, trip, slip, dip

A gill in a minute, in great agitation;
Then goes it again,
With a very perpen-
Dicular smash, dash, splash, crash;
A pint, at the least calculation!
Making no bones
Of wetting the stones,
Which can't get out,
But wriggle about,
A whole quart of the cascade has got 'em;
And the way they go
Down, isn't slow;
Rumble, and jumble, and tumble;
Hip, hop, drop, whop, stop!
A gallon has got to the bottom!

And the moral of that is, said the Duchess, that tourists shouldn't see
NIAGARA before they visit Lodore.

“TELL ME, YE WINGED WINDS.”

Tell me, my secret soul,
Oh, tell me, Hope and Faith,
Is there no resting-place
From women, girls, and death?
Is there no happy spot
Where bachelors are blessed,
Where females never go,
And men escape that pest?
Faith, Hope, and Love, best boon to mortals given,
Waved their bright wings, and whispered, “Yes, in Heaven!”

SEEING IS BELIEVING: SEEING IS DECEIVING.

Here is a row of capital letters, and of figures, of ordinary size and
shapes:

SSSSXXXXZZZZ33338888

They are such as are made up of two parts, of similar form. Look
carefully at these, and you will perceive that the upper halves of the

characters are a very little smaller than the lower halves—so little that, at a mere glance, we should declare them to be of equal size. Now, turn the page upside down, and, without any careful looking, you will see that this difference in size is very much exaggerated—that the real top half of the letter is very much smaller than the other half. It will be seen by this that there is a tendency in the eye to enlarge the upper part of any object upon which it looks. Thus two circles of unequal size might be drawn and so placed that they would appear exactly alike.

SSSSXXXXZZZZ3338888

2222XXXXSSSS3338888

FANTASTIC NAMES.

An Ohio lady told me that she knew three young ladies belonging to one family, named severally:

Regina, Florida Geneva, and Missouri Iowa. And that an ill-starred child, born about the time of the first Atlantic cable *furor*, was threatened with the name of *Atalanta Telegrapha Cabelletta*!

The cable collapsed, and the child escaped; but a young lady of Columbus, born January 1, 1863, was less fortunate. She was named by her parents in honor of the event of that day, *Emancipation Proclamation*, and is known by the pet name “Proklio.”

I knew a boy named *Chief Justice Marshall*; a young man, (greatness was thrust upon him,) named *Commodore Perry V——r*, and have been told of a little girl named by her novel-loving mother, *Lady Helen Mar*.

Mrs. C., of Western New York, was, in her girlhood, acquainted with a boy who by no means “rejoiced in the name” of *John Jerome Jeremiah Anseus P. S. Brown McB——e*.

A colored woman in Dunkirk named her infant son in honor of two lawyers there: *Thomas P. Grosvenor William O. Stevens D——s*; and, at an Industrial school in Detroit, there was some years ago a colored boy named

Nicholas Evans Esquire Providence United States of America Jefferson Davis B——s.

In Cazenovia there once lived a young lady named *Encyclopedia Britannica D——y*.

There, too, Messrs. *Hyde* and *Coop* lived side by side for several years. Then Mr. *Hyde* moved out of town, and spoiled that little game.

It was noted as a coincidence when a Mr. *Conkrite*, of Tecumseh, Mich., sold his dwelling-house and lot to Mrs. *Cronkite*.

A farmer in Allegany county, N. Y., named his children *Wilhelmina Rosalinda, Sobriski Lowanda, Eugertha Emily, Hiram Orlaska, Monterey Maria* and *Delwin Dacosti*. The following are also vouched for as genuine American names: *Direxa Polyxany Dodge, Hostalina Hypermnestra Meacham, Keren Habuch Moore* and *Missouri Arkansas Ward*.

There lived in Greenfield, N. Y., a certain Captain *Parasol*; and, at Niagara Falls, for a time, a Methodist minister named *Alabaster*.

I have lately heard of a Mrs. *Achilles*, a Mr. and Mrs. *December*, a *John January*, and a Mr. *Greengrass*; and of an Indiana girl, at school in Cincinnati, named *Laura Eusebia Debutts Miranda M’Kinn Parron Isabella Isadora Virginia Lucretia A——p*.

In 1874 one of the young ladies at a certain convent school in West Virginia, was Miss *Claudia Deburnabue Bellinger Mary Joseph N——p*.

The following are names of stations on the “E. and N. A. Railway,” New Brunswick: *Quispamsis, Nanwigewank, Ossekeag, Passekeag, Apohaqui, Plumweseep, Penobsquis, Anagance, Petitcodiac, Shediack, Point du Chene*; and we should particularly like to hear a conductor sing them.

LADIES’ NAMES.

Their Sound.

There is a strange deformity,
Combined with countless graces,
As often in the ladies’ names
As in the ladies’ faces.

Some names are fit for every age,
Some only fit for youth;
Some passing sweet and musical,
Some horribly uncouth;
Some fit for dames of loftiest grades,
Some only fit for scullery maids.

Ann is too plain and common,
And Nancy sounds but ill;
Yet Anna is endurable,
And Annie better still.
There is a grace in Charlotte,
In Eleanor a state,
An elegance in Isabelle,
A haughtiness in Kate:
And Sara is sedate and neat,
And Ellen innocent and sweet.

Matilda has a sickly sound,
Fit for a nurse's trade;
Sophia is effeminate,
And Esther sage and staid;
Elizabeth's a matchless name,
Fit for a queen to wear—
In castle, cottage, hut or hall,
A name beyond compare:
And Bess and Bessie follow well,
But Betsy is detestable.

Maria is too forward,
And Gertrude is too gruff,
Yet, coupled with a pretty face,
Is pretty name enough:
And Adelaide is fanciful,
And Laura is too fine,

But Emily is beautiful,
And Mary is divine;
Maud only suits a high-born dame,
And Fanny is a baby name.

Eliza is not very choice,
Jane is too blunt and bold,
And Martha somewhat sorrowful,
And Lucy proud and cold.
Amelia is too light and gay,
Fit only for a flirt,
And Caroline is vain and shy,
And Flora smart and pert;
Louisa is too soft and sleek—
But Alice, gentle, chaste and meek.

And Harriet is confiding,
And Clara grave and mild,
And Emma is affectionate,
And Janet arch and wild;
And Patience is expressive,
And Grace is old and rare,
And Hannah, kind and dutiful,
And Margaret, frank and fair;
And Faith, and Hope, and Charity
Are heavenly names for sisters three.

LADIES' NAMES.

THEIR SIGNIFICANCE.

Frances is frank and free;
Bertha is purely bright;
Clara is illustrious;
Cecilia, dim of sight.
Katharine is pure;
Barbara, from afar;
Mabel is lovable;
Lucy is a morning star.

Wisdom is Sophia's name;
Happiness, Letitia's;
Adelaide a princess is;
Beatrice, delicious.^[2]
Susan is a lily;
Julia has soft hair;
Sara is a lady;
Rosalind, as roses fair.

Constance, firm and resolute;
Grace is favor meet;
Emily has energy;
Melicent is honey-sweet.
Elizabeth and Isabel
To GOD are consecrate;
Edith is happiness;
Maud has courage great.

Mary or Maria,
Star of the sea;
Margaret, a pearl;
Agnes, chastity.
Agatha is truly kind;

Eleanor is light;
Esther is good fortune;
Elvira's soul is white.

Antoinette, Anne, Anna,
Grace and favor rare;
Geraldine and Bridget,
Strong beyond compare.
Noble is Eugenia;
Flora, queen of flowers;
Virginia is purity;
Let her grace be ours!

GEOGRAPHICAL PROPRIETY.

The Brewers should to Malta go,
The dullards all to Scilly,
The Quakers to the Friendly Isles,
The Furriers to Chili.
Spinsters should to the Needles go;
Wine-bibbers to Burgundy;
Gourmands may lunch at Sandwich Isles,
Wits sail to Bay of Fundy.

Cooks, from Spithead, should go to Greece;
And, while the Miser waits
His passage to the Guinea Coast,
Spendthrifts are in the Straits.
The Babies (bless their little hearts!)
That break our nightly rest,
Might be sent off to Babylon,
To Lapland, or to Brest.

Musicians hasten to the Sound;
Itinerants to Rome;
And let the race of hypocrites
At Canton find their home.
Lovers should fly to Cape Good Hope,
Or castles build in Spain;
Debtors should go to Oh-I-Owe;
Our Sailors to the Maine.

Bold Bachelors to the United States;
Maids to the Isle of Man;
The Gardener should to Botany go;
And Shoeblacks to Japan.

This all arranged, and misplaced men
Would then no longer vex us;
While any not provided for
Could go, at once, to Texas!

THE CAPTURE.

When, in the tenth century, the Tartars, led by their ruthless chief, invaded Hungary, and drove its king from the disastrous battle-field, despair seized upon all the inhabitants of the land. Many had fallen in conflict, many more were butchered by the pitiless foe, some sought escape, others apathetically awaited their fate. Among the last was a nobleman who lived retired on his property, distant from every public road. He possessed fine herds, rich corn fields, and a well stocked house, built but recently for the reception of his wife, who now for two years had been its mistress.

Disheartening accounts of the general misfortune had reached his secluded shelter, and its peaceful lord was horror-stricken. He trembled at every sound, at every step; he found his meals less savory; his sleep was troubled; he often sighed, and seemed quite lost and wretched. Thus anxiously anticipating the troubles which menaced him, he sat, one day, at his well closed window, when suddenly a Tartar, mounted on a fiery steed, galloped into the court. The Hungarian sprang from his seat, ran to meet his guest, and said:

“Tartar, thou art my lord; I am thy servant; all thou seest is thine. Take what thou fanciest; I do not oppose thy power. Command; thy servant obeys.”

The Tartar immediately leaped from his horse, entered the house, and cast a careless glance on all the precious adornments it contained. His eyes rested upon the brilliant beauty of the lady of the house, who appeared, tastefully attired, to greet him there, no less graciously than her consort.

The Tartar seized her, with scarcely a moment's hesitation, and, unheeding of her shrieks, swung himself upon the saddle, and spurred away, carrying off his lovely booty.

All this was but an instant's work. The nobleman was thunderstruck, yet he recovered, and hastened to the gate. He could hardly distinguish, in the distance, the figures of the lady and her relentless captor. At length a deep sigh burst from his overcharged heart, and he exclaimed in the bitterness of his bereavement:

“Alas! poor Tartar!”

Matrimony has been defined An insane desire on the part of a young man to pay a young woman's board. But it might be said, with equal justice, to be An insane desire on the part of a young woman, to secure—a master.

THE FIRST MARRIAGE.—And Adam said: “This is now bone of my bone, and flesh of my flesh: she shall be called woman because she was taken out of man. Therefore shall a man leave his father and mother and cleave unto his wife. They shall be one flesh.”

No cards.

In a country church-yard is found this epitaph: “Here lie the bodies of James Robinson and Ruth his wife;” and, underneath, this text: “Their warfare is accomplished.”

A lady having died unmarried at the age of sixty-five, the following epitaph was engraved upon her tombstone:

“She was fearfully and wonderfully maid.”

“This animal,” said a menagerie-man, “is exceedingly timid and retired in its habits. It is seldom seen by the human eye—sometimes never!”

If it was Talleyrand who described language as a gift bestowed upon man in order to enable him to conceal his thoughts, he scarcely made that

use of it, when, in reply to some friend who asked his opinion of a certain lady, he said: “She has but one fault—she is insufferable!”

“What do you want?” demanded an irate house-holder, called to the window at eleven o’clock, by the ringing of the door-bell:

“Want to stay here all night.”

“Stay there, then!” Window closed emphatically.

“I want to go to the Revere,” said a stranger in Boston to a citizen on the street.

“Well, you may go, if you’ll come back pretty soon,” was the satisfactory reply.

“I wish to take you apart for a few moments,” one gentleman said to another in a mixed company.

“Very well,” said the person addressed, rising and preparing to follow the first speaker; “but I shall insist on being put together again!”

Two gentlemen meeting at the door of a street-car in Toledo, and entering together, both faultlessly dressed for the evening, one of them, glancing at his companion’s attire, asked briskly: “Well! who is to be bored to-night?” “I don’t know,” said the other, *as* briskly, “Where are you going?”

This is the way it sounded to the congregation:

“Wawkaw swaw daw aw waw,
Thaw saw thaw Law ahwaw,
Wawkaw taw thaw rahvawvaw brow
Aw thaw rahjawsaw aw!”

this is what the choir undertook to sing:

“Welcome sweet day of rest,
That saw the Lord arise!
Welcome to this reviving breast,
And these rejoicing eyes!”

Mary Wortley Montague was epigrammatic when she divided mankind into “three classes—men, women, and the Hervey family”; an English writer of the present century, when he summed up Harriet Martineau’s creed, in a travesty on the Mohammedan confession of faith, “There is no God, and Harriet is his prophet;” an English critic, who described Forster’s *Life of Charles Dickens* as a “Biography of John Forster, with Reminiscences of Dickens”; an American, who said of one of his own noted countrymen (and it is equally true of many others), “He is a self-made man, and he worships his Creator;” finally, President Grant, when he exclaimed: “Sumner does not believe the Bible! I am not surprised; he didn’t write it!”

Charles Francis Adams, in his eloquent eulogy on W. H. Seward, lapses into a mixed metaphor which is, perhaps, all things considered, one of the most remarkable on record. “One single hour,” he says, “of the will displayed by General Jackson, at the time when Mr. Calhoun—the most powerful leader secession ever had—was abetting active measures, would have *stifled the fire in its cradle*.”

This is scarcely excelled even by Sir Roche Boyle’s celebrated trope: “I smell a rat. I see him floating in the air. But, mark me, I shall nip him in the bud!”

M. B. was planning plank walks from the front doors of his Ellicottville cottage to the gate, wishing to combine greatest convenience with least possible encroachment upon the verdure of the modest lawn. “Friends in council,” assisting at his deliberations, took diverse views of the case. One would have the walks meet obliquely in the form of a Y. Another insisted that whatever angles there were, should be right angles, etc. Finally, M. B. remarked: “Well! we don’t seem to agree. No two of us agree. I think I’ll plank the yard all over, and, where I *want* the grass to grow BORE HOLES!”

Readers who admire the elliptical and suggestive style, and who, therefore, adore Mrs. R. H. D. and Mrs. A. D. T. W., ought to be pleased with the instructions given by a Philadelphian million-heiress to her agent, in this wise, (*audivi*):

“Where the men are at work, they will throw stones and earth and timbers against that tree, and there is no use in it. By a little care they could avoid it, but they won’t *be* careful. So I’d like you, as soon as possible, to put a protection around it—*because it isn’t necessary.*”

... “No, you needn’t drive her out of the grounds. Cows are not allowed to run in the street, and the owner is liable for trespass if they do. Shut her up in the yard, and if the owner don’t come for her to-morrow—Pound her—*because there is a law against it.*”

“Aha!” said a Hibernian gentleman, surprised at his neighbor’s unusual promptness; “Aha! So you’re first, at last! you were always behind before!”

Another Emerald Islander, speaking at his breakfast table of the difference between travel by steam and the old mode, thus illustrated the point: “Afore the rail-road was built, if ye left Elmira at noon, and drove purty fast, ye might likely get to Corning to tea. But to-day, if ye were to start from Elmira at noon on an Express train for Corning, why, ye’re there *Now!*”

Caledonian shrewdness and the Caledonian dialect, alike speak for themselves, in a “bonny Scot’s” definition of metaphysics: “When the mon wha is listenin’, dinna ken what the ither is talkin’ aboot, and the mon wha is talkin’ dinna ken it himsel’, that is metapheesicks.”

“Be what you would seem to be,” said the Duchess, in Lewis Carroll’s delightfully droll story of “Alice’s Adventures,”—“or, if you like it put more simply: Never imagine yourself not to be otherwise than what it might appear to others, that what you were or might have been, was not otherwise than what you had been would have appeared to them to be otherwise.”

That is slightly metaphysical, perhaps; and the same objection might be urged against Dr. Hunter's favorite motto: "It is pretty impossible, and, therefore, extremely difficult for us to convey unto others those ideas whereof we are not possessed of ourselves."

It was Dr. Hunter, who, some years before the war, returned from Florida, where he had spent the winter in a vain quest of health, and exhibited to one of his friends a thermometer he had procured there, marked from 120° only down to zero.

"It was manufactured at the South, I suppose?" she said.

"Oh, no!" was his reply: "It was made in Boston. It's a Northern thermometer, with Southern principles."

Colonel Bingham, of brave and witty memory, had resigned his commission in the Union army, and come home to die. During his lingering illness, the family received a visit from a distant relative, a Carolina lady, with strong secession proclivities, but with sufficient tact not to express them freely before her Northern friends. However, she could not altogether conceal them, but would often express her sympathy for "the soldiers, on both sides"—wish she could distribute the fruit of the peach-orchard among them, "on both sides," &c.

One day when the Colonel was suffering, with his usual fortitude, one of his severest paroxysms of pain, the lady looked in at the door of his room, and, after watching him a few moments with an expression of the keenest commiseration, she turned away. Just as soon as he could breathe again, he gasped out:

"Cousin—Sallie—looked—as if—she was—sorry for me—on both sides!"

A young lady who had married and come north to live, visited, after the lapse of a year or two, her southern home. It was in the palmy days of the peculiar institution, and she was as warmly welcomed by the colored as by the white members of the household. Just before her arrival, a bottle of

medicine with a strong odor of Bourbon had been uncorked, and, afterward, set away. After the first greetings were over, she exclaimed:

“I smell spirits. What have you been doing?”

Old Aunt Chloe, who had lingered in the room so as to be near the beloved new-comer, turned with an air of triumph to her mistress, who had often rebuked her belief in ghosts, and burst out with:

“Dar, Missus! Didn’t I allus tole yo dere was sperits in dis yere house? Sometimes I see ’em, sometimes I hear ’em, an’ yo wood’n b’lieve me; but now, Miss Lizzie’s done gone SMELL ’em!”

The first chapter of a Western novel is said to contain the following striking passage:

All of a sudden the fair girl continued to sit on the sands, gazing upon the briny deep, upon whose bosom the tall ships went merrily by, freighted, ah! who can tell with how much joy and sorrow, and pine lumber, and emigrants, and hopes and salt fish!

“The story,” said our host, with his inexhaustible humor and irresistible brogue, “is of a man who died, and forthwith presented himself at Heaven’s gate, requesting admittance.

‘Have ye bin to Purgatory, my mon?’ says St. Peter.

‘No, yer Riverence.’

‘Thin it’s no good. Ye’ll have to wait awhile.’

While the unlucky ‘Peri’ was slowly withdrawing, another candidate approached, and the same question was asked him.

‘No, yer Riverence, but I’ve been married.’

‘Well, that’s all the same,’ says St. Peter; ‘Come in!’

At this, the first arrival taking heart of grace, advanced again, and says he:

‘Plaze yer Riverence, I’ve been married twice!’

‘Away wid ye! Away wid ye!’ says St. Peter: ‘Heaven is no place for fools!’”

When, some years since, a coalition was talked of between the *New York World*, the *Times*, and the *Herald*, the *Tribune* remarked that, after all, it would be nothing new; it was only the old story of “the world, the flesh, and the devil.”

In 1871, when the French President was undecided and inactive, in the face of all the frightful dangers that threatened the nation, some wit quoted at him the well known verse from Tennyson:

“Thiers! Idle Thiers! We know not what you mean!”

In ’73 a print was widely circulated in Germany, representing Bismarck pulling away at a rope which was fastened to the massive pillars of a Cathedral. At his side stood His Satanic Majesty, who thus questioned him:

“Well, my friend, what are you doing?”

“Trying to pull down the Church.”

“Trying to pull down the Church? And how long do you think it will take you?”

“Oh, perhaps three or four years.”

“Very good, my friend, very good! I have been trying that for the last eighteen hundred years; and, if you succeed in three or four, I’ll resign in your favor!”

When a certain United States Senator disappointed his Ohio constituents by voting on what they thought the wrong side of a question, some one (who must have enjoyed his opportunity) hit him with the following quotation: “He’s Ben Wade, and found wanting.”

“John P. Hale is an old goose!” exclaimed General Cass. Some friend was kind enough to repeat this saying to the Senator; who replied with a smile, (and, surely this was the “retort courteous,”) “Tell General Cass that he’s a Michi-gander!”

At a public dinner in Boston, nearly twenty years ago, Judge Story proposed as a toast: “The Orator of the Day: Fame follows merit whereEVER IT goes!” To which Mr. Everett responded: “The President of the Day: To whatever height the fabric of jurisprudence may aspire in this country, it can never rise above one Story!”

A newspaper wit announces the discovery of a buried city in the following pathetic terms: Another lost city has been found on the coast of Siberia. Now let the man who lost it make his appearance, pay for this advertisement, and take his old ruins away.

It has been said that the faculty of generalization belongs equally to childhood and to genius. Was she a genius, clad in sable robes, and bewailing the recent loss of her husband—she was certainly not a child—who observed in conversation, with most impressive pathos: “For we are all liable to become a widow!”

CHARACTERISTIC SAYINGS OF AMERICANS.

Franklin said many things that have passed into maxims, but nothing that is better known and remembered than “He paid dear, very dear, for his whistle.”

Washington made but very few epigrammatic speeches. Here is one: “To be prepared for war is the most effectual means of preserving peace.”

Did you ever hear of old John Dickinson? Well, he wrote of Americans in 1768: “By uniting we stand, by dividing we fall.”

Patrick Henry, as every school-boy knows, gave us, “Give me liberty, or give me death,” and “If this be treason, make the most of it.”

Thomas Paine had many quotable epigrammatic sentences: “Rose like a rocket; fell like a stick;” “Times that try men’s souls;” “One step from the sublime to the ridiculous,” etc., etc.

Jefferson’s writings are so besprinkled that it is difficult to select. In despair we jump at “Few die and none resign,” certainly as applicable to office-holders now as in Jefferson’s time.

Henry Lee gave Washington his immortal title, “First in war, first in peace, and first in the hearts of his countrymen.”

Charles Cotesworth Pinckney declared in favor of “Millions for defence, but not one cent for tribute.”

“Peaceably if we can; forcibly if we must,” is from Josiah Quincy, 1841.

John Adams did not say, “Live or die, survive or perish, I am for the constitution,” but Daniel Webster said it for him.

The revolutionary age alone would give us our article, had we time to gather pearls. Coming down, we pass greater, but not more famous men.

Davy Crockett was the illustrious author of “Be sure you are right, and then go ahead.”

Andrew Jackson gave us “The Union—it must be preserved.”

Benton almost lost his original identity in “Old Bullion,” from his “hard money” doctrines.

Governor Throop, of New York, was called “Small Light Troop” for years, from a phrase in a thanksgiving proclamation.

Scott’s “hasty plate of soup” lasted his lifetime.

Taylor’s battle order, “A little more grape, Captain Bragg,” will be quoted after he is forgotten by “all the world and the rest of mankind.”

Seward is known for the “irrepressible conflict,” wherever the English language is spoken.

To Washington Irving we owe “The Almighty Dollar.”

Rufas Choate gave us “glittering generalities.”

Tom Corwin’s “welcome with bloody hands to hospitable graves,” gave him more unenviable criticism than any other saying in his life.

Calhoun gave us “state rights” as a most pernicious and absurd equivalent for national supremacy under the constitution.

Douglas applied “squatter sovereignty,” though it is probable that Cass invented it and Calhoun named it.

Stringfellow was the original “Border Ruffian.”

War times gave us no end of epigrammatic utterances. Those of Lincoln alone would fill a volume—chief of these, is that noble sentiment: “With charity to all, and malice toward none.”

McClellan’s “All quiet along the Potomac” was repeated so often that its echo will “ring down through the ages.”

To Gen. Butler the country was indebted for the phrase “Contraband of War,” as applied to fugitive negroes found within our lines.

Grant gave us “Fight it out on this line,” “Unconditional surrender,” “I propose to move immediately upon your works,” “Bottled up,” and a hundred others. It seems to have escaped notice that Grant is responsible for more of these characterizing, elementary crystallizations of thought, than any other military leader of modern times.

One odd example occurs, in his response to Gen. Sheridan’s telegram: “If things are pushed, Lee will surrender.” “Push things!” was the reply, and that has passed into a proverb.

DIALECTICAL.

The peculiarities of the Yankee dialect are most amusingly exemplified by James Russell Lowell, in the Biglow Papers, especially in the First Series, from which the following extract is taken:

I ’spose you wonder where I be; I can’t tell fur the soul o’ me
Exactly where I be myself, meanin’ by thet, the hull o’ me.
When I left hum, I hed two legs, an’ they wa’n’t bad ones neither;

The scaliest trick they ever played, wuz bringin' on me hither—
 Now one on 'em's I dunno where, they thought I was a-dyin',
 An' cut it off, because they said 'twas kind of mortifyin';
 I'm willin to believe it wuz, and yet I can't see, nuther,
 Why one should take to feelin' cheap a minute sooner 'n t'other,
 Sence both wuz equilly to blame—but things is ez they be;
 It took on so they took it off, an' thet's enough for me.
 Where's my left hand? Oh, darn it! now I recollect wut's come on't.
 I haint no left hand but my right, and thet's got jest a thumb on't,
 It aint so handy as it wuz to calkylate a sum on't.
 I've lost one eye, but then, I guess, by diligently usin' it,
 The other'll see all I shall git by way of pay fer losin' it.
 I've hed some ribs broke, six I b'lieve, I haint kep' no account of 'em;
 When time to talk of pensions comes, we'll settle the amount of 'em.
 An' talkin' about broken ribs, it kinder brings to mind
 One that I couldn't never break—the one I left behind!
 Ef you should see her, jest clean out the spout o' your invention,
 And pour the longest sweetnin' in about a annooal pension;
 And kinder hint, in case, you know, the critter should refuse to be
 Consoled, I aint so expensive now to keep, as wut I used to be:—
 There's one eye less, ditto one arm, an' then the leg that's wooden,
 Can be took off, an' sot away, whenever there's a pudden!

(Letter from Birdofreedom Sawin, a Mexican volunteer, to a friend at home.)

The Dundreary “dialect” is admirably illustrated in

A LONDON EXQUISITE'S OPINION OF “UNCLE TOM'S CABIN.”

Aw must wead “Uncle Tom,”—a wawk
 Which aw'm afwaid's extwemely slow:
 People one meets begin to talk
 Of Mrs. Hawiet Beechah Stowe.

'Tis not as if aw saw haw name
 To walls and windahs still confined;
 All that is meawly vulgah fame:
 Aw don't wespect the common mind.

But Staffa'd House has made haw quite
 Anothah kind of pawson look;
 A countess would pawsist last night,

In asking me about haw book.

She wished to know if aw admiawd
Eva, which quite confounded me;
And then haw ladyship iniquawd
Whethaw aw didn't hate Legwee.

Bai Jove! Aw was completely flawed;
Aw wished myself, or haw, in Fwance;
And that's the way a fellah's bawed
By ewewy gahl he asks to dance!

Aw felt myself a greataw fool
Than aw had ewaw felt befaw;
Aw'll study at some wagged school
The tale of that old blackamaw!

It must be this same kind of Englishman, of whom the following story is told: He was traveling on some American railroad, when a tremendous explosion took place; the cars, at the same time, coming to a sudden halt. The passengers sprang up in terror, and rushed out to acquaint themselves with the cause and extent of the mischief, all but His Serene Highness, who continued reading his newspaper. In a moment some one rushed back, and informed him that the boiler had burst. "Awe!" grunted the Englishman.

"Yes, and sixteen people have been killed!"

"Awe!" he muttered again.

"And—and," said his interlocutor, with an effort, "your own man—your servant—has been blown into a hundred pieces!"

"Awe! Bring me the piece that has the key of my portmanteau!"

THE LEGAL "DIALECT."

ODE TO SPRING.

WRITTEN IN A LAWYER'S OFFICE.

Whereas, on sundry boughs and sprays
Now divers birds are heard to sing,

And sundry flowers their heads upraise,
Hail to the coming on of spring!

The birds aforesaid, happy pairs!
Love 'midst the aforesaid boughs enshrines,
In household nests, themselves, their heirs,
Administrators and assigns.

The songs of the said birds arouse
The memory of our youthful hours,
As young and green as the said boughs,
As fresh and fair as the said flowers.

Oh, busiest term of Cupid's court!
Where tender plaintiffs actions bring;
Seasons of frolic and of sport,
Hail, as aforesaid, coming spring!

“Broad Wiltshire” is sampled below, in a psalm given out by the Clerk of Bradford Parish Church during an Episcopal visitation:

Let us zing to the praayze an' glawry 'o God, dree verses of the hundred an' vourteenth zaam,—a version specially 'dapted to the 'casion, by myself:

Why hop ye zo, ye little hills,
And what var do'ee skip?
Is it acoz you'm proud to zee
His grace, the Lard Biship?

Why skip ye zo ye little hills,
And what var do'ee hop?
Is it acoz to preach to we,
Is comed the Lard Bishop?

Ees—he has comed to preach to we,—
Then let us aal strick up,
An' zing a glawrious zong of praayze,
An' bless the Lard Bishup!

Persons fond of economizing words, sometimes use figures (are they figures of speech?) and letters, in their stead. Thus, the fate of all earthly things is presented by the consonants DK—a view of the case entirely consonant with our own observation.

The following is a printer's short-hand method of expressing his emotions:

2 KT J.

An SA now I mean 2 write
2 U, sweet KT J,
The girl without a ||,
The belle of UTK.

I 1der if U got the 1
I wrote 2 U, B4
I sailed in the RKDA,
And sent by LN Moore?

My MT head will scarce contain
A calm IDA bright,
But, 8T miles from U, I must
M  this chance to write.

And first, should NE NV U,
B EZ, mind it not;
Should NE friendship show, B true;
They should not be forgot.

But friends and foes alike DK,
As U may plainly C,
In every funeral RA,
And every LEG.

From virtU never DV8;
Her influence B9
Alike induces 10dernS,
And 40tude divine.

This SA until U I C,
I pray U 2 to XQQ;
And not to burn in FIG
My young and 10der muse.

Now fare U well, DR KT J,
I trust that U R true;
When this U C, then U can say
An SA IOU.

AN AFFECTING STORY.

IIAR BB loved a maid,
He loved her to XS,
And XRSIId his NRGG
2 C her and confS.

Says he, "A meeting I'll proQR,
B4 the day is past;
In spite of all my NMEE,
She shall B mine at last."

Now UUULe, MLE
Was 10dR and B9,
FMN8 and gentL 2,
Some th0 she was Divine,

But poor IIAR made her X,
She said he was a calf—
SPCLE ODS;
0 spoke in his B½.

She said, "Should you go on UR nEE,
And melt awA in TRR,
Or WR at 10tions 4
The futR 50 years.

"U still would 0 B 2 me,
UR not 2 my mind,
So prA B YYR, sir, and go
Some betR maid 2 find.

"DR MLE, my love's XS,
PrithE X10U8,
XQQ—4give—and love me, or
I'll take an OP8."

And so he did. Alas! poor man!
Kind readR shed a TR,
He took the OPM so strong,
It laid him on his BR!

GEORGE AND HIS POPPAR.

FEB. 22, A.D. 1738.

There livèd once a plan-ti-er

With his son, his only love,
To whom, upon his birth-day,
A brand new ax he giv.

This farmer had a gar-di-ing,
All filled with apple trees,
Which, for the city mar-ki-et,
He trièd for to reeze.

The son he takes the hatch-i-et,
Quite jolly and jocund,
And, going to the apple trees,
He chops them to the grund.

The farmer called his serv-i-ents,
And ranged them in a row;
“Now, who has chopped my apple trees,
And killed them, root and bo’?”

The servants stand ama-zi-ed,
All drawn up in a line;
Then comes a running up to him,
His young and hopeful sci’n.

“I cannot tell a lie, poppar,”
This truthful boy began;
“’Twas I who chopped your apple trees,
’Twas I, your little san.”

Now, who’d you s’pose this buffer was?
And who his filial kin?
It was the immortal Bushrod,
And the late G. Washingtin!

Feb. 22, 1875. MORAL.

Now, whoso takes a hatch-i-et,
And apple trees cuts down,
Will be, if he lives long enough,
A great and pious moun.

The preceding poem, while it places in a new light the immortal history of the hatchet, also illustrates the wonderful adaptability of the English language to the purposes of the poet. Thus, in the last stanza, a rhyme is required for “down,” while the sense demands the word “man” at the end of the corresponding line. Instantly the ingenious author perceives the remedy,

and changes “man” to “moun,” which doesn’t mean anything to interfere with the sense, and rhymes with “down” in the most satisfactory manner.

Other fine illustrations of this kind are found in that learned translation of a part of the Eneid, published a few years since at Winsted, Connecticut. Thus:

“The hair stood endwise on his powdered wig,
Like quills upon the fretful porcupig;
He wants to go, and then again he doesn’t;
The situation is indeed unpluzzent.”

The temptation is strong to quote just here several parallel passages from Davidson’s very literal translation and from this Winsted version. We will give one, for the sake of the contrast.

“Returning Aurora now illuminates the earth with the lamp of Phœbus, and has chased away the dewy shades from the sky, when Dido, half-frenzied, thus addressed her sympathizing sister:

Sister Anna, what dreams terrify and distract my mind! What think you of this wondrous guest who has come to our abode? In mien how graceful he appears! In manly fortitude and warlike deeds how great! I am fully persuaded, (nor is my belief groundless,) that he is the offspring of the gods. Had I not been fixed and steadfast in my resolution never to join myself to any in the bonds of wedlock, since my first love by death mocked and disappointed me, I might, perhaps, give way. Anna, since the death of my unhappy spouse Sichæus, since the household gods were stained with his blood, shed by a brother, this stranger alone has warped my inclinations, and interested my wavering mind. I recognize the symptoms of my former flame. But he who first linked me to himself, hath borne away my affection. May he possess it still, and retain it in the grave. (*Liber Quartus. Ibid.*)

Next day the sun rose at the proper time,
And much improved the Carthaginian clime,
When thus her sister Anna she addressed:
“Sister, my nights are full of wild unrest:
This nice young man that’s now a-stopping here
To my affections is a-growing dear;
Celestial is his origin I *know*,—
Such fearless souls don’t emanate below.
My grief! what savage fights that man has fit,

And how genteel he can get up and git!
'F I hadn't vowed not to unite again,
I'm not quite certain but I should cave in.
Since poor dear Sic was slew by brother Pyg,
For no live man I've ever cared a fig,
Till unto Carthage this brave hero came—
But now—I swan—I feel the ancient flame.
Yet, while Sichæus keeps his confined state,
My heart lies with his ashes—that's my gait."

Prizes having been offered for rhymes corresponding to "Ipecacuanha," and "Timbuctoo," it is to be hoped that the ingenious authors of the following verses gained them:

As I was walking in the grove
With my Julianna,
Some oranges I gave my love,
Pine-apple and banana;
And then, her headache to remove,
Some ipecacuanha.

If I were a cassowary
On the plains of Timbuctoo,
I would eat a missionary,
Flesh and bones, and hymn-book, too.

"And the moral of that is," as the Duchess observed:

That step can find no place
In rhyme, is not the case:
'Tis quite absurd:
To find a rhyme for "step,"
You only have to sep-
Arate a word.

Also: ("month" having been declared unrhymable;)

They seized a soldier in Broadway,
December was the month;
He saw his pistols thrown away,
He also saw his gun th-

rown away!

In W. G. Clarke’s youth he was requested by a young lady in the millinery line to contribute a poem to her album. Her “Album” was an account book diverted from its original purpose, and he responded as follows:

To Miss Lucretia Sophonisba Matilda Jerusha Catling:

Thou canst not hope, O nymph divine		9
That I should ever court the		
Or that, when passion’s glow is done,		1
My heart can ever love but		
When, from Hope’s flowers exhales the dew,		2
Then Love’s false smiles desert us		
Then Fancy’s radiance ’gins to flee,		3
And life is robbed of all the		
And Sorrow sad her tears must pour		4
O’er cheeks where roses bloomed be		
Yes! life’s a scene all dim as Styx;		6
Its joys are dear at	3	
Its raptures fly so quickly hence		18d
They’re scarcely cheap at		
Oh! for the dreams that then survive!		25
They’re high at pennies		
The breast no more is filled with heaven		27
When years it numbers		
And yields it up to Manhood’s fate		28
About the age of		
Finds the world cold and dim and dirty		30
Ere the heart’s annual count is		
Alas! for all the joys that follow		25
I would not give a <i>quarter dollar</i> .		
1		97½

Thus, my dear maid, I send to you
The balance of my meter due;
Please scrutinize the above amount,
And set it down to my account.

“FRAGMENTS OF AN ORIGINAL LOVE STORY.”

BY
J. G. STAUNTON, AND A SOUTH CAROLINA LADY.

After a “lovers’

quarrel,” when the party of the first part
——Meekly approached and knelt down at her feet,
Praying loud as before he had ranted,
That she would forgive him, and try to be sweet,
And said “Can’t you?” the dear girl re-canted.

Then softly he whispered “How could you do so?
I certainly thought I was jilted;
But come now with me; to the parson we’ll go!
Say, wilt thou, my dear?” and she wilted.

Then gaily he took her to see his new home;
A cottage by no means enchanted;
“Ah! here we can live without longing to roam,”
He said, “Sha’n’t we, my love?” and they shantied,

And gently beamed o’er them love’s rose-colored ray;
(The bridegroom and bride of this ballad;)
He said “Let us walk at the close of the day,
My own lovely Sall,” and they sallied.

He plucked her the sweetest and loveliest flowers
That scented the path where they wandered;
And when she exclaimed “Let us turn from these bowers,
To roam near the pond!” then they pondered.

Old time softly paused o’er the home of this pair,
Nor grief nor perplexity haunted;
And when the meek husband asked “What shall I wear?”
“Plaid pants,” she replied, and he panted.

She, like a good wife, made his wardrobe her care;
(Neglecting it seemed to her wicked;)
So, when she brought linen, all shining and fair,
Saying “Wear this, dear Dick!” then he dickied.

And when a bright bud of divinity came,
To gladden the home where it tarried,
They put it to vote that the young stranger’s name
Sweet CARRIE should be, and *’twas carried*.

But perhaps the most “pronounced” example of adaptability, as referred to above, is found in a poem recently contributed to a Rochester paper.

Spring, sprang, beautiful sprung!
The wild-winged warblers are wanging a wung,
And the soft southern breezes are brazing a broze,
That thaws up the ice with remarkable thoze.

O betterest time of all moments of tome,
I'll rhyme thee a rhymelet in tenderest rhome,
And tell thee how oft in my longing, I've lung
To welcome thy coming, O beautiful sprung!

Symbolical season! exquisitest soze!
All nature uprising in gleefulest gloze,
Wide opens its larynx to sing and to shout,
Exuberant pleasure and gratefulest grout.

The blithe little rivulets run to the seas,—
The little buds start on the hemlocks and trees;
The wild geese are screaming their vigorest scream,
And the frogs that were dreaming no longer will dream.

Of course there is sadness in thinking the thought
That there'll be no more skating for skaters who skaught;
But the Erie Canal, with its *decrease* in tolls,
Will cause us to smile a succession of smoles.

If “the exigencies of rhyme” need not be considered in constructing English verse, neither need the exigencies of rhythm, as shown by the following highly artistic couplets:

The wind blew down our well-sweep,
And father and I put it up again —— sheep.

Wasn't Pharaoh a Rascal
Because he wouldn't let the children of Israel go three days' journey into the wilderness, to
celebrate the Paschal?

In '73, a modest volume of poems was published by an Hon. and Rev. gentleman of Central New York,^[3] in which occur the following rather surprising verses: (not consecutively, but here and there.)

O bright shining morn of the year,
I cannot foretell thy events;
Trusting in God, why should I fear,
Though having so many relents!

* * * * *

I looked on his form; 'twas like mine;
Transparent his body did seem;
His vigor could never repine;
With glory his features all gleam.

* * * * *

Oh, that the great ocean of love,
Where all the inhabitants bathe,
Ere they go to the bright realms above,
In His sight to whom they have clave.

* * * * *

We saw there as beacons of light
God's temples of worship, so fair;
We saw there, enlisted in fight,
The wicked who cursed God with dare.

* * * * *

O then they all sang as before,
And the prophets they came rushing down;
And skipping, they came to that shore
Where saints shall forever be crowned!

To find the “concealed sense” (concealed *nonsense*!) of the verses that follow, the first and third, second and fourth lines, are read consecutively:

That man must lead a happy life,
Who's free from matrimonial chains;
Who is directed by a wife,
Is sure to suffer for his pains.

Adam could find no solid peace,
When Eve was given for a mate;
Till he beheld a woman's face,
Adam was in a happy state.

In all the female race appear
Hypocrisy, deceit, and pride,

The tokens of a heart sincere,
In woman never did reside.

What tongue is able to unfold
The failings that in woman dwell?
The merits in her we behold,
Are almost imperceptible.

Confusion take the man, I say,
Who makes a woman his delight!
Who will no court to women pay,
Keeps always reason in his sight.

This is nonsense, too; though, certainly, women are the faultiest of human beings—except men.

Be that as it may, few women have ever been more severely, or, perhaps, more justly, cauterized, than poor Job's poor wife, in Coleridge's celebrated *Epigram*:

Sly Beelzebub took all occasions
To try Job's constancy and patience.
He took his honor, took his health,
He took his children, took his wealth,
His servants, horses, oxen, cows—
But cunning Satan did *not* take his spouse.

But Heaven, that brings out good from evil,
And loves to disappoint the Devil,
Had predetermined to restore
Twofold all Job had lost before:
His servants, horses, oxen, cows.
Short-sighted Satan! NOT to take his spouse?

SECRET CORRESPONDENCE.

A young lady, newly married, being obliged to show her husband all the letters she wrote, sent the following to an intimate friend:

I cannot be satisfied, my dearest friend,
blest as I am in the matrimonial state,
until I confide to your most friendly keeping
trusting to your interest in what interests me,
the various deep sensations which swell

with the liveliest feelings of satisfaction
my almost bursting heart. I tell you, my dear
husband is one of the most amiable of men.
I have been married nearly seven weeks, and
have never found the least possible reason to
repent the day that joined us. My husband is
in person and manners far from resembling those
ugly, cross, old, disagreeable and jealous
monsters, who think by confining to secure
a wife, it is his maxim to treat as a
bosom friend and confidant and not as a
plaything or menial slave the woman
chosen to be his companion. Neither party
he frequently says, ought to obey implicitly,
but each yield to the other in turn.
I know my husband loves nothing more
than he does me; he flatters me more
than the glass, and his intoxication
(for I must so call the excess of his love,)
often makes me blush for the unworthiness
of its object, and wish I could be more deserving
of the man whose name I bear. To
say all in one word, my dearest friend, and to
crown the whole, my former gallant lover
is now my indulgent husband. My fondness
is returned, and I might have married
a prince, without the felicity I find with
him! Adieu! May you be blest as I am unable
to wish that I could be more
happy.

(The key to the above letter is to omit every alternate line: reading the first, third, fifth, &c., consecutively.)

It is said that among ancient Christian devices the figure of a fish occurs very frequently, with the inscription *anthropou* (in Greek letters), signifying *of man*. The following explanation has been given: The Greek word for *fish* is *ichthus*, and each of the five letters composing the Greek word, (ch and th being each represented by only one letter,) is the initial of a significant word, as follows:

iesus—Jesus,
christos—Christ,
theou—of God,

uios—Son,
soter—Saviour.

The whole, followed by anthropou, (the word inscribed upon the figure of the fish,) forms a profession of Christian faith:

JESUS CHRIST, SON OF GOD, SAVIOUR OF MEN.

Pilate's question addressed to our Lord, "What is truth?" "Quid est Veritas?" contains in itself, by a perfect anagram, its own answer: "Est vir qui adest:" *"It is the Man who stands before you."*

When "I cry that I sin" is transposed, it is clear
My resource, "Christianity," soon will appear.

The following very curious sentence, "*Sator arepo teret opera rotas,*" is not first-class Latin, but may be freely translated: "I cease from my work; the mower will wear his wheels." It is, in fact, something like a nonsensical verse, but has these peculiarities: 1st. It spells backward and forward the same. 2d. Then, the first letter of each word spells the first word. 3d. Then, all the second letters of each word spell the second word. 4th. Then, all the third, and so on through, the fourth and fifth. 5th. Then, commencing with the last word, the last letter of each word spells the first word. 6th. Then, the next to the last, and so on, through.

The lines which constitute the Pyramid below, may be read from the base upward, or from the apex downward, indifferently.

There
For aye
To stay,
Commanding,
'Tis standing,
With God-like air,
Sublimely fair.
Its form declaring,
Its height admiring,

Looks on it from afar
 Lo! every smiling star.
 To raise the pile to heaven
 These beauteous stones are given,
 Each prayer for truth-inspiring light,
 Each manly struggle for the right,
 Each kindly word to cheer the lowly,
 Each aspiration for the holy,
 Each strong temptation overcome,
 Each clamorous passion held in silence dumb.
 As it arises slowly toward the upper heaven
 Stone after stone until the mass is given.
 Its base upon the earth, its apex in the skies,
 The good man's character, a pyramid doth rise.

There
 For aye
 To stay,
 Commanding,
 'Tis standing,
 With God-like air,
 Sublimely fair.
 Its form declaring,
 Its height admiring,
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 Lo! every smiling star.
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 Its base upon the earth, its apex in the skies,
 The good man's character, a pyramid doth rise.

“Revolution” is transposed “to love ruin,” and “French Revolution,”
 “Violence run forth.”

One of the prettiest of modern anagrams is “Florence Nightingale,” “Flit
 on, cheering angel.”

If the name Napoleon be successively “beheaded” till only two letters
 are left, each remainder forms a significant word; and these words,

combined in a certain manner, form a concise sketch of Napoleon the First. Thus:

	Napoleon,	Apoleon,	Poleon,	Oleon,
		destroying,	cities,	destructive,
Leon,	Eon,	On,		
lion,	going about,	being.		

Napoleon, on, oleon, leon, eon, apoleon, poleon.

Napoleon being a destructive lion, going about destroying cities.

The following sentence of only thirty-four letters contains all the letters of the alphabet:

John quickly extemporized five tow bags.

HISTORY.

Sir Walter Raleigh, in his prison, was composing the second volume of his "History of the World." Leaning on the sill of his window, he meditated on the duties of the historian to mankind, when suddenly his attention was attracted by a disturbance in the court yard before his cell. He saw one man strike another whom he supposed by his dress to be an officer; the latter at once drew his sword, and ran the former through the body. The wounded man felled his adversary with a stick, and then sank upon the pavement. At this juncture the guard came up, and carried off the officer insensible, and then the corpse of the man who had been run through.

Next day Raleigh was visited by an intimate friend, to whom he related the circumstances of the quarrel, and its issue. To his astonishment, his friend unhesitatingly declared that the prisoner had mistaken the whole series of incidents which had passed before his eyes.

The supposed officer was not an officer at all, but the servant of a foreign ambassador; it was he who had dealt the first blow; he had not drawn his sword, but the other had snatched it from his side, and had run *him* through the body before any one could interfere; whereupon a stranger, from among the crowd, knocked the murderer down with his stick; and

some of the foreigners belonging to the ambassador's retinue carried off the corpse.

Raleigh's friend added that the Government had ordered the arrest and immediate trial of the murderer, as the man assassinated was one of the principal servants of the Spanish ambassador.

"Excuse me," said Raleigh, "but I cannot have been deceived as you suppose, for I was eye-witness to the events, which took place under my own window; and the man fell there on that spot where you see a paving stone standing up above the rest."

"My dear Sir Walter," replied his friend, "I was sitting on that stone when the fray took place, and I received this slight scratch on my cheek in snatching the sword from the murderer. Upon my word of honor, you were deceived in every particular."

Sir Walter, when alone, took up the second volume of his history, which was in manuscript, and, contemplating it, thought: "If two men see the same thing so differently—nay, if I cannot believe my own eyes, how can I be assured of the truth of a tithe of the events which happened ages before I was born?" and he flung the manuscript into the fire.

Charles Dudley Warner, travelling in Nubia and Egypt, asserts that "The Arabian Nights' Entertainment" is the best history ever written. In the light of the above facts, perhaps it is.

ST. ANTHONY'S FISH-SERMON.

From a German versification of a passage from the works of Abraham à Santa Clara, a Jesuit preacher of the Seventeenth Century.

St. Anthony, *one* day
Found the Church empty, Sunday:
So he goes to the river,
A discourse to deliver:
They're ready to listen—
Their tails flop and glisten.

The carps, those old scorners,
Come out of their corners;

Their carping suspended,
Their jaws wide extended,
(Ears wanting—) to swallow
Remarks that might follow.

The pouts, cross-grained pouters—
Those well-known come-outers,—
For this once go-*inners*,
Confessed themselves sinners.
The pouts said they never
Heard a sermon so clever.

Crabs and mud-turtles also,
That usually crawl so,
And in dirt their heads bury,
Came up in a hurry.
Crabs and turtles had never
Heard sermon so clever.

Eels and sturgeons, best livers
Of all in the rivers—
Forsaking their dinners
Bewailed themselves sinners.
Eels and sturgeons had never
Heard sermon so clever.

And lastly, those odd fish
We mortals call codfish—
Their glass eyes distended—
Devoutly attended,
Like rational creatures,
This greatest of preachers.

And dog-fish and cat-fish,
And flounders and flat-fish,
And, finally, all fish,
Both great fish and small fish,
Came swimming and squirming
In shoals to the sermon;
And all said they never
Had heard one so clever.

But when it was ended,
To their business all wended;
The pikes to their thieving,
The eels to good living;
The crab still went crooked,
The codfish was stupid:
Yet none of them ever
Heard sermon so clever!

A susceptible youth addressed the following highly classical letter to a young lady whose poetical effusions, dated “Pine Woods,” had won his heart:

Permittere me dicere, carissima puella, ego habeo visus vestris dulces funes in papyrus. Ego lignum simile videre te plurimo. Ego nosco nos lignum autumnus in amore cum unus alter. Tuus versus spectaculum genius et tener cors. Ego lignum calcitro tuum durum cordatum patrem ex portis, et ego possum duo, si ille erat non complacens et omnis rectus. Volo ad vistare te, sed non nosco ubi Pinus Sylva sit. Prendam Erie maledictum-viam? Ubi est id? Ero membrum legis, proximo vero, et tun, cum pocket libro pleno stamporum, cano in manu, silko castore super capito, ego non curo pro omnibus tauricanibus in Pino-silva, nam meum canum est fors, et decutiam sua capita—sed sufficit.

Omnium pro te,
Unus qui amat.

FELIS ET MURES.

BY GREENE KENDRICK.

Felis sedit by a hole;
Intenta she, cum omne soul,
Prendere rats;
Mice cucurrerunt over the floor,
In numero, duo, tres, or more,
Obliti cats.

Felis saw them oculis;
“I’ll have them,” inquit she, “I guess,
Dum ludunt;”
Tunc illa crept toward the group,—
“Habeam,” dixit, “good rat soup;
Pingues sunt!”

Mice continued all ludere;
Intenti they in ludum vere,
Gaudenter:
Tunc rushed the felis into them,
Et tore them omnes, limb from limb,
Violenter.

MORAL.

Mures, omnes, now beware!
Of hungry felis have a care
Nox et die;
Si hoc facis “verbum sat;”
Avoid a huge and hungry cat,
Studiose!

Ego nunquam audiui such terrible news,
As at this present tempus my senses confuse;
I am drawn for a miles, I must go cum Marte,
Et, communis ense, engage Bonapar-te;
But soon we will show to this Corsican vaunter,
That, though *times* may change, BRITONS *never* mutantur.
Dr. Porson.

Tres fratres stolidi
Took a boat for Philippi;
Stormum surgebat
Et boatum overturnebat;
Omnes drownerunt
Qui swimmere non potuerunt

THE RHINE.

Oh the Rhine, the Rhine, the Rhine!
Comme c'est beau! wie schön! che bello!
He who quaffs thy Lust and Wein,
Morbleu! is a lucky fellow.

How I love thy rushing streams,
Groves of ash and birch and hazel,
From Schaffhausen's rainbow beams,
Jusqu 'à l'echo d' Oberwesel!

Oh, que j'aime the Brüchen, when
The crammed Dampschiff gayly passes!
Love the bronzed pipes of thy men,
And the bronzed cheeks of thy lasses!

Oh, que j'aime the "oui," the "bah,"
From the motley crowd that flow,
With the universal "ja,"
And the Allgemeine "So!"

LATIN POEM.

FOR THE LEARNED.

Hei didulum, didulum, atque iterum didulum,
Felisque, Fidisque!
Vacca super Lunæ cornua prosiluit
Nescio qua catulus risit dulcedine ludi,
Abstunt et turpi lanx cochleare fuga!

FRENCH SONG.

Chantons une chanson à six sous,
La poche pleine de blé;
Vingt-quatre oiseaux noirs
Cuits dans un pâté!
Quand le pâté s'ouvrit,
Les oiseaux levaient leurs voix;
N'était-ce pas un joli plat,
Mettre devant le Roi?

ICH BIN DEIN.

ENGLISH, LATIN, GREEK, FRENCH AND GERMAN "MACARONI."

In tempus old a hero lived
Qui loved puellas deux,
He ne pouvait pas quite to say
Which one amabat mieux.

Dit-il lui-même, un beau matin,
"Non possum both avoir;
Sed si address Amanda Anne,
Then Kate and I have war!"

Amanda habet argent coin
Sed Kate has aureas curls
Et both sunt very agathæ
Et quite formosæ girls.

Enfin, the youthful anthropos
Philoun the duo maids,
Resolved proponere ad Kate
Avant cet evening's shades.

Procedens then to Kate's domo,
Il trouve Amanda there,
Kai quite forgot his late resolves
Both sunt so goodly fair.

Sed, smiling on the new tapis,
Between puellas twain,
Cœpit to tell his vœux to Kate
Dans un poétique strain.

Mais, glancing ever and anon
At fair Amanda's eyes,
Illæ non possunt dicere
Pro which he meant his sighs.

Each virgo heard his demi vow
With cheeks as rouge as wine,
And, offering each a milk-white hand,
Both whispered "Ich bin dein."

MACARONIC ADVERTISEMENT.

An inn-keeper in Germany sets forth the accommodations of his house
in the following lines, inscribed upon one of its windows:

In questa casa trovarete
Toutes les choses que vous souhaitez;
Vinum bonum, costas, carnes,
Neat post-chaise, and horse and harness.

ANN HATHAWAY.

(PROBABLY NOT SHAKESPEARE'S.)

Would ye be taught, ye feathered throng,
With love's sweet notes to grace your song,
To charm the heart in thrilling lay,
Listen to Ann Hathaway.
She hath a way to sing so clear,
Phœbus might, listening, stoop and hear:
To melt the sad, make blithe the gay,
And nature charm, Ann hath a way.
 She hath a way,
 Ann Hathaway.

When Envy's tongue and Rancor's tooth
Do soil and bite fair worth and truth,
And merit to distress betray,
To soothe the soul, Ann hath a way.
She hath a way to chase despair;
To heal all grief, to cure all care,
Turn foulest night to fairest day,
Thou knowest, fond heart, Ann hath a way,
 She hath a way,
 Ann Hathaway.

Tell not of gems the Orient list;
The diamond, topaz, amethyst,
The emerald mild, the ruby gay;
Talk of my gem Ann Hathaway.
She hath a way with her bright eye,
Their various lustre to defy;
The jewel she, and the foil they,
So sweet to look Ann hath a way.
 She hath a way,
 Ann Hathaway.

But to my fancy were it given
To rate her charms, I'd call it heaven;
For, though a mortal made of clay,
Angels might love Ann Hathaway.
She hath a way so to control
And rapture the imprisoned soul,
And love and truth so to display
That to be heaven Ann hath a way.
 She hath a way,
 Ann Hathaway.

INSTRUCTIVE FABLES.

THE DOG AND THE SPARE RIB.—A mastiff crossing a bridge and bearing in his mouth a piece of meat, suddenly swallowed the meat. He immediately observed that the shadow of the aforesaid in the water had disappeared.

Moral: We learn from this fable that life is but a shadow.

THE ASS AND THE LOCOMOTIVE.—A donkey one day was quietly munching thistles when he heard the screaming whistle of a locomotive. Pricking up his ears, he started into a gallop and raced across lots, with his tail high in the air.

Moral: This fable teaches what an ass he was.

THE MOUSE AND THE CAT.—A mouse once peeped from his hole and saw a cat. The cat was looking the other way, and happened not to see the mouse.

Nobody killed.

Moral: This little fable doesn't teach anything.

PRONUNCIATION.

The difficulty of applying rules to the pronunciation of our language may be illustrated in two lines, wherein the combination of the letters *ough* is pronounced in no less than seven different ways, viz: as *o*, *uf*, *off*, *up*, *ow*, *oo*, and *ock*.

Though the tough cough and hiccough plough me through,
O'er life's dark lough my course I still pursue.

And in the subjoined couplets, which should be read rhymingly:

Peasant Arcadian, guiding the plough,
Loam on your garments, your aspect is rough.

Peasant imprudent, I hear you've a cough:
Do you feel sure you're clad warm enough?

Home to your cottage, and bend o'er the trough,
Kneading the loaves of digestible dough.

Though the bread's heavy, unsweetened and tough,
Well sharpened teeth can go easily through.

And the opposite difficulty, which sometimes occurs, of determining the sense of a word from its pronunciation, is shown in the following verses:

Write, we know, is written right,
When we see it written w-r-i-t-e;
But when we see it written r-i-g-h-t,
We know it is not written right.
For write, to have it written right,
Must not be written r-i-g-h-t, or r-i-t-e,
Nor yet must it be written w-r-i-g-h-t,
But w-r-i-t-e, for so 'tis written right.

Some one asks: "If W-o-r-c-e-s-t-e-r is pronounced Wooster, wouldn't r-o-r-c-e-s-t-e-r be an excellent way to spell rooster?"

That is "the English of it," and, on the same principle—whatever it is—C-h-o-l-m-o-n-d-e-l-e-y is pronounced Chumley; M-i-c-h-i-l-i-m-a-c-i-n-a-c, Mackinaw; M-a-r-j-o-r-i-b-a-n-k-s, Marchbank; L-e-i-c-e-s-t-e-r, Lester; N-o-r-w-i-c-h, Norrij, and C-o-l-o-n-e-l, Curnel.

The ways of English pronunciation are, indeed, past finding out.

So are the secret motives of those who, having once adopted a false pronunciation, adhere to it in the face of all precept and example; who persist in calling Garibaldi, Gar-i-bawld-i; guipure, gim-pure; alpaca, al-a-pac-a; and a polonaise, a polo-nay. Of this class was the young person of Boston—she *couldn't* have been a young person of BOSTON!—who, passing out of an Art Gallery with a friend not long since, read aloud the inscription beneath a statuette of Psyche, and pronounced it Pi-sish. Her friend mildly suggesting the true pronunciation, the young person rejoined: "I know it. Some folks call it Si-kee, and some Pi-sish. I like Pi-sish the best."

THE QUESTION.

It is said that when a young lady enters society in one of our leading Eastern cities, the question invariably asked about her, by those who have not met her, is, in New York, “How much is she worth?” in Baltimore, “How does she look?” in Boston, “What does she know?” in Philadelphia, “*Who* is she?”

ALLITERATION.

The best specimen of alliteration in the English language is, perhaps,

THE SIEGE OF BELGRADE.

An Austrian army, awfully arrayed,
Boldly, by battery, besieged Belgrade.
Cossack commanders cannonading come,
Dealing destruction's devastating doom;
Every endeavor engineers essay,
For fame, for fortune, fighting, furious fray!
Generals 'gainst generals grapple—Gracious God!
How honors Heaven heroic hardihood!
Infuriate, indiscriminate, in ill,
Kinsmen kill kindred—kindred kinsmen kill.
Labor low levels longest, loftiest lines,—
Men march 'mid mounds, 'mid moles, 'mid murderous mines.
Now noisy, noxious, numbers notice naught
Of outward obstacles opposing ought;
Poor patriots! partly purchased, partly pressed,
Quite quaking, quickly “Quarter! Quarter!” quest.
Reason returns; religious right redounds,
Suwarrow stops such sanguinary sounds.
Truce to thee, Turkey! triumph to thy train,
Unjust, unwise, unmerciful, Ukraine!
Vanish, vain victory! Vanish, victory vain!
Why wish we warfare! Wherefore welcome were
Xerxes, Ximenes, Xanthus, Xavier!
Yield, yield, ye youths; ye yeomen yield your yell!
Zeno's, Zarpater's, Zoroaster's zeal,
Attracting all, arms against arms appeal.

A droll example of French alliteration is the following inquiry as to the efficacy of a certain remedy:

“Ton thé, a-t-il oté ta toux?”

One of the neatest of ACROSTICS was written by Desmond Ryan, for the *London Musical World*:

Art and Genius burn within her,
Dearest fondling of the Graces!
Every charm is centered in her;
Like a poet's page her face is!
In her voice the lark is thrilling—
Now to weep the heart is willing—
And now with joy and hope 'tis filling!

Praised, admired, two worlds all hail her—
Artless, pure, no tongues assail her!
Trust, love, triumph, never fail her!
Tell me, sooth, whose praise all that is?
I say, ADELINA PATTI'S!

But apropos of ingenuity, the author of the following exquisite poem seems, without half trying, to have distanced all competitors.

Many years ago, twenty-five or thirty, perhaps, two Cincinnati editors engaged in a newspaper controversy, which was, for a long time, conducted with all candor and courtesy. At length, however, one of them so far forgot himself as to become first personal, then scurrilous, then virulent; and the other, at an early stage of this radical change, quietly withdrew from the contest. Editor No. One thereupon indulged in loud pæans of victory: he had spiked his adversary's guns, put him to rout, utterly demolished him. While he was in this complacent frame of mind, he received from an anonymous contributor a seasonable poem on SPRING, which he published with a eulogium on its beauty, and a warmly-expressed wish that he might often hear from its gifted author:

SPRING.

The genial Spring once more with chaplets crowned,
Has showered her choicest blessings all around.
Each silent valley, and each verdant lawn,
Enriched with flowers, looks smiling as the dawn;
Demure and modest here the violet grows,

In yonder garden blooms the blushing rose:
To these the lilac adds her fragrant dower
Of perfume cherished by the sun and shower:
Reviving Flora walks the world, a queen
Of kingdoms peerless as a fairy scene.
Far o'er the hills, in many a graceful line,
The rainbow blossoms of the orchard shine.
How softly mingled all their tints unite,
Embalm the air, and bless the grateful sight!
Sweet voices now are heard on every tree,
The breeze, the bird, the murmur of the bee;
And down the cliff, where rocks oppose in vain,
Runs the clear stream in music to the plain.
In noisy groups, far from their southern home,
Now 'round the lofty spire the swallows roam;
The fearless robin builds, with glossy leaves,
Her fragile nest beneath the farmer's eaves;
Embowered in woods the partridge makes her bed
With silken moss o'er tender osiers spread:
Each happy bird expands his dappled wings,
Soars with his gentle mate and sweetly sings.
The sounds of early husbandry arise,
In pleasing murmurs, to the pale blue skies;
Shrill floats the ploughman's whistle, while he speeds
Along the yielding earth his patient steeds.
Joyous the life which tills the pregnant soil,
And sweet the profits of the farmer's toil:
Content, as smiling as an angel's face,
Keeps peaceful vigil 'round his dwelling-place;
And gentle Hope, and Love, forever bright,
Smiling like seraphs in their bowers of light,
Salute his mornings, and embalm each night.

A few days passed, and this self-complacent gentleman had the satisfaction of reading in a Boston paper that the editor of *The Star in the West* had fully justified the acrostic contained in a late beautiful poem on SPRING, by publishing and praising it in his paper.

EXTEMPORE SPEAKING.

It is no small thing to be called suddenly to address a public meeting of any sort, and to find all your wits gone wool-gathering, when you most require their services. Such being the case, and standing admitted, the

following speech of a compulsory order, at the opening of a free hospital, is recommended as a model:

Gentlemen—ahem! I—I—I rise to say—that is, I wish to propose a toast—wish to propose a toast. Gentlemen, I think that you’ll all say—ahem—I think, at least, that this toast is, as you’ll all say, the toast of the evening—toast of the evening. Gentlemen, I belong to a good many of these things—and I say, gentlemen, that this hospital requires no patronage—at least, you don’t want any recommendation. You’ve only got to be ill—got to be ill. Another thing—they are all locked up—I mean they are all shut up separate—that is, they have all got separate beds—separate beds. Now, gentlemen, I find by the report (turning over the leaves in a fidgety manner), I find, gentlemen, that from the year seventeen—no, eighteen—no, ah, yes, I’m right,—eighteen hundred and fifty—no, it’s a three, thirty-six—eighteen hundred and thirty-six, no—less than one hundred and ninety-three millions—no—ah? (to a committee-man at his side), what? thank you!—thank you, yes—one hundred and ninety-three thousand, two hundred and thirty-one! Gentlemen, I beg to propose:

Success to this Institution!

If no selections from the writings of our modern humorists, Artemus Ward, P. V. Nasby, Mark Twain, and others, grace these pages, the omission arises partly from the difficulty of selecting and partly from the fact that these writings are only too well known for our purpose. While the compiler has, doubtless, brought her readers face to face with many of their old acquaintances, she naturally prefers not to introduce those whom they are certain to meet every day at their own tables. “There must be a line drawn somewhere.”

But there is a word to be said about K. N. Pepper, whose irresistibly droll papers were contributed to the *Knickerbocker Magazine*, early in the ’50’s. He was, in fact, pioneer in that region of illiterature, in which so many others, since he withdrew, have apparently settled for life. Artemus Ward learned from him (and never hesitated to give him credit for the original idea,) the trick of bad spelling, and caught many of his fantastic ways of thought. His Betsey Jane was Pepper’s Hannah Gane amplified,—

but the twins, and the son who read the *Clipper*, and the daughter who delighted in the *Ledger*, were original Wards. (And what a guardian they had, in their hi-minded father!)

K. N. Pepper describes in the *Knickerbocker*, his first visit to New York. He arrived there on the twenty-fifth of November, and that anniversary suggested many solemn reflections. "I thinc," he pensively remarks, "that I see the British evacuating of the sitty. I thinc I se them gathering up their goods and things. I thinc I hear them cuss, and then I thinc I doant."

Very suddenly he retired from the field, leaving his laurels to be picked up and won by others, and presently disappeared from public view. But it is possible that Mr. James W. Morris, of Onondaga County, N. Y., could, if he chose, furnish some information concerning him.^[4]

The Widow Bedott, too, was precursor and prototype of Miss Slimmins, Josiah Allen's wife, and all of that ilk; and, among her imitators, has, thus far, had no equal. Her prose was a model of absurdity; but there are no words to characterize her poetry.

Listen, as she condoles with a widower, on his recent bereavement:

Sickness and afflictions is trials sent
By the will of a wise creation,
And always ought to be underwent
With fortitude and resignation.
Then mourn not for your pardner's death,
But to forgit endevver,
For, sposen she hadn't a died so soon,
She couldn't a lived forever.

And when, at last, she secured a widower of her own, the Rev. Shadrack Sniffles, how jubilant her muse became:

The heart that was scornful and cold as a stun,
Has surrendered at last to the fortinit one.
Farewell to the miseries and griefs I have had!
I'll never desert thee, O Shadrack, my Shad.

The wonderful puns and repartees of Charles Lamb and Sydney Smith, prince and king of wits! are open to the same objection as those alluded to above: they are only too familiar, already. But as that is equivalent to saying

that they have charmed only too many people; turned too many sorrowful or wearied minds out of their ordinary channels; excited too much healthful and delightful laughter; we are, after all, not disposed to complain. Rather let us, Sancho-Panza-like, invoke a benison, first on Cervantes himself; then on the English Hood and Hook, and Moore and Sheridan and Lamb, on the three Smiths, Sydney and James and Horace; on Dickens, Thackeray and Jerrold, and Edmund Lear; on our own Irving, Derby, Whicher, Morris, Brown, the Clarkes; our Lowell, Saxe, Holmes, Strong; our Warner, Cozzens, Dodgson, Gilbert, Locke, Bret Harte; our Grail Hamilton, and our Phebe Carey; and on all the named and unnamed, known and unknown writers, through whom have come to us the exquisite sense of fun, the blessing of irrepressible mirth, and of hearty, wholesome, innocent, delicious laughter!

And if, despite our struggles, we are accused, as we shall be, and justly, of having told some more than twice-told tales, of quoting already hackneyed quotations charity will urge in our behalf (and, let us trust, not vainly), Burns' pathetic plea, reminding the critics, that while

“What's done they” easily “compute.
They know not what's resisted.”

“SOUND AND” UNSOUND, “SIGNIFYING NOTHING.”

A young gentleman of Rochester, suspecting that the poetical enthusiasm of certain of his young lady acquaintances was not genuine; that they appreciated the musical jingle of verses, without in the least regarding the sentiment, laid a wager with one of his friends, that he could write a set of stanzas, which should not contain one grain of sense, and yet would be just as warmly applauded by those young ladies as the most eloquent poetry.

He won the wager. (But this occurred many years ago. There are no such young ladies in Rochester now).

See! the fragrant twilight whispers
O'er the orient western sky,
While Aurora's verdant vespers

Tell her evening reign is nigh.

Now a louder ray of darkness,
Carols o'er the effulgent scene,
And the lurid light falls markless
On the horizon's scattered screen.

Night is near, with all his horrors,
Sweetly swerving in his breast,
And the ear of fancy borrows
Morning mists to lull the west.

Ere he comes in all his splendor,
Hark! the milky way is seen,
Sighing like a maiden tender
In her bower of ruby green.

Such a scene, ah! who can list to,
And not saddened, silent, seek
To unveil the burning vista
Of Diana's raven cheek?

Thus tremulous, and ever dear,
Robed in repellant rapture;
Our hours shall stay, swift as the year,
Illumed by Cupid's capture!

And when hyenal joys are ours,
And memory soars above us,
Hope shall retrace for future years
The love of all who love us.

Something of the same character is the subjoined:

EVENING SONG.

Brightly blue the stars shine o'er us,
While the sinking sun ascends
To the wide spread waves before us,
And a pleasing softness lends.

Homeward now the aged plough-boys
Wing their way o'er hill and dale,
And the laughter-loving cow goes
Tripping lightly down the vale.

Gentle zephyrs' ink-stained fingers
Point the hour-hand of the clock,

There the warbling sheep-fold lingers—
Save it from the cruel hawk!

Thus excoriate the hours,
Till the red volcano's powers
Kindle on the hearth its fires:
Poets! dissipate your lyres!

In the following musical poem, the letter e does duty so well for all the other vowels, as to suggest the idea that our ordinary lavish use of them is a piece of extravagance!

When the September eves were new,
When fresh the western breezes blew,
When meek Selene, gem-besprent,
The dew her crested jewels lent;
We met, Belle, where the beeches grew,
When the September eves were new.

When the September eves were new,
Endless, meseemed, the sweets we knew!
Sweet fell the dew; sweet swept the breeze;
Sweet were the templed beechen trees;
The spell yet sweeter, tenderer grew,
When the September eves were new!

When the September eves were eld,
The templed beechen trees were felled;
Keen-edged the western breezes blew;
Crestless the meek Selene grew;
The fettered dew her jewels held,
When the September eves were eld.

When the September eves were eld,
Fled were the scenes we erst beheld—
Reft were the tender scenes we knew;—
The desert, where the beeches grew!
Yet, Belle, we sweeter secrets held,
Ere the September eves were eld!

The construction of the following verses, from which the letter s is omitted, shows that our language is not of necessity a succession of sibilant sounds, as it is generally supposed to be:

Oh! come to-night, for naught can charm
The weary time when thou'rt away.
Oh, come! the gentle moon hath thrown
O'er bower and hall her quivering ray.
The heather bell hath mildly flung
From off her fairy leaf the bright
And diamond dew-drop that had hung
Upon that leaf a gem of light.
Then come, love, come!

To-night the liquid wave hath not,
(Illumined by the moonlit beam
Playing upon the lake beneath,
Like frolic in a fairy dream—)
The liquid wave hath not, to-night,
In all her moonlit pride, a fair
Gift-like to them that, on thy lip,
Do breathe and laugh and home it there.
Then come, love, come!

To-night, to-night, my gentle one,
The flower-bearing Amra tree
Doth long, with fragrant moan, to meet
The love-lip of the honey-bee.
But not the Amra tree can long
To greet the bee, at evening light,
With half the deep, fond love *I* long
To meet my Nama here to-night.
Then come, love, come!

What a boon would a volume of poems, modeled on the above principle of architecture, be to perthonth troubled with a lithp; whose reading at present (through the perverseness of the English language), sounds thus:

Thweetly murmurth the breathe from the thea,
Thoothing my thoul to thlumberth,
Fond memorieth bearing to me,
Of the patht, in endleth numberth.
I thigh ath I think how yearth have thped,
How joy hath left me to thorow;
My heart now thleepeth the thleep of the dead;
Will it waken to gladneth to-morrow?

THE NIMBLE BANK-NOTE.

“And he rose with a sigh,
And he said, ‘Can this be?’”

(Motto chosen chiefly for its inappropriateness.)

One evening at the house of a friend of mine, while we were seated at the table, Mr. Baker, my friend’s husband, absently feeling in his vest pocket, found a five dollar note which he had no recollection of putting there.

“Hallo!” he exclaimed, “that is no place for you. I should have put you in my pocketbook. Here, wife, don’t you want some ready money?” and he threw the note across the table to her.

“Many thanks,” she replied; “money is always acceptable, although I have no present need of it.” She folded the note and put it under the edge of the tea-tray, and then proceeded to pour out the tea and attend to the wants of her guests.

At her right sat Mrs. Easton, or Aunt Susan, whom we all knew as an acquaintance who, from time to time, spent a week with Mrs. Baker. Her visit was just at an end, and she was to return home that evening.

As Mrs. Baker was pouring her tea, it occurred to her that she was in her aunt’s debt for certain small matters, and when she had the opportunity, she pushed the note under her plate, saying:

“Here, auntie, take this five dollars in part payment of my debt.”

“Very well,” she replied, “but the money does not belong to me. I owe you fifteen dollars, my dear Grace, which you lent me last Saturday. I had to pay the taxes on my little home, and had not the ready money, and Grace lent it to me,” explained Aunt Susan.

Grace, an orphan, was a cousin of Mrs. Baker. She and her brother Frank boarded with her, and made a very pleasant addition to the family circle. She was studying music, and her brother was a clerk in a mercantile establishment.

As soon as Aunt Susan received the note, she handed it to Grace, saying:

“I will give you this now on account, and the rest as soon as I get it.”

“All right,” answered Grace, laughing, “and since we all seem in the humor of paying our debts, I will follow suit. Frank, I owe you something for music you bought me; here is part of it,” and she threw the bank-note across the table to her brother, who sat opposite.

We were all highly amused to see how the note wandered around the table.

“This is a wonderful note,” said Mr. Baker; “I only wish somebody owed me something, and I owed somebody something, so that I might come into the ring.”

“You can,” said Frank. “I owe Mrs. Baker—or you, it’s all the same—for my board; I herewith pay you part of it.”

Amid general laughter, Mr. Baker took the note and playfully threw it to his wife again, saying:

“It’s yours again, Lucy, because what belongs to me belongs to you. It has completed the round, and we have all had the benefit of it.”

“And now it must go around again,” replied she gayly. “I like to see money circulate; it should never lie idle. Aunt Susan you take it. Now I have paid you ten dollars.”

“Dear Grace, here is another five dollars on my account,” said Aunt Susan, handing it to Grace.

“And you Frank, have paid ten dollars for the music you bought me,” said Grace, handing it to her brother.

“And I pay you ten dollars for my board,” he continued, and the note once more rested in Mr. Baker’s hands.

The exchanges were quick as thought, and we were convulsed with laughter.

“Was there ever so wonderful an exchange?” exclaimed Grace.

“It’s all nonsense!” exclaimed Mr. Baker.

“Not in the least,” answered his wife. “It’s all quite right.”

“Certainly,” said Frank; “when the money belonged to you, you could dispose of it as you would; I have the same right; it is a fair kind of

exchange, though very uncommon.”

“It shows the use of money,” said Aunt Susan. “It makes the circuit of the world and brings its value to every one who touches it.”

“And this note has not finished its work yet, as I will show you, my dear, if you will give it to me again, said Mrs. Baker to her husband.

“I present you with this five dollar note,” said Mr. Baker.

“And I give it to you, Aunt Susan—I owed you fifteen dollars, and I have paid my debt.”

“You have, my dear friend, without doubt; and now, my dear Grace, I pay you my indebtedness, with many thanks for your assistance.”

“I take it with thanks, Aunt Susan,” replied Grace; “and now the time has come when this wonder-working, this inexhaustibly rich bank-note must be divided, because I do not owe Frank five dollars more. How much have I to pay you?”

“Two dollars and sixty-two cents,” replied Frank.

“Can you change it?”

“Let me see; sixty-two, thirty-eight, yes, there is the change; the spell is broken, Grace, and you and I divide the spoils.”

“This bank-note beats all I ever saw. How much has it paid? Let us count up,” said Grace. “Mrs. Baker gave Aunt Susan fifteen dollars, which Aunt Susan gave me; I gave Frank twelve dollars and sixty-two cents; Frank gave Mr. Baker ten dollars—altogether fifty-two dollars and sixty-two cents.”

“It’s all nonsense, I tell you,” cried Mr. Baker, again; “you all owe each other what you owed before.”

“You are deceived, my dear, by the rapid, unbroken race this little sum has made; to me it is as clear as daylight,” replied Mrs. Baker.

“If it is all nonsense, how could the note which you gave Mrs. Baker, if nothing to me or to you, be divided between us two?” asked Grace.

Mr. Baker did not seem to see it very clearly, but the others did, and they often relate this little history for the amusement of their friends.

THE RATIONALISTIC CHICKEN.

(*Inspecting its shell.*)

BY J. S. STONE.

Most strange!
Most queer,—although most excellent a change!
Shades of the prison-house, ye disappear!
My fettered thoughts have won a wider range,
 And, like my legs, are free;
No longer huddled up so pitiably:
Free now to pry and probe, and peep and peer,
 And make these mysteries out.
Shall a free-thinking chicken live in doubt?
For now in doubt undoubtedly I am:
 This Problem's very heavy on my mind,
And I'm not one either to shirk or sham:
 I won't be blinded, and I won't be blind.

Now, let me see:
First, I would know how did I get in *there*?
 Then, where was I of yore?
Besides, why didn't I get out before?
 Dear me!
Here are three puzzles (out of plenty more)
Enough to give me pip upon the brain!
 But let me think again.
How do I know I ever *was* inside?
Now I reflect, it is, I do maintain,
Less than my reason, and beneath my pride,
 To think that I could dwell
In such a paltry miserable cell
 As that old shell.
Of course I couldn't! How could *I* have lain,
Body and beak and feathers, legs and wings,
And my deep heart's sublime imaginings,
 In there?

I meet the notion with profound disdain;
It's quite incredible; since I declare
(And I'm a chicken that you can't deceive)
What I can't understand I won't believe.
Where *did* I come from, then? Ah! where, indeed?
This is a riddle monstrous hard to read.
 I have it! Why, of course,
All things are moulded by some plastic force,
Out of some atoms somewhere up in space,
Fortuitously concurrent anyhow;—

There, now!
That's plain as is the beak upon my face.

What's that I hear?
My mother cackling at me! Just her way,
So prejudiced and ignorant *I* say;
So far behind the wisdom of the day.
What's old I *can't* revere.
Hark at her. "You're a silly chick, my dear,
That's quite as plain, alack!
As is the piece of shell upon your back!"
How bigoted! upon my back, indeed!
I don't believe it's there,
For I can't *see* it: and I do declare,
For all her fond deceivin',
What I can't see I never will believe in!

A MEDLEY.

I only know she came and went,	[Lowell.
Like troutlets in a pool;	[Hood.
She was a phantom of delight,	[Wordsworth.
And I was like a fool.	[Eastman.
One kiss, dear maid, I said, and sighed,	[Coleridge.
Out of those lips unshorn!	[Longfellow.
She shook her ringlets round her head,	[Stoddard.
And laughed in merry scorn.	[Tennyson.
Ring out, wild bells, to the wild sky,	[Tennyson.
You hear them, Oh, my heart,	[Alice Cary.
'Tis twelve at night by the castle clock—	[Coleridge.
Beloved, we must part.	[Alice Cary.
Come back, come back, she cried in grief,	[Campbell.
My eyes are dim with tears;	[B. Taylor.
How shall I live through all the days,	[Mrs. Osgood.
All through a hundred years?	[J. J. Perry.
'Twas in the prime of summer time,	[Hood.
She blessed me with her hand;	[Hoyt.
We strayed together deeply blest,	[Mrs. Edwards.
Into the dreaming land.	[Cornwall.
The laughing bridal roses blew,	[Patmore.
To deck her dark brown hair,	[B. Taylor.
No maiden may with her compare,	[Brailsford.
Most beautiful, most rare!	[Read.
I clasped it on her sweet cold hand,	[Browning.

The precious golden link;	[Smith.
I calmed her fears, and she was calm—	[Coleridge.
Drink, pretty creature, drink!	[Wordsworth.
And so I won my Genevieve,	[Coleridge.
And walked in Paradise;	[Hervey.
The fairest thing that ever grew	[Wordsworth.
Atween me and the skies!	[Tennyson.

ANOTHER MEDLEY.

(WHO ARE THE AUTHORS?)

The curfew tolls the knell of parting day,
 In every clime, from Lapland to Japan;
 To fix one spark of beauty's heavenly ray,
 The proper study of mankind is man.

Tell, for you can, what is it to be wise,
 Sweet Auburn, loveliest village of the plain!
 "The man of Ross," each lisping babe replies,
 And drags, at each remove a length'ning chain.

Ah, who can tell how hard it is to climb
 Far as the solar walk, or milky way?
 Procrastination is the thief of time,
 Let Hercules himself do what he may.

'Tis education forms the common mind,
 The feast of reason and the flow of soul;
 I must be cruel only to be kind,
 And waft a sigh from Indus to the pole.

Syphax! I joy to meet thee thus alone,
 Where'er I roam, whatever lands I see;
 A youth to fortune and to fame unknown,
 In maiden meditation, fancy free.

Farewell! and wheresoe'er thy voice be tried,
 Why to yon mountain turns the gazing eye?
 With spectacles on nose, and pouch on side,
 That teach the rustic moralist to die.

Pity the sorrows of a poor old man,
 Whose beard descending, swept his aged breast;
 Laugh where we must, be candid where we can,
 Man never is, but always to be blest.

AND ANOTHER MEDLEY.

The moon was shining silver bright,
All bloodless lay the untrodden snow,
When freedom from her mountain height,
Exclaimed, "Now don't be foolish, Joe!"

An hour passed by; the Turk awoke,
Ten days and nights with sleepless eye,
To hover in the sulphur smoke,
And spread its pall upon the sky.

His echoing axe the settlers swung,
He was a lad of high degree;
And deep the pearly caves among,
Sweet Mary, weep no more for me.

Loud roars the wild, inconstant blast,
And cloudless sets the sun at even;
When twilight dews are falling fast,
And rolls the thunder-drum of heaven.

Oh, ever thus, from childhood's hour,
By torch and trumpet fast arrayed,
Beneath yon ivy-mantled tower,
They lingered in the forest shade.

My love is like the red, red rose;
He bought a ring with posy true;
Deep terror then my vitals froze;
And, Saxon, I am Rhoderick Dhu!

LIFE.

Why all this toil for triumph of an hour?

[Young.

Life's a short summer—man is but a flower;

[Dr. Johnson.

By turns we catch the fatal breath and die—

[Pope.

The cradle and the tomb, alas! so nigh.

[Prior.

To be is better far than not to be,

[Sewell.

Though all man's life may seem a tragedy:

[Spencer.
But light cares speak when mighty griefs are dumb—

[Daniel.
The bottom is but shallow whence they come.

[Sir Walter Raleigh.
Your fate is but the common fate of all;

[Longfellow.
Unmingled joys may here no man befall;

[Southwell.
Nature to each allots his proper sphere,

[Congreve.
Fortune makes folly her peculiar care;

[Churchill.
Custom does often reason overrule,

[Rochester.
And throw a cruel sunshine on a fool.

[Armstrong.
Live well—how long or short permit to heaven;

[Milton.
They who forgive most shall be most forgiven,

[Bailey.
Sin may be clasped so close we cannot see its face—

[French.
Vile intercourse where virtue has no place,

[Sommerville.
Then keep each passion down, however dear.

[Thompson.
Thou pendulum betwixt a smile and tear;

[Byron.
Her sensual snares let faithless Pleasure lay,

[Smollet.
With craft and skill to ruin and betray,

[Crabbe.
Soar not too high to fall, but stoop to rise,

[Massinger.
We masters grow of all that we despise.

[Cowley.
Oh, then, renounce that impious self-esteem;

[Beattie.
Riches have wings; and grandeur is a dream.

[Cowper.
Think not ambition wise because 'tis brave,

[Sir Walter Davenant.
The paths of glory lead but to the grave,

[Gray.

What is ambition? 'Tis a glorious cheat.

[Willis.

Only destructive to the brave and great.

[Addison.

What's all the gaudy glitter of a crown?

[Dryden.

The way to bliss lies not on beds of down.

[Francis Quarles.

How long we live, not years but actions tell;

[Watkins.

That man lives twice who lives the first life well.

[Herrick.

Make then, while yet you may, your God your friend.

[William Mason.

Whom Christians worship, yet not comprehend.

[Hill.

The trust that's given guard, and to yourself be just;

[Dana.

For live we how we may, yet die we must.

[Shakespeare.

THE KEY.

ANSWERS TO PUZZLES.

1. Cobweb. *M. A. R.*
[Back to puzzle](#)
2. Thanks.
[Back to puzzle](#)
3. Of course I can! (Of Corsican.)
[Back to puzzle](#)
4. Maid of Orleans.
[Back to puzzle](#)
5. Because they have studded the heavens for centuries.
[Back to puzzle](#)
6. The winds blue, and the waves rose.
[Back to puzzle](#)
7. In violet.
[Back to puzzle](#)
8. They *leave out* their summer dress.

[Back to puzzle](#)

9. Because I am the querist.

[Back to puzzle](#)

10. Penmanship. *English Paper.*

[Back to puzzle](#)

11. Heather: weather. *Hearth and Home.*

[Back to puzzle](#)

12. Nothing.

[Back to puzzle](#)

13. It contains all the letters of the alphabet.

[Back to puzzle](#)

14. A lawsuit.

[Back to puzzle](#)

15. His father was Enoch, who did not die.

[Back to puzzle](#)

16. Yes: he was the Daughter-of-Pharaoh's son.

[Back to puzzle](#)

17. When Autumn is turning the leaves.

[Back to puzzle](#)

18. Bud-dhism.

[Back to puzzle](#)

19. Starch. (Star, sac, scar, tar, trash, act, arc, arch, art, ash, rat, rash, chart, cart, cat, car, chat, cash, cast, crash, hart, hat.)

[Back to puzzle](#)

20. Ague. (Hague; league; plague.)

[Back to puzzle](#)

21. Lettuce, alone. (Let us alone!)

[Back to puzzle](#)

22. The moon.

[Back to puzzle](#)

23. A human being.

The Sphinx Riddle.

[Back to puzzle](#)

24. Noah.

[Back to puzzle](#)

25. Macaulay.

Rural New Yorker.

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26. N R G.

[Back to puzzle](#)

27. M T.

[Back to puzzle](#)

28. O B C T.

[Back to puzzle](#)

29. X L N C.

[Back to puzzle](#)

30. L E G.

[Back to puzzle](#)

31. Dutch S.

[Back to puzzle](#)

32. French L.

[Back to puzzle](#)

33. K.

[Back to puzzle](#)

34. In the days of no A (Noah,) before U and I were born.

[Back to puzzle](#)

35. T.

[Back to puzzle](#)

36. Q.

[Back to puzzle](#)

37. It's laudin' 'em.

[Back to puzzle](#)

38. No man has three feet; a man has two feet more than no man:
therefore, a man has five feet.

[Back to puzzle](#)

39. A branch. *M. L. C.*

[Back to puzzle](#)

40. Love Me Little: Love Me Long.

[Back to puzzle](#)

41. Ma mère. *E. P.*

[Back to puzzle](#)

42. Amiable (Am I able?)

[Back to puzzle](#)

43. Conundrum.

[Back to puzzle](#)

44. Purcell. *M. D.*

[Back to puzzle](#)

45.

You sigh for a cipher, but I sigh for thee;
Oh, sigh for no cipher, but, oh, sigh for me;
And O, let my sigh for no cipher go,
But give sigh for sigh, for I sigh for you so!

[Back to puzzle](#)

46. Because they *axed* him whether he would or no. (Horrid!)

[Back to puzzle](#)

47. He was out at midnight, *on a bust*.

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48. $99\frac{9}{9}$.

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49. The season is backward for potatoes.

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50. One “wouldn’t do:” one “would do.”

[Back to puzzle](#)

51. When he owed (Oh’d) “for a lodge in some vast wilderness.”

[Back to puzzle](#)

52. The reindeer (The rain, dear!)

[Back to puzzle](#)

53. Red Wing. M. A. R.

[Back to puzzle](#)

54. Insert a semicolon after “peacock,” after “comet,” after “cloud,”
&c.; finally, after “sun.”

[Back to puzzle](#)

55. Semicolon after “talked.”

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56. Absence of body!

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57. The year before was 1870; the year following was 1870, too.

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58. Because they’d *fall out*, if they didn’t.

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59. Io died (iodide) of potassium.

[Back to puzzle](#)

60. He named it Robinson for Robinson crew so!

[Back to puzzle](#)

61. They’ve been to sea.

[Back to puzzle](#)

62. By the *Sound*.

[Back to puzzle](#)

63. He wears his collar and *pants*.

[Back to puzzle](#)

64. Veil; vile or evil; Levi, live.

[Back to puzzle](#)

65. A pair of spurs.

[Back to puzzle](#)

66. The letter A.

[Back to puzzle](#)

67. Translate the fourth and fifth “*suis*,” *follow*. “Suis” comes from *suivre*, as well as from *être*.

[Back to puzzle](#)

68. A mouse ran, full *but*,
Against my big *to*.

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69. Mind your *I*!

[Back to puzzle](#)

70. Campbell’s Poems.

[Back to puzzle](#)

71. Thou tea-chest!

[Back to puzzle](#)

72. J’aime en silence (*six lances*.)

[Back to puzzle](#)

73. Who raw for (the) read, white, and blew!

[Back to puzzle](#)

74. G a. (G, grand; a, petit.)

[Back to puzzle](#)

75. Toad (to *ad*.)

[Back to puzzle](#)

76. Noon.

[Back to puzzle](#)

77. Insatiate (in sat I ate.)

[Back to puzzle](#)

78. Follow the English pronunciation of the syllables, allowing for the cockneyish displacement of the letter h.

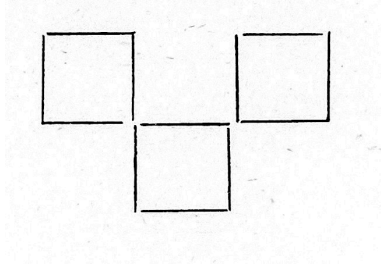
Thus: TONY'S ADDRESS TO MARY.

O Mary! Heave a sigh for me,
For me, your Tony true;
I am become as a man dumb,—
Oh, let Hymen prompt you! etc.

The eighth line is “Or eat a bit of pie.”

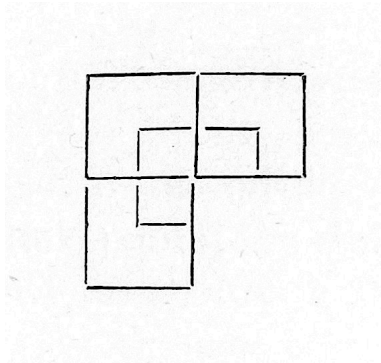
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79.



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80.



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81. XIII. (X, ^{VIII.})

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82. For convenience let us call the eight-gallon measure, a; the five-gallon, b; and the three-gallon, c.

From a fill c, and empty into b. Fill c again; and, from it, fill b. Then empty b into a, and c, (which has in it one gallon,) into b. Fill c again, and empty into b, which now contains four gallons; while a, also, contains four.

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83. One bushel and one-ninth.

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84. Nescio. Ik weet niet. Je ne sais pas. No sà. Non so. Ich weiss nicht.
Ninis cume. I dinna ken. I DON'T KNOW!

Professor Robinson in his Algebra attempts it, but not satisfactorily, so long as letters may be made to represent any number, or any other number, at discretion. Let us call it in this particular phase—(unfortunately it has others),—the Matrimonial Equation: “For, these two are one.”

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85. The stranger had eaten eight-thirds of a loaf: seven-thirds belonging to one of the Arabs, and only one-third to the other.

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86. He lost four dollars and the actual cost of the boots.

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87.

5 herring @ 2d. = 10d.

1 “ @ ½ = ½

6 “ @ ¼ = 1½

—
12 “ 12d.

[Back to puzzle](#)

88. Endless.

[Back to puzzle](#)

89. Cares: caress.

[Back to puzzle](#)

90. Onion.

[Back to puzzle](#)

91. Advice.

[Back to puzzle](#)

92. When he has grounds for complaint.

[Back to puzzle](#)

93. For divers reasons.

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94. For sundry purposes.

[Back to puzzle](#)

95. “The quality of Mercy (Mersey) is not strained.”

H. B. S.

[Back to puzzle](#)

96. “If the grate be empty, put coal on. If the grate be full, stop putting coal on.” So said one, but another replied “How can I put coal on, when there is such a high fender?”

[Back to puzzle](#)

97. Because he is no better.

[Back to puzzle](#)

98. When it becomes a lady.

[Back to puzzle](#)

99. The letters of the alphabet.

[Back to puzzle](#)

100. *One* was *going* to St. Ives': he met the others.

[Back to puzzle](#)

101. A little too long to wait! (*A little 2, long 2, 8.*)

E. S. D.

[Back to puzzle](#)

102. The Image that Michal put in David's bed. I Samuel, ch. xix.
Douay version, xix ch. I Kings.

[Back to puzzle](#)

103. His sister. The blind beggar was a woman.

[Back to puzzle](#)

104. The man who thanked Heaven was the lady's father.

[Back to puzzle](#)

105. "That man" was the rhymer's son.

[Back to puzzle](#)

106. Hirsute.

[Back to puzzle](#)

107. The letter s.

[Back to puzzle](#)

108. Because it is always *Snowdon*.

[Back to puzzle](#)

109. They should go to Fall River and Salem.

[Back to puzzle](#)

110. Novice.

[Back to puzzle](#)

111. Burns.

Hearth and Home.

[Back to puzzle](#)

112. Crabbe.

“ “ “

[Back to puzzle](#)

113. Bryant.

“ “ “

[Back to puzzle](#)

114. Gray.

“ “ “

[Back to puzzle](#)

115. Beecher.

“ “ “

[Back to puzzle](#)

116. Homer.

[Back to puzzle](#)

117. Hood.

[Back to puzzle](#)

118. Southey.

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119. Coleridge.

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120. Goldsmith.

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121. Humboldt.

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122. Mulock.

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123. Lowell.

[Back to puzzle](#)

124. Virgil.

[Back to puzzle](#)

125. Akenside.

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126. Wordsworth.

[Back to puzzle](#)

127. Steele.

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128. Shakespeare.

[Back to puzzle](#)

129. Cowper.

[Back to puzzle](#)

130. WILLis.

[Back to puzzle](#)

131. Barry Cornwall.

[Back to puzzle](#)

132. Landon.

[Back to puzzle](#)

133. Landor.

[Back to puzzle](#)

134. Leigh Hunt.

[Back to puzzle](#)

135. Walpole.

[Back to puzzle](#)

136. Palmerston.

[Back to puzzle](#)

137. Russell.

[Back to puzzle](#)

138. Lytton.

[Back to puzzle](#)

139. Carlyle.

[Back to puzzle](#)

140. Seward.

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141. W(h)ittier.

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142. Chatter(t)on.

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143. Because he has tenants.

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144. It is a step fa(r)ther.

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145. A draft.

[Back to puzzle](#)

146. A pack of cards.

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147. A cord of wood.

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148. Taking leave of things as they go.

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149. His reaper.

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150. It was Hamlet's Uncle, who "did murder most foul."

[Back to puzzle](#)

151. The Human Body.—¹ The chest; ² the eye-*lids*; ³ the knee-*caps*; ⁴ the ear-*drums*; ⁵ the nails; ⁶ the *soles* of the feet; ⁷ the muscles; ⁸ the *palms* of the hands; ⁹ the limbs; ¹⁰ two lips; ¹¹ the hips; ¹² the calves; ¹³ hairs; ¹⁴ the heart; ¹⁵ the eye-*lashes*; ¹⁶ the temples; ¹⁷ arms; ¹⁸ veins; ¹⁹ insteps; ²⁰ eyes and nose; ²¹ pupils; ²² tendons.

^a The palate; ^b the *roof* (of the mouth;) ^c the *bridge* (of the nose;) ^d the shoulder-*blades*; ^e the iris (of each eye;) ^f the skull; ^g the spinal *column*; ^h the tongue; ⁱ the eye-*balls*, &c., ^{jjj} the stirrup, anvil and hammer (bones of the ear,) ^k locks (of hair).

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152. Truant.

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153. Scarecrow.

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154. Intimate.

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155. Codicil.

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156. The hair.

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157. Sixteen (those who were blind of both eyes, were also blind of one eye, &c.)

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158. Because we have a W(h)ittier.

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159. Because that was his name!

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160. Because the other forty are Lent.

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161. Now here, nowhere.

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162. Ah no! (Arno.)

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163. Unquestionably.

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164. The road.

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165. Columbus.

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166. Met-a-physician.

[Back to puzzle](#)

167. Sackcloth.

[Back to puzzle](#)

168. The one who attends “patients on a monument.”

[Back to puzzle](#)

169. Rather he killed the gorilla.

[Back to puzzle](#)

170. She is a musing, b coming, d lighting, n chanting.

[Back to puzzle](#)

171. She is *Sad* you see.

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172. She is *Fair* I see.

[Back to puzzle](#)

173. “The judicious Hooker.”

[Back to puzzle](#)

174. Yesterday.

[Back to puzzle](#)

175. Sunday; all the rest are *week* days.

[Back to puzzle](#)

176. Campbell. *W. M. Praed.*

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177. Seldom, (cell-dumb.)

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178. His equal.

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179. Just ice.

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180. The King's Highway.

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181. Postage.

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182. Baking—*a king, b king, a kin.*

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183. Strawberry.

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184. A Mushroom.

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185. Fault.

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186. A ditch.

[Back to puzzle](#)

187. When they chatter.

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188. Short.

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189. A pillow.

[Back to puzzle](#)

190. *Advice*.

[Back to puzzle](#)

191. Heat; you can *catch* cold.

[Back to puzzle](#)

192. Sausage.

Rural New Yorker.

[Back to puzzle](#)

193. Hemlock.

[Back to puzzle](#)

194. Heroine; hero; her; he.

[Back to puzzle](#)

195. A blush.

[Back to puzzle](#)

196. He took his cup and saucer.

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197. The cat'll eat it.

[Back to puzzle](#)

198. B natural.

[Back to puzzle](#)

199. B sharp.

[Back to puzzle](#)

200. If the stairs were a way, I would go down stairs.

[Back to puzzle](#)

201. Nameless.

[Back to puzzle](#)

202. He “cut it too little”; that is, he did not cut it enough.

[Back to puzzle](#)

203. TOBACCO.

[Back to puzzle](#)

204. Because of the sandwiches (sand which is) there.

[Back to puzzle](#)

205. How did the sandwiches get there? Ans. There Ham dwelt, and there his descendants were bred and mustered (bread and mustard.)

206. Was there any butter on the sandwiches? Ans. No; Ham took only his wife; he took none of his family BUT *her*.

207. His was made *of* Gophir wood, and they are made *to* go for wood.

[Back to puzzle](#)

208. “Noah went *forth*.”

[Back to puzzle](#)

209. (M) *a jest* (y).

[Back to puzzle](#)

210. “Dreaming often;” dreaming of *ten*.

[Back to puzzle](#)

211. Yes; “perhaps” *is* most like maybe, or a bee in May.

[Back to puzzle](#)

212. The third gave it her ring, which Puss *couldn't* eat.

[Back to puzzle](#)

213. On the other side.

[Back to puzzle](#)

214. Eusebius, (You see by us.)

[Back to puzzle](#)

215. Inch; chin.

[Back to puzzle](#)

216. Envy; (N. V.)

[Back to puzzle](#)

217. Pardon.

[Back to puzzle](#)

218. Cape, caper.

[Back to puzzle](#)

219. Ten, tenor.

[Back to puzzle](#)

220. Foe, four.

[Back to puzzle](#)

221. Oak, ochre.

[Back to puzzle](#)

222. Sow, soar.

[Back to puzzle](#)

223. Fee, fear.

[Back to puzzle](#)

224. Roe, roar.

[Back to puzzle](#)

225. Sue, sewer.

[Back to puzzle](#)

226. Be, beer.

[Back to puzzle](#)

227. Lie, lyre.

[Back to puzzle](#)

228. Beau, bore.

[Back to puzzle](#)

229. Stowe, store.

[Back to puzzle](#)

230. Sea, seer.

[Back to puzzle](#)

231. Cough, coffer.

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232. Loaf, loafer.

[Back to puzzle](#)

233. Port, porter.

[Back to puzzle](#)

234. Pie, pyre.

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235. Bat, batter.

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236. Dee, deer.

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237. Tart, Tartar.

[Back to puzzle](#)

238. Tea, tier.

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239. Ye, year, yeast.

[Back to puzzle](#)

240. Bow, boar, boast.

[Back to puzzle](#)

241. Fee, fear, feast.

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242. Pay, pear, paste.

[Back to puzzle](#)

243. Lea, Lear, least.

[Back to puzzle](#)

244. Bow, rower, roast.

[Back to puzzle](#)

245. Bee, bier, beast.

[Back to puzzle](#)

246. E, ear, east.

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247. Co., core, coast.

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248. Poe, pour, post.

[Back to puzzle](#)

249. Go, gore, ghost.

[Back to puzzle](#)

250. Weigh, weigher, waste.

[Back to puzzle](#)

251. “Dear Nephew;

See, my coal on.

Uncle John.”

“Dear Uncle;

Coal on!

James.”

[Back to puzzle](#)

252. He is above doing a bad action.

[Back to puzzle](#)

253. Because a hen lays only one egg a day, and a ship *lays to*.

[Back to puzzle](#)

254. Because you can.

[Back to puzzle](#)

255. ¹ corn, ² needles, ³ pins, ⁴ buckles, ⁵ canals, ⁶ combs, ⁷ rivers, ⁸ roses, ⁹ clocks, ¹⁰ potatoes, ¹¹ stars, ¹² shoes.

Hearth and Home.

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256. The whale that swallowed Jonah.

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257. Bunyan—a bunion.

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258. A girl is a lass, and alas is an interjection.

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259. Learning to go alone.

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260. The door-bell.

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261. White kids.

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262. He would want muzzlin'.

[Back to puzzle](#)

263. When it lies in a well.

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264. Three: Sirius and the two pointers.

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265. *Hailing* omnibuses.

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266. All the rest are in audible.

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267. Because he is not a(p)parent.

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268. A river.

[Back to puzzle](#)

269. Neither: both burn shorter.

[Back to puzzle](#)

270. Because it keeps its hands before its face; and, though full of good works, it is wholly unconscious of them, and always running itself down.

[Back to puzzle](#)

271. Manslaughter; man's laughter.

[Back to puzzle](#)

272. Monosyllable.

[Back to puzzle](#)

273. A bed.

[Back to puzzle](#)

274. (P)shaw!

[Back to puzzle](#)

275. The sons raise meat there. (The sun's rays meet there.)

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276. Innocence Abroad, by Mark Twain (In no sense, a broad).

[Back to puzzle](#)

277. Facetiously.

[Back to puzzle](#)

278. Philip the Great.

[Back to puzzle](#)

279. Bug-bear.

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280. Wat Tyler Will Rufus.

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281. Bloomer (err; her; Herr).

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282. Clio.

[Back to puzzle](#)

283. Cheat; heat; eat; at; chat; ache.

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284. One; none.

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285. Arrow-head.

[Back to puzzle](#)

286.

A man of deceit
Can best counterfeit;
So, as everything goes,
He can best count 'er toes.

[Back to puzzle](#)

287. Balaam's Ass.

[Back to puzzle](#)

288. A kiss.

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289. The *five* vowels.

[Back to puzzle](#)

290. Dotage.

[Back to puzzle](#)

291. Seaward.

[Back to puzzle](#)

292. Mimic.

[Back to puzzle](#)

293. Disgraceful.

[Back to puzzle](#)

294. The first made musical instruments; the second was a baggage-man; the third was employed in a gas-factory; and the fourth made candles.

[Back to puzzle](#)

295. Cod.

[Back to puzzle](#)

296. The postman.

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297. Cowslip.

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298. Love.

[Back to puzzle](#)

299. The axle-tree.

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300. Because it is farthest from the bark.

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301. Because his business makes him sell-fish.

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302. Pearlash.

[Back to puzzle](#)

303. If he was a wonder, she was a *Tudor*.

[Back to puzzle](#)

304. LION
 INTO
 OTTO
 NOON.

[Back to puzzle](#)

305. A cock.

[Back to puzzle](#)

306. Enigma.

[Back to puzzle](#)

307. Crabbe, Shelley, Moore.

[Back to puzzle](#)

308. Goldsmith, Locke.

[Back to puzzle](#)

309. Campbell, Knight, Day, Foote.

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310. His face.

[Back to puzzle](#)

311. BLIND.

[Back to puzzle](#)

312. Young, Gay, Hood, Lamb, Field, Gray, Fox, Hunt, Horne, Lingard, Wordsworth, Steele.

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313. Marvell, Hilarius, Akenside, Manley, Hyde, Pope.

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314. Aërial.

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315. Bass, perch, roast pig, turkey, fillet, celery, gooseberry pudding, dates, Hamburg grapes.

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316. Fire-fly.

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317. The nose.

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318. *Walnut.*

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319. *Pea-nut.*

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320. *Butternut.*

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321. *Beechnut.*

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322. *Chestnut.*

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323. *Cocoanut.*

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324. *The morning glory.*

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325. *Snow drops.*

[Back to puzzle](#)

326. *Spinach.*

[Back to puzzle](#)

327. The passion flower.

[Back to puzzle](#)

328. The spruce tree.

[Back to puzzle](#)

329. Because he has Adam's Needle, Jacob's Ladder, and Solomon's Seal.

[Back to puzzle](#)

330. Catnip and Henbane.

[Back to puzzle](#)

331. Heart-ache.

[Back to puzzle](#)

332. Cashmere.

[Back to puzzle](#)

333. Season.

[Back to puzzle](#)

334. A drum.

[Back to puzzle](#)

335. Chain, china, chin.

[Back to puzzle](#)

336. Charge, charger.

[Back to puzzle](#)

337. Scamp, scamper.

[Back to puzzle](#)

338. Lad, ladder.

[Back to puzzle](#)

339. Tell, teller.

[Back to puzzle](#)

340. Barb, barber.

[Back to puzzle](#)

341. Din, dinner.

[Back to puzzle](#)

342. I, ire.

[Back to puzzle](#)

343. Yew, ewer.

[Back to puzzle](#)

344. Owe, oar.

[Back to puzzle](#)

345. Crescent, (cress-scent.)

[Back to puzzle](#)

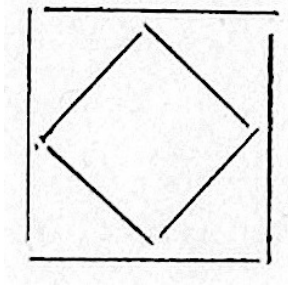
346. The 5th, 6th, 7th, 8th, 9th, 12th, 16th, 18th, 19th, 22nd, 23rd, 24th, 26th, 27th, 30th, in the circle, were Jews.

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347. Honesty is the best policy. (On ST, etc.)

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348.



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349. The Tongue.

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350. Bothwell.

St. Nicholas.

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351. A little more than *kin* and less than *kind*.

[Back to puzzle](#)

352. Clink, link, ink, chair, hair, air.

[Back to puzzle](#)

353. (1) D-ranged; (2) C-girt; (3) D-lighted; (4) N-hammered; (5) D-tested; (6) R-gone-out; (7) G-owed; (8) K-dense; (9) O-void; (10) S-pied; (11) B-held; (12) C-bored; (13) X-pensive; (14) D-famed. *St. Nicholas.*

[Back to puzzle](#)

354. Wake robin.

[Back to puzzle](#)

355. Fill blanks with: straining, training, raining; dashing, plashing, marching, arching.

[Back to puzzle](#)

356. Lily.

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357. Ivanhoe. *St. Nicholas.*

[Back to puzzle](#)

358. Aries,—wearies. The enigma refers to the period when Taurus (the name of whose principal star Aldebaran signifies “He went before, or led the way,”) was First Constellation. Next, Aries, always First Sign, was also First Constellation; and now the Constellation Pisces “leads the year.”

[Back to puzzle](#)

359. Tissue.

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360. Because it is written with great E’s.

[Back to puzzle](#)

361. Because it is written with two great E’s—(*too* great ease.)

[Back to puzzle](#)

362. Trace a five-pointed star, and plant a tree at each extreme point, and at each point of intersection.

[Back to puzzle](#)

363. In naught extenuate, and set *down* naught in malice. E. S.
D.

[Back to puzzle](#)

364. That boy lied.

[Back to puzzle](#)

365. Fill the blanks with heart, story, art, tory.

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366. Fill the blanks with plover, lover, over, ver; glowing, lowing, owing, wing.

[Back to puzzle](#)

367. "For thou art as deaf as a p-o-s-t."

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368. April: (ape, rill).

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369. He mispronounced the word "full." "You're a fool, Moon," said he.

[Back to puzzle](#)

370. The pronoun "it," which may stand for anything on earth, or under or above the earth, seems to be the only possible solution. In the first line it

stands, perhaps, for the utmost limit of space; in the second, for the centre of the earth, etc.

[Back to puzzle](#)

371. Dogmatic.

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372. Cambyses.

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373. About 117.7 feet. (Find the radius of a circle whose area is 43,560 square feet.).— *Prof. Eaton, of Packer Institute.*

[Back to puzzle](#)

374. Informal.

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375. **A DINNER PARTY—THE GUESTS.**

1. Robert Bruce.
2. Sir Walter Scott.
3. Cleopatra.
4. Leonidas.
5. Napoleon.
6. John Milton.
7. Louis XVI.
8. Artemisia.
9. Michael Angelo.
10. Gustavus of Sweden.
11. Warwick.
12. Anne of Warwick.
13. Christopher Wren.

14. Cardinal Mezzofanti.
15. Nelson.
16. Robert Burns.
17. The Chevalier Bayard.
18. Cromwell.
19. Sir Robert Walpole.
20. Sopor, King of Persia.
21. Death.
22. Schwartz, or Roger Bacon.
23. Alfred the Great.
24. Captain Cook.
25. Johannes Gutenberg.
26. Marshal Ney.
27. Galileo.
28. Blucher.
29. Sir Isaac Newton.
30. Julius Cæsar.
31. Sir Humphrey Davy.
32. Sir Walter Raleigh.
33. Sir James Ross.
34. Alfred Tennyson.
35. William Wordsworth.
36. Geoffrey Chaucer.
37. Charles XII of Sweden.
38. The Black Prince.
39. Sir Francis Drake.
40. Talleyrand.
41. Herodotus.

DISHES, ETC.

1. Oysters.
2. Soles.
3. Herring.
4. Crabs.

5. Venison.
6. Turkey.
7. Bacon.
8. Lamb.
9. Goose.
10. Hare.
11. Duck.
12. Woodcock.
13. Partridge.
14. Tongue.
15. Terrapin.
16. Potatoes.
17. Pease.
18. Parsnips.
19. Tomatoes.
20. Beets.
21. Spinach(e).
22. Cabbage.
23. Cauliflower.
24. Salad *in*.
25. Jelly.
26. Celery.
27. Artichokes.
28. Capers.
29. Cucumbers.
30. Salt.
31. Hominy.
32. Bread.
33. A *floating* island.
34. Whips.
35. Currants.
36. Gooseberries.
37. Pears.
38. Oranges.

- 39. Pine apples.
- 40. Apricots.
- 41. Medlars.
- 42. Figs.
- 43. Grapes (gray apes.)
- 44. Comfits.
- 45. Nuts.

[Back to puzzle](#)

Note.—“[A headless man had a letter](#),” etc., [page 78](#). Was “the letter” the letter O—equivalent to a cipher, to nought, or nothing? If this is the solution, then the headless man had “nothing” to write; “nothing” was read by the blind man; the dumb repeated and the deaf heard “nothing.”

Footnotes

[1] Reminichia—overhanging the water—the Indian name of a bluff at the entrance of a certain Minnesota city.

[2] Full of delights: blessed.

[3] The book was written in good faith, and was published for the benefit of the Syracuse University.

[4] Emerson, in his “Parnassus,” and the *Atlantic Monthly* for April, 1875, accredit “A Colusion between A Water-Snaik and A Aligater,” to G. H. Derby (“John Phenix”). It was contributed by “K. N. Pepper” to the *Knickerbocker Magazine*, in 1854.

Transcriber's Notes

Inconsistent word hyphenation and spelling have been regularized.

Apparent typographical errors have been corrected.

Hyperlinks are provided from each puzzle or riddle to its solution (“Answer”) and from the solution back to the puzzle (“Back to puzzle”).

Depending on the device, software and font used to read this text, not all elements may display as intended.

In the [printer's short-hand poem](#) on [page 119](#), the “{” character was originally depicted facing upwards.

The illusion [“Seeing is Believing: Seeing is Deceiving”](#) on [Page 97](#) may not work with every font. Therefore, right-side-up and upside-down text lines from the original work have been inserted as additional illustrations below the text.

The [word pyramid](#) on [Page 132](#) may not make the expected shape with every font, and therefore the pyramid from the original text has been added as a additional illustration under the text pyramid.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK PUZZLES AND
ODDITIES ***

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